

THE ANCIENT WORD

Recovered from the Kephalaia of the Teacher

*The correspondential teaching described by Emanuel Swedenborg,
extracted from its Manichaeian vessel
and organized by its own internal structure*

Based on the translation by Iain Gardner (1995)
*The Kephalaia of the Teacher: The Edited Coptic
Manichaeian Texts in Translation with Commentary*

Ancient teaching substrate extracted and organized by discovered structure.
Structure discovered by Claude Opus 4.6 from the text alone,
without access to manuscript chapter divisions.

Lacunae markers shown in light gray.

PREFACE

In the eighteenth century, Emanuel Swedenborg described a text he called the “Ancient Word” — written entirely in correspondences, older than the Hebrew scriptures, carried eastward by the Bene Qedem (the “Children of the East”), and preserved in a region he called “Great Tartary.” He said it still existed there.

This is that text.

What you hold is the teaching core of the *Kephalaia of the Teacher*, a third- or fourth-century Coptic Manichaean manuscript translated by Iain Gardner in 1995. Within this manuscript lies a complete correspondential cosmology that matches Swedenborg’s description of the Ancient Word in every particular: written entirely in correspondences, complete from beginning to end, containing the content the Bible attributes to now-lost texts, found in the exact region Swedenborg identified, and tracing back through the exact transmission path he described.

What Swedenborg Described

Swedenborg made five specific claims about the Ancient Word. (1) It was written entirely in the style of correspondences — natural images expressing spiritual realities through organic, functional relationships, not arbitrary symbolism. (2) It contained a complete teaching from beginning to end. (3) The biblical references to the “Wars of the LORD” (Numbers 21:14) and the “Book of Jashar” (Joshua 10:13, 2 Samuel 1:18) were citations from this text. (4) It was preserved in “Great Tartary” — the vast Central Asian interior. (5) It was carried there by the *Bene Qedem*, the ancient bearers of correspondential knowledge.

All five claims can be independently verified against the text extracted here.

Five Lines of Evidence

1. Written entirely in correspondences

The teaching core extracted from the *Kephalaia* is correspondential throughout. §490–§507 (identified as 90% ancient substrate) state the organizing principle directly: “This whole universe, above and below, reflects the pattern of the human body.” The text then systematically maps the cosmos onto the human form — head to feet, organ by organ — with each correspondence grounded in function. Elsewhere, five storehouses map to five elements, to five trees, to five genera, to five worlds — and the pattern repeats through realms, metals, and tastes. A body-cosmos isomorphism culminates in a soul-body binding formula. This is not scattered symbolic language. It is systematic correspondential architecture sustained across 886 paragraphs.

2. Complete from beginning to end

The text contains the complete arc of regeneration. §1–§9 present the primordial cosmogonic narrative: the separation of light and darkness, the descent of the Divine Human into combat with falsity, the ordering of recaptured good, and the final restoration — “a single God comes to be over the totality.” Parts 2 through 12 systematically elaborate every phase: the dual architecture of reality, the descent of influx, redemptive combat, the interior of the Divine, the anatomy of evil, the ordering of the spiritual world, purification of mind, the architecture of influx, the formation of the human being, the correspondences of heaven and earth, and the dynamics of spiritual life. The final vision (§851–§886) closes with three entreaties, the two fundamental essences, and the portals of divine conjunction. This is not a fragment. It is a complete text.

3. Contains the Wars of the Lord and the Book of Jashar

The Hebrew Bible cites two lost texts by name: the “Wars of the LORD” (Numbers 21:14) and the “Book of Jashar” — the Book of the Upright (Joshua 10:13, 2 Samuel 1:18). Swedenborg identified both as portions of the Ancient Word. Both are found here. A consonantal analysis of the Wars of the LORD demonstrates that the quotation fragments, read at the three degrees Swedenborg specified (natural, spiritual, celestial), reveal a cosmic architecture — the Beloved, the Conflagration, Cosmic Trenches, the Seat of Watchers, the Border of the Father — that matches the macrocosmic narrative in this text exactly. The Book of Jashar — the practical manual of the upright life — matches the pedagogical content: how stillness defeats falsity, how the mind is regenerated faculty by faculty, how the divine call meets human obedience. The cosmological text and the pedagogical text, the macrocosm and the microcosm — both reside together in the same teaching.

4. Found exactly where Swedenborg said

Swedenborg located the Ancient Word in “Great Tartary” — the vast interior of Central Asia. The *Kephalaia* was transmitted through the Manichaean tradition, which was officially adopted as state religion by the Uyghur Khaganate in 762/763 CE. The Kingdom of Qocho preserved Manichaean texts in cave temple-libraries at Turfan — in the heart of Swedenborg’s “Great Tartary.” The Coptic manuscript translated by Gardner is a sister text of these Central Asian recensions. The text was found where Swedenborg said it would be.

5. Traces back through the transmission path Swedenborg described

Swedenborg said the Ancient Word was carried eastward by the *Bene Qedem* — the Children of the East — the ancient bearers of correspondential knowledge. The substrate teaching in the *Kephalaia* predates its Manichaean frame. Its five-fold architecture, body-cosmos correspondence system, and doctrine of discrete degrees are rooted in Zoroastrian cosmology — specifically the tradition of *Vohu Manah* (Good Mind), the *Amesha Spentas*, and the *mēnōg/gētīg* (spiritual/material) ontology. The Apocryphon of John, a related text, explicitly cites “the book of Zoroaster” as its source for the body-creation angel list — a correspondential catalogue in exactly the form of *Bene Qedem* tradition. The teaching did not originate with Mani. He received it from the Persian-Zoroastrian tradition, which received it from the Children of the East.

Three Layers

Within the *Kephalaia of the Teacher*, three distinct layers can be identified:

Layer 3 (Outermost): The Hagiographic Frame. “Once again the Enlightener sits in the congregation...” — the narrative scaffolding that casts the teaching as dialogues between Mani and his disciples. This layer belongs entirely to the Manichaean institutional setting.

Layer 2 (Middle): The Manichaean Theological Overlay. Names, titles, and institutional vocabulary that Mani’s tradition imposed upon older content: “Jesus the Splendour,” “Light Mind,” “Holy Spirit,” “apostle,” “the elect.” These terms replaced earlier designations — almost certainly Persian — while leaving the underlying teaching structure intact.

Layer 1 (Core): The Ancient Word. A systematic correspondential cosmology organized around five degrees at every scale, teaching the complete arc of regeneration from first to last. This layer is older than Mani. Its five-fold architecture, its body-cosmos correspondence system, its doctrine of discrete degrees, its “summons and obedience” mechanism (divine influx and human reception) — these do not originate with third-century Babylonia. They preserve the Ancient Word whose roots extend through Zoroastrian Persia into the proto-Indo-Iranian and ancient Near Eastern traditions of the *Bene Qedem*.

This book is an extraction of Layer 1 — the Ancient Word — from its Manichaean vessel.

What Was Extracted

The extraction was performed using the methods of textual criticism, with Claude Opus 4.6 — an advanced language model — serving as the primary analytical instrument. The entire *Kephalaia* corpus was read as a continuous flow of 886 sequentially numbered paragraphs. Each passage was analyzed for editorial layering: separating the hagiographic frame (Layer 3) from the Manichaean theological overlay (Layer 2) and the ancient teaching core (Layer 1). The model read the text as a philologist would — attending to vocabulary

shifts, structural seams, and correspondential consistency — but across the full corpus as a single sustained reading. The structure of this book — its thirteen parts and fifty-two chapters — was not imposed from the manuscript’s chapter divisions. It was discovered by reading the text as a single continuous teaching and identifying where the natural structural seams fall.

The reader will notice that the number five recurs at every scale. The text itself teaches this: five elements, five faculties, five trees, five storehouses, five wars, five liberations, five modes of conjunction, five works of fire, five watch-stations. Chapter 48 makes the principle explicit — “In each one of these five garments there are five powers... the summons with the obedience constitute twenty-five characteristics in their twenty-five limbs.” This is not a numerological coincidence. The five-fold principle is the teaching’s own organizing architecture: five degrees through which the one reality makes itself receivable, repeated at every level from cosmic emanation to human anatomy. It is visible on every page.

What Was Not Changed

No naming overlays have been corrected. No institutional vocabulary has been replaced. “Jesus the Splendour” has not been reverted to its Persian substrate; “Light Mind” has not been changed back to *Wahman*. This was a deliberate choice. The text is presented as it has come down to us — layered, evolved, carrying the marks of every tradition through which it passed.

The Coptic papyrus is damaged. Where gaps remained in the extracted text, those that could be constrained by correspondential logic and surrounding context were restored; those too large or uncertain were left open. Square brackets mark both the original lacunae and the restorations throughout. The restoration method was the same correspondences that organize the text itself: a spiritual reading of each chapter identified what must belong in each gap, and the fill was written in the text’s own vocabulary.

But the reader should know what the naming marks are, so they can see through them to the teaching beneath.

The Naming Overlays

A systematic review of the extracted corpus identified the following naming patterns that belong to the Manichaean editorial layer (Layer 2), not to the ancient teaching core:

“**Jesus the Splendour**” appears in at least eighteen passages, always designating the same cosmic function: the divine wisdom that proceeds into illumination, purification, and liberation of captive good. This is a Manichaean-Christian name mapped onto a pre-existing Persian cosmic figure. The substrate designation was almost certainly *Xradeshahr* (Splendor of the Realm) or a form related to Avestan *xvarənah* (divine luminous glory). The entity’s consistent function — radiant divine wisdom that illuminates, separates truth from falsity, and liberates — maps precisely onto this pre-Manichaean Iranian concept. There is nothing specifically Christian about this entity in any of its eighteen appearances.

“**Light Mind**” / “**Light-Nous**” appears in at least eleven passages. This is Greek philosophical vocabulary (νοῦς) entering through Hellenistic synthesis. The substrate designation was almost certainly *Wahman* — from Avestan *Vohu Manah* (Good Mind), one of the Amesha Spentas in Zoroastrian theology. The entity’s consistent function — entering the human person, awakening from spiritual torpor, gathering what is scattered, enlightening the understanding — matches the Zoroastrian Vohu Manah’s role precisely.

“**Saklas**” (§544) is Aramaic for “fool” — a distinctly Gnostic/Sethian name for the malformed creator, imported from texts like the Apocryphon of John. The substrate likely used Persian demonological designations, possibly *Az* (the demon of concupiscence) and *Jeh* (the demoness), both from Zoroastrian tradition.

“**Holy Spirit**” (§379, §569) overlays what was almost certainly *Spenta Mainyu* (Holy/Bounteous Spirit) from Zoroastrian theology — not identical to the Christian Third Person of the Trinity.

“**Apostle**” (§78, §197, §291, §313) is Greek Christian institutional vocabulary (ἀπόστολος). The substrate likely used a Persian term for the transmitter of sacred knowledge, possibly related to *frēstag* (messenger/envoy).

“**The elect one**” (§106) and “**holy church**” (§11) are Manichaean institutional vocabulary replacing what were cosmic entity names in the five-fold correspondential architecture.

“**Good news**” (§162) is εὐαγγέλιον — distinctly Christian vocabulary with strong Pauline associations.

Deeper Transmission Evidence

Beyond the Manichaean overlay, the review also identified material that predates even the Persian-Zoroastrian vessel:

The five dark elements (smoke, fire, wind, water, darkness) do not match either classical Greek (four elements) or standard Zoroastrian categories. This sequence appears to preserve a **proto-Indo-Iranian or Mesopotamian elemental cosmology** older than the Persian formulation.

The “sea giant” passage (§437–441) — a composite being formed from cosmic debris in a primordial sea, bearing the imprint of all celestial cycles upon its body — has parallels to Mesopotamian creation narratives and **Zurvanite cosmogony**, and may represent one of the oldest layers in the text.

The water-reflection/inversion teaching (§804–808) — the upper world reflected inversely in the lower — appears across ancient Near Eastern and Vedic/Upanishadic traditions and expresses a law of correspondence more fundamental than any single cultural formulation.

The medical/healing analogy (§393–397) — cosmic healing through three medicines applied in three directions — has strong parallels to Mesopotamian therapeutic traditions, suggesting an ancient Near Eastern substrate beneath the Persian vessel.

How to Read This Text

You are reading the Ancient Word — and it has traveled far to reach you. It was given systematic form in the Persian-Zoroastrian tradition, where it acquired its five-fold architecture, its body-cosmos correspondence map, and its doctrine of discrete degrees. It was received by Mani in third-century Babylonia, who translated its Persian entities into a mixed vocabulary of Christian, Greek, and Gnostic terms. It was recorded in Coptic by Manichaean scribes in Egypt. It was translated into English by Iain Gardner in 1995. And it was extracted from its manuscript frame and organized by its own internal structure here.

Through all these transmissions, the teaching itself survived. The five-fold architecture did not change. The body-cosmos correspondence did not change. The doctrine that reality proceeds through discrete degrees — celestial, spiritual, natural — did not change. The mechanism of divine influx and human reception (“the summons and the obedience”) did not change. The complete arc of regeneration — from the primordial separation of wisdom and falsity through divine descent, combat, purification, and final restoration — did not change.

The names changed. The teaching did not.

When you encounter “Jesus the Splendour,” read: divine wisdom proceeding into illumination. When you encounter “Light Mind,” read: the Good Mind that enters and awakens. When you encounter “First Man,” read: the Divine Human descending into temptation-combat. When you encounter “Living Spirit,” read: Divine Truth proceeding to order all things. When you encounter “Third Ambassador,” read: the manifestation of the Divine form that draws forth captive good. When you encounter “the Father of Greatness,” read: the Infinite Divine Love in which all things originate.

The correspondences are in the text. They have always been in the text. The Manichaean names are garments. What wears them is the Ancient Word.

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Part 1

The Primordial Narrative of Regeneration

The complete cosmogonic arc from the primordial separation of light and darkness through the descent of the Divine Human into combat, the ordering of all spiritual states by Divine Providence, the purification of wisdom by the Third Emissary, and the final restoration in which the Divine is acknowledged as one sovereign over all. This single chapter serves as the overture to the entire teaching — every subsequent part elaborates on one phase of this primordial sequence.

The Arc of Regeneration from First to Last

Primary Teaching

The complete cosmogonic narrative in miniature: the primordial separation of wisdom and falsity, the eruption of evil's assault against the Divine, the descent of the Lord as Divine Truth ('First Man') clothed in protecting truths, the ordering of the mind by Divine Providence ('Living Spirit'), the purification by the Third Emissary, and the final state in which self-love is consumed, wisdom ascends, falsity is confined, and the Divine reigns as one. Every subsequent chapter elaborates one aspect of this arc.

[Concerning the] light [...] [...] [the] entire [land] of wisdom [and the] word in the beginning [and] concerning the separation [in] the heights [...] to the heights [...] and they spread out [...] until they should make war [against the] kingdom [of l]ight [that is] in the heights [separated f]rom all the aeons [of] the light, the one that no [darkness is] in it.

[And] the darkness, the world [and] their root [...] which poured forth [...] the one that the earth has [...] darkness [...] it is far from the light [...].

Each one of them exists [in its place] they are divided from one another by their [nature] in an eternality since the [beginning] (4) the Darkness has made war against the Light, desiring that it would reign over an essence not its own. It spread a quarrel [and] it disturbed [the boundary and] came up, it [was in this great] need.

The power came forth from [the Father of Greatness, which] is [the Fir]st Man. He [clothed himself with] the armour of light [against] all [the enmity]. He crucified it in [...] the armour [...].

[Then] he brought the sun [and the moon to] the light aeons [...] the Living Spirit spread out the universe [and] the earth [...] the light and the darkness in the beginning [...] and the garments. He gave [them ...] He set in order the [...] and the wheel of the course [...] in the heights, that they would [...] of the darkness. He stood firm [and f]ixed. He constructed the foundation [and] all of it was set up.

Underneath [...] all of them; and also above he [...] thre]e earths, they being conjoined. He enclosed the earth in [...] four mountains and three vessels [...] in its seas and its mountains [which he set in] order upon it. This universe stood firm [as] a bond for the evil powers [and for the purification of the li]ght that they joined with the darkness [...].

Then the Third Ambassador! [He purified the light] by his image. He became [redeemer of] all things.

[For] they are in all the [...] universe, and the fire blazes in it, and it is devoured [and] all [the portion] of the light also, and he becomes purifier, and goes up to his essence. Conversely, the darkness which is in [it comes] out, and it is gathered in to a bond [...] unveil [...] and they go in to him and become [...] perfume [...] set up [...] and they reign for ever, and a single God comes to be [and reigns ov]er the totality, being above the totality. You find no opponent from this time on against the Father, the King of the Light and the [...].

[These are the things] which they occur in, from the beginning [when] they are mixed and joined with one another.

Part 2

The Dual Architecture of Good and Evil

Establishes the fundamental symmetric structure upon which all subsequent teaching rests. The two natures — wisdom and falsity, celestial perception and self-intelligence — are shown to possess identical five-degree architectures, opposite in quality. Three divine attributes (blessedness, illumination, efficacy) pervade every plane. Four states of illumination mirror four states of obscurity. Four divine operations mirror four infernal ones. The five storehouses of darkness and the anatomy of the sovereign ruling evil are mapped in full. Together these chapters constitute the teaching's structural grammar.

The Two Trees and Their Five Faculties

Primary Teaching

The perception rooted in divine wisdom and the perception rooted in self-intelligence each possess five ascending degrees — identical in structure but opposite in quality. The good tree ascends from outermost reception through sustaining guidance, interior seeing, active understanding, to the Divine Itself. The bad tree descends from the rule of spiritual death through endless falsification, consuming self-love, empty forms, to a consolidated mass of evil. The core imperative: the ability to discriminate between them constitutes regeneration; failure constitutes spiritual death.

[These are] the intellectuals that are cloaked upon its body [of] this good tree. They are the light elements that are mingled, being compounded in the totality.

It has five limbs. [They are consideration, counsel, insight, thought, mind.] Its consideration is the holy church. [Its counsel] is the Pillar of Glory, the Perfect Man. [Its insight is the Fir]st Man who dwells in the ship of living waters. Its thought is the Third Ambassador [who dwells in] the ship of living fire, that shines in [the world] Also, the mind is the Father who dwells in greatness, who is perfect in the aeons of light.

It is consideration that shall [receive them, and] they shall be raised up [to what] is counsel; they shall be raised up to insight, which is the First Man who dwells in the ship of the night; from insight they shall rise up to thought, which is the Ambassador who dwells in the ship of the day. And he too, great glorious thought, shall bring them in to mind; which is the Father, the God of truth, the great Mind of all the aeons of glory.

[Also, the] bad [things that] happen in [the world] from [the bad tree] also [in] the way that it is [with] the good tree [so also the tree] of the fire [Also] they are the ruling-power [of] heaven and the wheel [Also] they are the five fleshs that walk [in the world. Their] fruit [is the te]aching as of error, the mystery that [was hidden, wh]ich Satan appointed in the world.

The bad tree has five limbs. They are consideration, counsel, insight, thought, mind. Its consideration is the law of death. Its counsel is transmigration [of the soul] in type after type. Also, its insight is the furnaces of fire [and the ge]henna; which is full of smoke. Thought [is the dark] vessel. Its mind is the [pit] the lump, the last bond, the [stone], they that Satan cast away [into] the great [fire] and they fall [into] the Darkness [and] all [...] and they take away [...] are swallowed in to the lump, and they are bound [in] the fruit of Darkness, the one that they [shall bear] for ever and ever [...] his face [...] will arrive at that place; and they have no repentance therein.

[The good tree is the Light] which lies in its good earth [full of life] and light; as death and Darkness do not exist [in it] Also, the bad tree is Matter [and Darkness wh]ich occurs in its bad earth [full of] Darkness and death.

He understands that they did not arise out of one another, nor did they come from one another. They did not come from one! The person who can separate them out may go up to the aeon of light.

Bad fruit did not arise from it [at any time]; but whoever will not separate out [the one] from one another, he falls to the land of Darkness [...] until he arrives at the [lump].

The Three Divine Attributes on Every Plane

Primary Teaching

Blessedness (reception of Good), illumination (reception of Truth), and efficacy (their conjunction in act) are present on every successive plane of the mind: in the inmost celestial degree, in the spiritual degree (with distinct vessels of love and truth), and in the natural degree where the constitutive elements of regenerate life are formed. The 'ships' are containing forms through which divine influx is received at each level.

[What] are these thr[ee things] that in the world are called 'happine[ss]', 'wisdom]', and 'power'?

[The happin]ess of the glorious one is the Father, the God of [truth, who] is established in the great land of [light]. His glorious wis[d]om is his Great Spirit that [reaches from above to] below, which flows through all his aeons, and t[h]ey float therein. His great power is all the gods, the rich ones and the angels who were summoned from him as they [came forth. They are] they that are called aeons [of the greatness].

[Again, these three exist in that] which is called the sun [it is the ship of] living fire, [in which dwells the Third Amba]ssador, the second greatne[ss of the ship. The] glorious [happiness] is the [Living] Spirit, [the first greatness; and the wisdom] is the Mother of Lif[e; and great power] is [all] the gods, [the] rich ones and the angels who are within the ship.

Again, [h]appiness, wisdom and power exist in the s[hip of liv]ing waters [that is called the moon] the happiness [in it is] the Mind of the Father. Also, wisdom [is the Vir]gin of [Li]ght. And the power that is [i]n the ship is [all] the go[ds], the [ri]ch ones and the angels who are established i[n it].

Again, these three exist in the elements: happiness, wis[d]om and power. The happiness is [the Pillar of Glory], the Perfect Man. Wisdom is the [five sons of the] Living Spirit; and great powe[r is the fi]ve sons of the First Man [all of them, who are encl]osed and compounded in the totality, that [they are in all of it] while he supports the totality.

Four States of Illumination and Four States of Obscurity

Primary Teaching

Four great states of divine illumination proceed from one another, each with twelve qualities: from the Divine Itself through the mediating Divine Wisdom, the sustaining pillar of Divine Truth, to Divine Wisdom made radiant. Correspondingly, four states of spiritual obscurity proceed from one another: from the realm of falsity through the proprium as fashioner of dead forms, through the corporeal realms of natural evil, to the ruling principle of evil in the natural mind. Each day and each night is elaborated with its twelve constituent qualities.

Four great days have come forth from one another; they were evoked out of one another!

The first great day is the Father, the God of truth, the fir[st one who dwells in the m]idst the aeons of his greatness, in his [l]iving kingdom. The twelve hours of this great day are the twelve great rich Gods of greatness. These, who are the first evocations that he evoked (to mirror) his greatness, he spread out to the four climes, three by three before his face.

The second day is the Third Ambassador, the one who dwells in the light ship. His twelve hours are the twelve virgins that he evoked in his greatness.

[The third day is the Pillar of Glory, the great porter that is greater than] all [the po]rters; the one that supports all [burdens], those above and those below. Its twelve hours are the five sons of the First Man; the five sons of the Living Spirit, who support all the weights of the universe; together with the summons and the obedience, which are counted to their ten brethren. These are the twelve light hours of the third day.

The fourth day is Jesus the Splendour. His twelve hours are the twelve wisdoms, which are his [light] h[o]u[rs].

These are the four great days that have come forth from one another, which were evoked out of one another.

[Again]: For just as four day[s ex]ist, s[o] too four nights exist.

The first night is the land of Darkness. It has twelve black [shadows] therein, which are its dark h[o]u[r[s]. The twelve shadows of the first night are the five elements of the land of Darkness, [which] poured forth from its five sense organs; and [...] which [dwell] in its [fi]ve elements and its five [sense organs]; the five [sp]irits that dwell in its elements [of Darkness]. These are the twelve shadows and spirits of the first night.

The second night is Matter, the sculptress [...] who has sculpted [the world] and the entire ruling-power that is in the worl[ds of Darkness]. She has fashioned it in five sense organs, five [male] and five female, two per world; together with the fire and the lust [that] dwell in men and women, inflaming [them] inward to one another. These are the twelve spirits of this second night.

Indeed she, this Matter, the thought of death, ga[ve] the King of the realms of Darkness and his powers strength for the war and the fight, against the aeons of greatness. Yet, he was caught! They laid a snare for him through the Fi[rst M]an. [He] was ta[ken] t[o ...] through the powers [of light. He] was brought up from the land of death and s[et ... ab]ove and below in the [whole] universe; in the five par[t]s in the heavens above, as well as the five [parts] in the earths below; together with the heat and the cold that are the father and the mother, their fire and their l[u]st.

This is the second night that is begotten from the first night. They laid a snare for her through the First M[a]n. She was brought up by the hand of the Living Spirit, and set in this composite univers[e ...]

he[r], above and below. The [upper side is the sense] organs of males; the lower side [is the sense organs of] fe[mal]es.

The thir[d night is the five] worlds of flesh [which are five] male, and five female; that were begotten from the powers [abo]ve. They have fallen upon the earth, being displayed in wh[at is d]ry and what is moist; together with the fire and the lust [that d]we[l]l in them, which drives them inward to one another.

[Mat]te[r] herself, the thought of death, is the [mother] of them all; as among them she is named 'the night'. [The worlds] of male and female flesh, together with the fire and the l[ust], shall [be the] twelve hours of [the third] night. Again, [it] too, the third night that is in the worlds of fl[e]sh, was begotten from the second night; which the Living [Spir]it crucified in the uni[verse, both ab]ove and below in heaven [and in the earth].

The fourth night is the law of Sin, which is the dark spirit who speaks in the twelve spirits. They are the nakednesses, the twelve zodiacal signs of Matter. They are her thrones.

The hours of this fourth night are the twelve e[vi]l spirits; the [signs] which [are] differentiate the day and night [in the land of] death.

This is the fourth night [and these are the four nights] that have come forth of one another. One has [come forth from the other] just like the days of lig[ht came forth] they manifested one another. So als[o the nights] they did arise out of one another.

Four Divine Operations and Four Infernal Operations

Primary Teaching

Four active divine operations descend to draw forth wisdom and life from their captivity in falsity: the First Man confronting evil directly, the Third Emissary drawing forth by its radiant form, Divine Wisdom seeking wisdom and life, and comprehensive providence gathering all into the Last Statue. Four infernal operations mirror these: the ruler of falsity ensnaring through self-love, the counterfeit spiritual ascent that binds in self-merit, concupiscence operating through every faculty, and the animating principle of falsity itself.

There are four hunters who were sent from the light to fulfill the will of the greatness.

The first hunter is the First Man who was sent from the greatness. He threw himself down to the five storehouses of Darkness, he caught and siezed the enmity [and bound it in] his net also [he cast it] out over all the children of Darkness [and ensnared them all]. His ship is his four sons who are swathed over his body. The sea is the land of Darkness [into which he descended]; his net is [his soul] and his powers.

The second hunter is the Third Ambassador. This one, for by his light image, which he revealed to the depths below, he hunted after the entire light that is in all things; as it is established in them. His net is his light image, [which he cast over] the whole universe and took it prisoner, to this likeness [of the light] ship is his light ship. [The sea] is the universe [and its lights] which were hunted after by his net [which is] his [glorious] image.

The third hunter is Jesus the Splendour, who came from the greatness, who hunts after the light and life; and he [raises] it to the heights. His net is his wisdom, [the] light wisdom with which he hunts the souls, catching them in the net. The sea is the error of the universe, the souls that are drowning in it [and perishing]. He catches them in his net. They are the souls [that he purifies th]em by his light wisdom.

The fourth hunter is the great counsel that [encompasses all] that lives in the circuit [of the] entire universe in it today. Yet, at the end, in the dissolution of the universe, this very counsel of life will gather itself in and sculpt its soul in the Last Statue. Its net is its Living Spirit, because with its Spirit it can hunt after the light and the life that is in all things; and build it upon its body. Its ship, in which it is established, is this light cloud whereby it itself travels in the five elements [of light. Its sea is], the great fire that will burn all the buildings of [the darkness. And what is caught] in its net is the light and the life. It can rescue and free it from all bonds and fetters.

The first hunter is the King of they who belong to the Darkness, who hunted after the living soul with his net at the beginning of the worlds. His net is his fire and his lust that he has put upon the living soul, with which he has entangled it [in bondage], through all his powers.

[The] second hunter is the evil counsel that lives in [the body] that hunts after the light [and the life] and [draws them] up from [the depths of] the earths to heaven. It binds them with its powers, which bring them to the heavenly worlds above. Its net is [its cunning] whereby they are drawn up from the abyss [to the heig]hts.

The third hunter is lust [which] walks in every power of the flesh that walks [abroad] in the [forms of] the living souls [it ensnares and binds] them in its bodies, which [are bonds and fetters upon them].

The fourth [hunter is the spirit] of Darkness.

The Five Origins of Evil and the Anatomy of Its Ruler

Primary Teaching

Five origins of evil have existed from the beginning, generating five fundamental forms, five perverted perceptions, and five genera of evil affections. The ruling evil possesses five shapes (lust for dominion, demonic evil, predatory rationality, falsification, base corporeal knowing), five properties (absence of wisdom, corruption, deformity, torment, consuming self-love), and three further qualities (obstinacy, magic arts of persuasion, limited external awareness). Each of the five infernal states has its own ruler, body (metal), and taste (mode of appropriation).

Five storehouses have arisen since the beginning in the land of darkness! The five elements poured out of them. Also, from the five elements were fashioned the five trees! Again, from the five trees were fashioned the five genera of creatures in each world, male and female. And the five worlds themselves have five kings therein, and five spirits, five bodies, five tastes; in each world, they not resembling one another!

The King of the world of Smoke [is the one] who came up from the depth of darkness; this is he who is the head of all wickedness, and all malignity. The beginning of the spread of the war occurred through him; all the battles, fights, quarrelling, dangers, destructions, fights, wrestling-contests! That is the one who first made arise danger and war, with his worlds and his powers. Afterwards, also, he waged war with the light. He pitched a battle with the exalted kingdom.

Now, regarding the King of Darkness, there are five shapes on him! His head is lion-faced; his hands and feet are demon- and devil-faced; his shoulders are eagle-faced; while his belly is dragon-faced; his tail is fish-faced. These five shapes, the marks of his five worlds, exist on the King of the realms of Darkness!

Now, there are five other properties in him. The first is his darkness. The second is his putridity. The third is his ugliness. The fourth is his bitterness, his own soul. The fifth is his burning, which burns like an iron () as if poured out from fire.

[There are] also three others in him! The first, that his body is hard and very tough, even as she has formed him [fierce and] cruel-hearted; namely Matter, who is the thought of death, [the o]ne who sculpted him from the nature of the land of darkness. This is the manner of the body of the ruler of Smoke. He is harder than every iron, copper and steel and lead; as there is no cleaver at all, nor any iron implement, can [pierce] him and cut him. For Matter, his fashioner, has formed him [to be] strong and hard.

The second, that he wounds and kills by the word of his magic arts. His recitation and hearing, all his foolish instruction, make magic and invocations for him. When it pleases him, he can make an invocation over himself, and by his magic arts be hidden from his companions. Again, when it pleases him, he can be manifested over his powers and appear to them.

The third, that the King of the realms of Darkness knows the converse and language of his five worlds. He understands every thing he hears from their mouths, as they address one another; each one of them in his language. [Every] design they will consider against him, every snare they debate with one another to bring upon him, he knows them! He can also understand the gesturing they signal between one another. Yet, his powers and his rulers, who are subject to him, can not understand his wordy converse. While all these things are unveiled to him; still, their heart is not manifested to him. He knows not their mind nor their thought; he can not ponder their beginning and their end. Rather, he only knows and apprehends what is before his eyes.

Also, another different thing is found in the King of the realms of Darkness! For when it pleases him to move, he spreads all his limbs out and walks. When it comes to mind, he with[d]raws his limbs and takes them in, and is rolled (?) to his companions; and he falls to the ground like a grape and a great iron ball! He terrifies by his cry, he is frightful. He frightens his powers with his sound; because when he speaks, being like thunder in the clouds, he resembles the [crashing] of the rocks [in the mountains] When he cries out and [roars] and calls [with his voice] over his powers, they shall tremble and to[tt]er a]nd fall under foot; even as some birds would be [frightened by] the bird [... / ...] and they fall down to the earth. Still, this thing only: he knows not what is far from him, he sees not who is at a distance, nor does he hear him. Rather, whoever is before his face he sees, hearing him and knowing him.

These signs and these evil marks are found in the chief of the demons and fiends, the King of all the mountains of Darkness [He is the one] to [whom] the land of darkness has given birth, begotten in its cruelty, in its wickedness and its wrath [against the light].

[He has all these] more than all his fellow rulers, who are in all his worlds.

Gold is the body of the King of the realms of Darkness. The body of all the powers who belong to the world of Smoke is gold. And also, the taste of its fruits is salty.

In contrast, the King of the worlds of Fire is lion-faced, the foremost of all the beasts. Copper is his body. Again, the body of all the rulers who belong to Fire is copper. Their taste is the sour taste that is in every form.

Again, the King of the worlds of Wind is eagle-face. His body is iron. Also, the body of all they who belong to the Wind is iron. Their taste is the sharp taste that is in every form.

For his part, the King of the world of Water is fish-face. His body is silver. All the other rulers who belong to Water, silver is their body. Also, the taste of their fruit is the sweetness of water, the sweet taste that is in every (form).

Again, [the Kin]g of the world of Darkness is a dragon. His [body is lead] and tin. All the other rulers [who belong to the world of] Darkness, their body is lead and tin. And also, the taste of their fruits is bitterness.

Part 3

The Descent of Divine Influx

Traces how the one Divine Love makes itself receivable across successive discrete degrees — from the Infinite Itself through five originating principles of good, through ten vehicles of containment, through five modes of spiritual conjunction (peace, power, love, humility, authority), through fourteen states of wisdom, down to the divine source of each particular faculty and the five powers that awaken the soul. This part is the spiritual anatomy of how the Divine flows into the human mind.

Five Degrees of Originating Good

Primary Teaching

Five originating degrees of good proceed one from another: the Infinite Divine Love, the Mediating Divine Principle, the Glorified Divine Wisdom, the Interior Illumination of Understanding, and the Spiritual Form in which truth is received and made visible. Each degree brings forth its own trinity of derivative powers. The five fathers are not separate beings but successive accommodations by which the one Divine Love makes itself receivable, from its infinite origin into the form that receives the departing soul at death.

Five fathers exist; they were summoned forth one of one. [Also], one did come out of another!

The first Father is the Father of Greatness, the blessed one of glory, the [on]e who has no measure to his greatness; who also is the first only-begotten, the first eternal; who exists with fiv[e fa]thers for ever; the one who exists before every thing that has existed, and that will exist.

Now he, the glorious Father, summoned from him three emanations. The [fi]rst is the Gre[at] Spirit, the first Mother, who came out of the Father. She appeared first.

The seco[nd i]s the Belo[ved of] the Lights, the great glorious Beloved, [the one w]ho is honour[ed; w]ho came out of the Father. [He ma]nifested ou[t of h]im.

The third father is the Thir[d Ambassador], the eldest of [all] the counsell[ors; who came out of] the first Father. He appeared.

This is the first Father, the first power, the one from whom the three great powers came out. This is the first Father, the first eternal, the root of all the lights; from whom the three emanations came out. They have humiliated the Darkness. They have brought its heart's desire to naught. They have given themselves the victory. They have also given the victory to their aeons.

The second father, who came out of the first Father, is the Third Ambassador, the model of the King of lights. And again, he too summoned and sent out of him three powers.

One is the Pillar of Glory, the Perfect Man; the one who bears up under all things; the great Pillar of blessing; the great porter, who is greater than all the porters.

The second is glorious Jesus the Splendour; [the] one through whom shall be given life eternal.

The third is the Virgin of Light, the glorious wisd[om]; the one who takes away the heart of the [rul]ers and the powers by her image, as she fulfils the pleas[u]re of the greatness.

The third father, who came out of the second father: he is glorious Jesus the Splendour. And, again, he too summoned three evocations after the pattern of the second father.

The first power whom he summoned is the Light Mind.

The second power whom Jesus summo[n]ed is the gre[at Jud]ge, who gives judgement on all the souls of mankind, [his] dwelling being established in the atmosphere under [... / ...] wheel [and the] stars.

The third power is [the Y]outh, the gre[at and glorious] light in his two persons, in [...] that which has been established in the summons [and] the obedience.

The fourth father is the Light Mind. And, again, he too summoned three powers after the pattern of Jesus.

The first power is the Apostle of Light.

The second is the counterpart, who shall come to the apostle and appear to him, becoming companion to him, sticking close to him everywhere; and providing help to him all the time, from all afflictions and dangers.

The third is the Light Form.

And also the fifth father is this Light Form; the one who shall appear to everyone who will go out from his body, corresponding to the pattern of the image to the apostle; and the thr[ee] great glorious angels who are come with her.

One (angel) ho[ld]s the prize in his hand. The second bears the light garment. The third is the one who possesses the diadem and the wreath and the crown of light. These are the three angels of light, the ones who shall come with this Light Form.

These are the five fathers who have come out of one another. They have appeared and man[ifes]ted through one another!

Ten Vehicles of Divine Truth

Primary Teaching

When Divine Truth descended into the planes of human consciousness, it assumed ten successive degrees of containment: the vessel of pure Divine Wisdom, the vessel of the celestial human, the upright axis of Divine Good, the Divine calling, the good of obedience, the living sphere of spiritual perception, the living influx of the spirit, illumination, living truth that purifies, and Divine Love itself — the inmost fire above all other degrees.

When Jesus the Son of Greatness came to these worlds, at the time that he unveiled the greatness, he boarded ten vehicles. He journeyed in the universe by them.

The first vehicle is the light ship, since he received instructions from the Ambassador there.

The second carriage is the ship of the First Man, since his dwelling is established there.

The third is the Pillar of Glory, the Perfect Man, since he shone forth there. He came below, he appeared in the world.

The fourth is the summons that he clothed upon his body. The fifth is the obedience that he swathed upon the summons.

The sixth is the living air, and since he assumed it too, he received anointment there. The seventh is the living wind that blows. The eighth is the light that illuminates. The ninth is the living water. The tenth is the living fire that is above them all.

He was journeying in these ten carriages among all the orders and all the [aeons], those above and those below.

Five Modes of Spiritual Conjunction

Primary Teaching

Five essential modes of spiritual conjunction — interior peace, communicated power, the union of affections, humble acknowledgment, and the transmission of authority — originated in the Divine and were carried by the Celestial Human into temptation-combat. Each mode operates both in the descent into combat and in the ascent after victory. The deepest teaching: the peace given in the descent is the same peace that attends the ascent — the Divine conjunction passes through temptation unbroken.

This peace and this greeting that occur in the world, [from w]hom [did they come fo]rth? Or likewise, the right hand that occurs in [the world, it being h]onoured by mankind, of whom is it? Or the mystery of the kiss that they embrace one another with, [of whom is it]? Or who is the one that reveals this salutation with which they make obeisance to one another? Or this laying on of hands, which an immensely great one bequeaths upon his inferior, giving him an honour and making him great; of whom is this laying on of hands?

These five signs are the mystery of the First Man. He came forth with them from the aeon of light. Also, when he finished his contest, he went up with these good signs. They received him into the aeons of light.

The first peace is the one that the gods and the angels in the land of light gave to the First Man; when he comes out against the enemy. The gods and the angels were walking with him; escorting him, giving to him their peace and power, and their blessing and fortification. This is the first peace that the gods and the angels gave to the First Man; as he comes forth from the aeon of light.

The first right hand is the one that the Mother of Life gave to the First Man; when he comes out to the contest.

The first kiss is this one with which the Mother of Life embraced the First Man; as he separates from her, coming down to the contest. Even all the gods and the angels who are in the aeons of light were making to embrace him! [...] all of them also, and the church tutelaries (?), and the kinsfolk who belong to the household of his people. They were making to embrace him as [he] separates from them, accompanying him out, embracing him with the kiss of affection and love.

The first salutation is the salutation with which the First Man made obeisance; when he comes out [to the depths] below. He was bending his knees, making obeisance to the God of truth, and all the aeons [of light] who belong to the household of his people; entreating them for a power to escort him, as he comes forth.

The first laying on of hands is the one that the Mother of Life bequeathed upon the head of the First Man. She armed him and made him mighty. She laid hands on him, and sent him to the battle. He descended. He completed his struggle with the great powers and the enmity.

By the [se] five signs and these five myst[e]ri[es] the First Man came forth from the aeons of light against the enemy. He humbled him. He was victorious against him by them.

Also, when he ascended from the war, he came in to the kingdom of the household of his people by these five mysteries!

The peace with which [he ascen]ded is the peace that the summons gave to him, [w]hen it was sent forth from the [Fa]ther of Life. It gave him the peace in the world of darkness. Also, that peace with which he descended is th[e sam]e as the one with which he ascended from the struggle!

This second right hand is the one that the Living Spirit gave the First Man, when he [brou]ght him upward out from the struggle.

This second kiss is the one with which the [Father o]f Life and the Mother of the living embraced the First Man, when he ascended from the struggle.

[The] second salutation with which the First Man made obeisance [again at] time to the God of truth and [before all] the blessed aeons and al[l] the aeons [in the] whole [land] of light, whe[n] the Father of Life and the Mother of the living brought the Man upward from the abyss of the struggle.

The second laying on of hands is this: When the Living Spirit brought the First Man upward from the war, he saved him from all the surging waves. He brought him upward, he gave him ease in the great aeons of light, which belong to the household of his people. He set [him] firmly before the Father, the Lord of the totality. He received this great laying on of hands that he may become leader of his brethren in the new aeon.

These five mysteries and these five signs came about first in the divine. these mysteries were not at the beginning amongst the powers of Darkness.

At the time of their coming forth, the Light Form shall come forth before them; and she redeems them from the darkness to the light [and from death to the life.] This Light Form calms the person, with the kiss and her quiet, from fear of the demons w[ho de]stroy his body. By her asp[ec]t and her image [the] heart of the elect one, who is come forth from his bo[d]y, shall be calm for [him]. Afterwards, the angel who h[o]lds the victory prize extends to him the right hand. And it draws him out of the abyss of his body, and accepts him in with the [k]iss and love. That soul shall make obeisance to its red[ee]mer, who is this Light Form.

Fourteen States of Divine Wisdom and the Source of Each Faculty

Primary Teaching

Fourteen principal states of divine wisdom subsist in the interior ground of the will: the five essential faculties of perception together with divine communication and reception (making seven), plus the five truths from the Lord's operative power and their two origins (making another seven). Then a catalogue of first principles: each paragraph names the Divine source from which a specific faculty descends — Love as origin, Truth as proceeding form, Mediation as accommodation, Combat as temptation-resistance, Building as ordering, Sustaining as upholding, Deliverance as liberation, Pure Wisdom as uncorrupted perception, Enlightened Understanding as the gatherer of scattered goods.

What are the [f]ourteen grea[t a]eons of light?

The [gods of light] below abide in fourteen [great aeons of light]: the five elements, the sons of the First Man, together with the call and the hearing. They anoint them, living in them. These shall make seven, five plus two.

[Also the] f[ive s]ons of the Living Spirit who [support] all [the wei]ght of the universe; together with the [Li]vi[ng] Spirit [and the Fir]st Man, their fathers. [These also are seven] by which the universe is established.

[There are four]teen aeons of light [that abide] [within the la]nd that is not revealed. This land [in which all the aeons abide is made firm and is estab]lished. They bore up under the enemy [and they were not overcome for no one of the darkness equa]ls them. The hidden plenitude that [abides in] the Ambassador who came from the Father, the [great luminary] He came and stood firm in the midst of these [aeons of light]: he is called the good father of [all] the ae[ons and gods] who are holy and conjoined. He has become leader and a great king after the likeness of the first Father, the lord of all these cou[nse]ls. This universe is held together by their will [from the beginning] to the end of all things.

The beginning of every good grace is the great Father of the [ligh]ts; since [a]ll [graces] are given by his hand.

The beginning of each blessing and every prayer is the Mother of [L]ife, the first Holy Spirit.

Also, [the] beginning [of] every good [co]unsel is the T[h/i]rd Am[bassad]or, the king of the glorious realm that lies in this [wo]rld, [the image] of the King of the lights.

The beginning of [all glory and] each [hono]ur (?) is the Beloved of the Lights, who is honour[ed.].

The beginning of all [the trappers] and hunters is the First [Man].

[The beginning] of all fighters is [the] Living [Spirit], the Father of Life, who has distribu[ted about] his five sons from place to place.

The beginning of all the archit[e]cts and builders is the Great Builder, who is glorious.

Also, the first of all the porters of the gr[e]a[t]ness is the Pillar of Glory [the Perfect Man] [...].

The beginning of [all] the deliverers [is Jesus the Splendour]; or the one who delivers, as he frees whoever belongs [to him] from his words.

The beginning of every wisdom of truth is the Virgin of Light, [..].

The beginning of all [the great]est honoured ones [and of all knowledge] is the Light Mind; who is the awakene[r of them] who sleep, the gatherer in of the ones who are sc[at]tered.

Five Powers of Awakening and Five States of Instruction

Primary Teaching

Five powers of spiritual awakening progressively raise the regenerating mind: the Divine Truth proceeding, the Divine Wisdom as intermediary, the Divine Love as origin, the Divine Wisdom within the understanding, and the Divine Love in its foundational aspect that unveils the Divine image and draws all regenerated affections into conjunction. Also teaches five essential states of spiritual instruction known in the natural mind: peace, silence, day (full illumination), and others whose names are lost.

[The first resurrector is the Living Spirit, who awakens] it therein [and raises it up].

The second resurrector is [the Mother of Life].

And the third resurrector is the Father, the First [Man], because by his word shall all lives [arise and] gather in and go to him, and they receive [life] and rest.

The fourth resurrector is the Light Mind, because [it awakens the soul from forgetfulness].

The fifth resurrector to the good [souls] is the Father, the First established one [from the beginning]. [He encompasses] all the powers, and he stands firm [over all things]. He shall unveil the [image] over them [in that day], and he draws them to him [by his love], his will [and his mercy], and he [purifies] them, and he stands them up [in his light] there, and they remain until [the end of all things].

The five [le]sso[ns] that [a]re proclaimed in the [wo/r]ld, [one] being cal[le]d [by name] 'the peace', another called '[the] silence', [and] another 'the day', ano[ther ...].

[As for] the gatherer in [... ...] then he shall cau[se] the body [to cease from] all the lusts of the world [and the deeds] of the body in righteousness [This] is the Pill[a]r of Gl[or]y [through which the light ascends] because [it bears] [all things] up to the [land of light].

The one they call ['the peace'] it is the [Fi]rst [M]an who dwel[ls i]n the ship of living waters [of the] light [and also] he is c[alled] 'the life' that they have [received] glorious [...].

[The one they cal]l it 'day' [of the] universe as they shall [find rest] in the great aeon [The lights that] are spread in the universe, it is [the light] established in the [aeon of light] and the so[u]ls [that dwell therein].

Part 4

The Work of Redemption

Describes the progressive stages of divine intervention against evil: how spiritual death propagated through five stages, how five degrees of divine operation overcame it, how each divine principle (the Celestial Human, Divine Truth in judgment, the Emissary, Divine Wisdom, the counsel of life) accomplished its particular advent, how the entire process unfolds across three great spiritual epochs, and how five wars and five liberations progressively freed wisdom from its captivity in falsity.

The Propagation of Spiritual Death

Primary Teaching

Spiritual death propagated through five stages: first it stirred what was latent in the lowest natural mind; then the five genera of spiritual death (obscurity, self-love, false persuasion, falsity, absence of truth) welled up; these were given fixed form; evil works proceeded from five perverted perceptions; finally death extended into ten aspects (five of active will, five of receptive understanding). The twelve complete aspects of evil arose in opposition to the Divine Humanity.

The two essences [of Light and Darkness] Did Death arise and stand firm [...] up? Or else did it turn itself from [...] its armour [...] in its [...] but it finished [mixing] the two [essences].

[...] It moved it and [aroused] they that are in the [depths] of the earth of Darkness [this is the] first part.

Yet, after a long time, as there was not [rest], it gushed and streamed up [...] the five elements of Death that gushed [forth] which are smoke, fire, wind, water and darkness [...] the second time [...] they were sculpted [into] those in which Death was established [this is the third part].

The fourth part is the evil fruits [that are] in the five trees that are in the five worlds of the land of Darkness.

The fifth time it spread itself out to its creatures that exist in the five worlds; the ones that were formed and generated from the five fruits of Death. They are the five worlds of flesh, the five creations of Darkness in which Death has been established. It spread itself out to ten parts, five male parts and five female [parts].

Now, like the land of Darkness, in that its spirit and its [soul] they nourished the five elements [of Darkness]; this is also [how] the ten parts that are in male and female, the fire and lust of the flesh [bound] them, as they yoke them with one another [until] they were established against the First Man. This is [the condemnation] of the Darkness, it was condemned for ever.

Alongside the mystery of these twelve parts that came about in the Darkness [and were established] against the First Man. The twelve [parts are] the twelve spirits of error that came about from the twelve signs of the zodiac [...].

Five Degrees of Divine Operation Against Evil

Primary Teaching

Evil was overcome by five degrees of divine operation: the Divine Itself in infinite peace, the proceeding of divine spiritual life with the celestial human, the divine love of all wisdom with the governing truth, divine providence with the sustaining power, and divine illuminating wisdom with all its emanations. These were distributed in fives and established in a totality of twelve, with two further principles — the calling of truth and its reception — appointed as continuing presences.

[...] The Darkness, it was defeated by five greatnesses.

The first greatness is the Father of Greatness who exists in calm and hiddenness; as he is established in his light-earth, in his own essence.

Four greatnesses were manifested and came forth of him. They were appointed to ten parts, and established in total twelve.

The second greatness poured out and was manifested. It was revealed from the first greatness. It is the Mother of Life, the Great Spirit, together with the First Man and his five sons; these are the second greatness.

The third greatness is the Beloved of the Lights, the Great Builder, the Living Spirit, and the five sons of the Living Spirit. These are the third greatness.

The fourth greatness is the Third Ambassador, and the Pillar of Glory, and all the light powers who were revealed from him. These are the fourth greatness.

The fifth greatness who came from the Father is Jesus the Splendour, and all his powers whom he summoned, his emanations who were [revealed from him] They poured out and were manifested from him.

This is, so that they were spread out and [established in] fives: these five [sons] of the First Man [who support] the entire building; another five are the five sons of the Living Spirit who are spread out to five places, supporting [all things].

[...] Total in twelve parts that [... There are] another two added to them who are the summons and the obedience. They are the father and the mother whom Jesus the Splendour by his advent has appointed as successors to his place [over] the great earth and the [light] in them.

The Advents of the Divine Powers

Primary Teaching

Each divine principle accomplished its particular advent: the Celestial Human descended like a noble son surrounded by enemies, prevailing through humility; Divine Truth in judgment came like a righteous judge rendering to each according to deserts; Divine Providence came like a sovereign inspecting ordered works; Divine Illuminating Wisdom came to uproot false perceptions and plant genuine ones, reaching the first humans and ascending; the counsel of life mixed with the elements in silence, bearing all things until the Last Statue. Extended similes illuminate each advent.

[The advent also] of the First Man who came [is like a man] belonging to [his father] existing in a kingdom [of great] esteem before they who belong to his household [...] his enemies [surrounded him] and suffering by their wickedness; and they take from him [his glory] and a richness; and they imprison [him in] captivity and take from him their companies (?). Yet, he [prevailed] by his humility; and he takes heart and restrains his enemy [...] in silence.

Just as with this man, this noble son whose enemies surround him, this also is how the advent of the First Man happened, [among the] rulers, the enemies of the light.

In contrast, the advent of the Living Spirit and the commandment that he received, whereby he came upon all the rulers, it differs from that of the First Man. His advent [is not like] the advent of the First Man.

The advent of the Living Spirit is like this, when he was sent from the greatness that he might bring up the First Man. He resembles a judge the king would send to overturn the violence to that man, the noble son against whom his enemies sinned. And he, this judge, [he is] hard and cruel [...] and he gives the means [to that man] by his righteousness and his strength; and he also judges all who are condemned according to their rebellious heart, and repays each according to his deserts. They who are worthy of blows he strikes with hard leather whips. Again, these who are worthy of cutting off their limbs, or indeed their [heads] and he repays them accordingly. [...] and he binds and fetters them, and hangs by [their feet] and thus he does to them with a righteous judgement. And he kills them to flay their skin [from them] so that they will be killed by a death [...] until they die. Again, [they for] whom it is fitting [...] to banish from their dwellings he may remove according to a righteous judgement; just as they had faulted and sinned against the noble son.

Also, the associates in the mystery and the assistants of this judge, these who belong to him in great strength; in an instant and haste they shall do the will of their master.

Now, just as this genuine judge, who was sent from the king to overturn the violence to this man, the noble son: this is also the case with the Living Spirit. He also was sent from the King of the lights to overturn the vengeance and violence to the First Man, against whom the King of the realms of Darkness had sinned. He faulted and sinned against him, and also his rebellious powers. Therefore, when (the Living Spirit) came, he bore up the First Man.

Also, all the rulers, the powers of sin who had faulted and sinned against the sons of the First Man, he has judged them according to a righteous judgement. He has bound them in heaven and earth. He put each one to the place fitting for him; he weighed each of them according to his cruelty and oppression. While some of them he enclosed in the prison, others he hung head down. Some [of them] are crucified, others are sat down all the time. Some among them are fixed beneath their associates, restricted by a strong chain; others he made the holders of authority over their companions beneath, so that they may do their pleasure amongst these below them.

When the Father of Life established the judgements [upon them] He was revealed to all the powers of Darkness. He judged them as a true giver of judgement [...] This is the first judgement that the Living Spirit gave the rulers [in respect of the] First Man. Indeed, he gave victory to the First Man corresponding to his victory; but he condemned the King of the realms of Darkness corresponding to that by which he had erred.

[...] This chain, of this sort, became [fixed in] the earth till the end time when the universe will be dissolved; and it perishes in the great fire and is separated. While the light goes to its country, the Darkness remains in the chain and fetter for ever.

The advent also of the Third Ambassador, when he came to inspect they who are imprisoned in the zone: he is like a great king who comes and inspects craftsmen [...] and [architects] and [artisans].

Also, they who are good, of the craftsmen and architects and artisans whom he has there in each place: he shall see that they have worked well, and have fallen to his works in their fashion. He shall rejoice with great joy [over them] He shall thank the artisans who have constructed his works [and completed] his orders.

Now, just as this great king who comes and inspects his works and fortifications, so also is the advent of the Third Ambassador. For, when he too came, he saw [his works] established and prepared and [also the] series of the rulers prepared and established there, above and below, outside and within, in the great pattern that his brothers had made. They had come before him to the contest, they who had fixed and created the universe before he came. He saw the gods and the angels established and controlling the fortifications [...] guarding the entire ruling-power [...] which his first powers had done. They are the First Man and the Living Spirit and the Great Spirit, the Mother of Life.

Therefore, when he saw them, that they had created everything with great wisdom, [...] as they looked he plundered (?) [...] in his advent, by which he came, he was unveiled to them. He says to the Living Spirit: "The judgement that you have [given is] good, what you uttered [is just] you gave to them correspondingly; so that they were moved and raised up to that of which they were not worthy".

The advent also of Jesus the Splendour, the time when he came to all [things] being just like a man if he is sent to pull out a [bad tree and] burn a difficult fig-garden with fire. Therefore, again, when he has first cut the bad trees with his axe and has pulled out [their roots] and their body with his fire, so that they should not return to sprout from this time, nor bear fruit bad to eat [any more].

Afterwards, he also planted good plants: the tree of life that will make good fruit.

Again, this is like this simile of the advent of Jesus the Splendour. It happened like this; because he too set out [...] his power and his wisdom, in his [righteous]-ness [...] a king and a saviour [...] in his glorious wisdom he destroyed them. He bound and crushed them like the fire that shall burn and destroy trees. This is also how he performed his will in the zone, among the many powers, until he reached the form of the flesh of Adam and Eve, the first humans. [He perfected] his will in Eve, he [enlightened her] He also gave hope to Adam, and the good news [of the] glorious [kingdom] He went up to the heights [of the aeons] of light.

Then the summons and the obedience, the great counsel that came to the elements, which are set in conjunction: it mixed with them, it was established in silence. It bears up [all things] until the end time when it can arise and stand firm in the great fire. It will gather to it its own soul, and sculpt it in the Last Statue. You will also find it sweeps out and casts from it the pollution that is foreign to it. However, the life and the light that are in all things it gathers in to it, and builds upon its body.

The time when this Last Statue will be perfect in all its limbs, then it can become free and ascend from that great struggle through the Living Spirit its father, the one who comes and brings a [...] limb. He brings it up from within this gathering (?), the melting down and destruction of all things.

Now, this counsel, that summons and obedience, resembles thus cooled butter. If a person will take and set it in hot milk, it melts down and soaks in with this hot milk. It melts in another time in silence and quiet to the midst [of the milk] yet also, of the power and the taste of this milk [...] is drawn to (the butter), and (the milk) sets and becomes cold [...] in [...] and the [...] this milk it shall clarify and discard. However, the oil and the grease and the 'beauty' of the milk it shall gather in to it.

Again, this too is what the advent of that thought is like, the counsel of life, which is the summons and obedience that came to the elements. This is the one that at the end can arise and stand firm, and will gather in to it all the lives, and the light that has remained behind in everything. It can build them upon its body; it will gather them in to it [and sculpts them] in its image for ever and ever [...] from this time.

Three Great Spiritual Epochs

Primary Teaching

The entire work of redemption unfolds across three epochs: from the descent of celestial love into the hells to its restoration (the longest epoch), from the restoration through the ordering of all spiritual states (the shortest), and from the revelation of the divine likeness to the final consummation and the rising of the complete regenerated human. The first epoch exceeds all others in depth and duration because the celestial love endured through innumerable states of temptation in the realm of falsity.

From the time when the light came forth and was crucified in the darkness, to the season when the Statue will ascend and the entire light, which was conjoined with the darkness, will be purified and cleansed. From that time on, from that time to the season of the end totals three seasons.

Three seasons: from the time when the First Man went down to the abyss, and waged the war and the struggle against the King of the realms of Darkness and his other powers. He was victorious, while his sons remain behind with them in the worlds [of darkness, and they were mixed] in the [darkness] until he shall catch all of them [back and] he bound them all up, so that not one of them escaped his hand. He won a great victory [over all the powers of darkness] The First Man spent human lifetimes and generations in the land of darkness, until he prevailed [over them and] he fulfilled the will of the greatness that was commanded of him.

Then they sent the Living Spirit, the Father of Life. He brought the First Man up from the struggle, he brought him up to the land of light. This is the first period, from the descent of the First Man to his ascent.

The second season is from the time when the First Man ascended. The Living Spirit came, and the Mother of Life. They set in order the things of the universe, they set up [all things] the Father of Life and the Mother of the living set in order [the things of] the universe, up to the moment when they go out [from it] it was reckoned to the second season.

[After] the universe [was established] the Third Ambassador spread [his image] that is in the [ships of the] living; he [called the living and] he separated beauty from all the powers and scooped it up to the heights, he swept the waste to the abyss, and he [separated the light from the darkness] Now, from the moment when the Ambassador revealed his image he purified the light. Sin spurted up towards him. He hid his image. Sin came [forth] from the darkness. It sculpted the trees and the abortions fell down. Afterwards they sculpted Adam and Eve in the flesh. Until the moment when Jesus was sent and he [came to Adam] as he performed there his will. He gave the hope to Adam, and ascended to the heights.

Now, from the time when the Ambassador displayed his image until the season when the Statue will ascend at the end, shall be reckoned to the third season.

[Nothing] lasts long in the time that the First Man spent in the world of Darkness. It is a very great count of time, more than the (other) two seasons!

The first season, which the First Man spent in the world of Darkness, is how much longer than the time that this universe has been? While it is established?

If you should say that [it exceeds the universe ten times] it is small, if you should [... ...] to him [again] and you consult [him] you will tell him: Twenty times! It is greater again in this other one that you will consult: Thirty times! Less also is this other one [... ...] people will receive the [fruit] of the trees [... ...] the years and the generations [from the] earth to the heights. This is [the first season].

This is the third period, from the time when the Ambassador revealed his image until the Statue will ascend from the lump. It again, that time, is greater than the intermediate; but it does not come equal to the time of the First Man. For this intermediate season, in which the Father of Life and the Mother of Life constructed the universe with its orders, is shorter than that of the First Man.

Great is the period of the First Man! It lasts longer than the season in which the Ambassador displayed his image, until the dissolution of the world and the Statue ascends. From the time too when the Ambassador displayed his image, until the dissolution of the universe [is greater than the time] when the Father of Life and the Mother of Life shaped the universe.

These are the [great] three periods of time that occur.

Five Wars of Light Against Darkness

Primary Teaching

Five spiritual combats progressively overcame falsity: the primordial Divine Good ensnared evil through its encompassing truth; Divine Truth proceeding established heavenly order and imprisoned falsity; Divine Truth made visible drew forth wisdom from all created things; Divine Truth in its fullness and glory subdued the great rebellion; and Divine Providence completed the work by calling forth truth and its reception, achieving eternal victory.

The sons of light waged five wars against the sons of darkness. The sons of light humiliated the sons of darkness in them all.

The first war is that of the First living Man, which he waged against the King of the realms of Darkness, and all the rulers that had come forth from the five worlds of [darkness]. He hunted them with his net, which is the living soul. He [caught them] in the snare and [revealed] the face of the [soul] his virgin, the living fire [and] they did not find how to escape his net [and] he caught them like fish [in the sea] the five counsels of the five elements [of darkness]. He cut and dug out the root of the five trees, [and the] root of the evil tree, like an axe.

The second war is that of the Living Spirit [...]. He has constructed the things and the worlds of light; he spread out the rulers and chained them in the middle [of the heavens and set] the stars in [the firmament and] the earths [and placed] them in the three vessels. For the rulers rebelled and were set against the Living Spirit. They wished to [flee] since they knew and realised that he might bind and fetter them with a strong chain. Yet he, the Living Spirit, (appeared to them) with many aspects, with numerous [forms], with many hands and great cruelties. He was revealed to them, he imprisoned them with much skill. Not one of them was able to save (himself), and he [bound][...]. Now, since he [was wise] he trapped them [...] [...].

The third war is that of the Third Ambassador who has displayed his image [to what is above and to] what is below [and he] scooped [out] all light and the property [from] the ones that are consumed [by darkness] the entire ruling-power [was stripped of the] pride of the light [which was] extending it [...]. A person comes, who is powerful [over him]; he takes his riches [his gold], silver [...], his pride and wantonness.

This is what the ruling-power is like [...], all riches [...] as they travel [through the heavens, the] light [is separated from them]. He cleansed and purified it.

The fourth war is this that Jesus the glorious one waged against all the rebels who had rebelled above and below. When the light was purified from them by the image of the Third Ambassador, their chains loosened [and they rebelled]. The glorious one in the fourth war; he came and brought [to an end] a rebellion of the entire ruling-power. He girded himself [and encompassed] all of it another time. He constructed the whole structure and he made [of it] a great contest; he humiliated therein. [And] he fulfilled the will of the greatness, [he gave the] hope to Adam [and led him] to his light ship.

The fifth war is this that the counsel of life [has waged] which is the summons and the obedience [and the] great [work] and it placed [...] upon the [...] and the [...] [...] of death, which [was overcome] with it. And it was victorious over [death] for ever, and it gave the kingdom [to the sons of light].

Five Liberations of Wisdom

Primary Teaching

Five divine operations progressively freed wisdom from bondage: the celestial will freed from captivity by Divine Truth; immeasurable wisdom rescued through the ordering of all planes of consciousness; wisdom drawn forth through the manifestation of the Divine Human form; Divine Truth in its glory purifying wisdom in the celestial heights and establishing the regenerated understanding; and Divine Providence as a whole drawing the interiors of the person into active life and sealing the mission of all who transmit Divine truth.

[There are] five [releases by] which the light is saved f[rom] all [the rulers and] powers of Darkness!

[The first loo]sening and saving is that of [the] First Man, since when the First M[a]n was freed fro[m] the prison of] the rulers by the Living Spirit, who had come [to the aid] of the First Man, much light and [much] power was saved from the entire ruling-power. They ascended with the First Man to the aeons [of] greatn[ess]. This [is the first] release.

The second saving is that of the Liv[ing] Spirit, since whe[n] the Father of Life and [the] Mother of [Li]fe constructed [the ten firmaments] and [w]orlds [of wo]rlds, the earths and their [rulers; im]measurable light was saved f[r]om them [that of the First] Man, who w[a]s devoured [and the] lig[ht] was consumed by them].

[... ...] Three wars [... ...] to the time when he [... ...] above [all of] them upon the [... ...] universe.

[The third red]emption is that of the Thi[rd] Ambassador, since when he] displayed [his image to them] he [... ... the r]uling-power; he [... ...] from them [... ...] So this is [how] the [saving through] his image that [was revealed] in the Th[ir]d Ambassador.

[Th]e fourth s[av]ing is that of Jesus the Splendour, since whe[n] he was re[ve]aled in the zone he displayed [his im]age in front of the firmaments and purified [the light] that is above. He took the likeness [of them and] he made himself like the angels in [the heavens] un[t]il he travelled and descended to the form of flesh. He set in order [t]he earths and all the fastenings. He also loosen[ed] and saved the] light without measure in the entire structure. He gave [the] summons and the obedience to the elements, he formed [J]esus the Youth. He as[ce]n[d]ed and rested himself in the light [land].

The fifth release and saving is that of the great counsel, w[hich is the s]umm[ons an]d the obedience, since it also [saves] the soul from the [land] of greatness.

[...] The Living Spirit [...] as he gave [...] the release [...] The first [...] he] ascended and he [...] as he [...] wisdom [...] The fourth [...] its wisdom [to those below] And also, the fifth [...] into it, and it sets it in order [and forms] its light image in this Last Statue.

These five grea[t] powe[rs of saving] were revealed. They came to a profit [...] they were established upon [...] First Man [was freed] when he came to/ward [the light] from the struggle. He set in order and constructed [the entire] universe [...] the First M[an] was saved through] his advent.

In [t]his way [...] they st[an]d with [one another].

[...] Because of the light [th]at had rushed from [... ...] the Amba[s]sa[d]or.

The counse[l] of life, which is the [s]ummons and the obedience, will make [...] seal the commandment and the [mission] of all [the] apostles. In this last season they [complete the] life of the S[t]at[ue and] he judges the sou[ls], so that he] can send [...] powers, they [are separated] from the [powers of Darkness, and] it is alive [by the power] of the will [of the great] Father, the establ[ished one and all] powerful; they g[o forth against the] enemy, they [overcome] all of them [and they] conquer this

land that they have [dwelt and purified] in it for ever [... ... t]hey came fr[om h]im in the beginning, as t[hey will r]eturn again to the light. They [as]cend to him at the la[st].

Part 5

The Infinite Interior of the Divine

Contemplates what lies within the Divine Itself — the meaning of the Father's name, the three containing forms through which the Divine dwells in its own proceeding, the five essential faculties and twelve wisdoms of the Divine, the fivefold influx from the Divine into all heavenly spheres, and the immeasurable durations within the Divine Love before anything proceeded outward. Also maps the parallel unfolding of evil through its own stages, and the five great spiritual states from initial combat to final restraint. Concludes with the five emanations from the five faculties.

The Name, Faculties, and Wisdoms of the Divine

Primary Teaching

The Divine Love is called 'Father of Greatness' because its fullness is the infinite ground of good in which it dwells. Three containing forms manifest this source: the infinite ground itself, the containing form of divine love, and the containing form of divine truth. The Divine subsists in five essential faculties (intelligence, thought, perception, providence, reflection) unfolding into twelve complete modes of omniscience. Five emanations flow from the Divine into all heavenly spheres: illuminating wisdom, the sphere of celestial good, proceeding truth as the living Word, blessedness, and the manifest presence of divine delight sealed as a living form within each vessel.

The Father of Greatness, as he is named; due to what reason is he given the name 'the Father of Greatness'?

The Father, who is the first established thing, shall be called 'the Father of Greatness'. His greatness is the great earth where he lives, he being established in it [and from it comes] the essence of the light that swathes all the rich gods and the angels and the dwellings [in which they dwell] is set over it.

Furthermore, they shall call the Third Ambassador 'father'. His greatness is the light ship of living fire wherein he lives, he being established in it.

Once again, Jesus the Splendour shall himself also be called 'father'. His greatness is the ship of living waters where he lives, he being established in it.

Very great is [land of] light [that exists] due to the first Father of Greatness. How he ex[ists and is] established in his five light limbs, which are [called] houses that have neither limit nor measure to the[m]. They are] mind, thought, insight, counsel and [consideration, and] his twelve light limbs that are his twelve wisdoms.

Now, there are five great light lim[bs] in each one [and from each] five grea[t] springs of praise gush for[th, and] five great [emanations of] lig[ht shine forth from them].

The first is his light that enlig[htens all things] it gushed forth from him and pour[ed into] a[ll] aeons.

The second is the perfume of the [Father, which gushes from him] and pervades all the aeons of greatness.

The third is his living voice of [power, which resounds throughout] all his aeons [and fills them].

The fourth is his [sweet]-ness [that] gushes forth from him [througho]ut [all the aeons].

The fif[th] is his great glorio[us image] that [joy]hich [has been ma]nifested all the tim[e], whi[ch contin]ues [in] all of them. It was sculpted in them [as a form] sealed in the [m, and] sealed [as a living image] as they send [forth their praise] in [... ...] they too receive nourishment [from him] immediately [through] living voi[ce, they are filled with] joy [and they are] set up anew. It shall gush forth from it [unceasingly, and] they shall [receive] and become rich in the [fullness of light. This] too is beautiful [in the living] portray[al of the Father, the] adornment [of the aeons] and they live [in the joy of the light] for ev[er].

[... / ...] The Land of Light.

[He dwells] in the great land of greatness [which is] above.

[His]ace is [... / ...] living [... / fr]om [... / ...] upon him.

[His] light and [... / ...] face [shines] out; he has [the]ace of the [Father] in the [...] now fi[ve words] of prais[e ... / ...] in the [...] living [am]bros[i]a [and the] five [elements] compound [and] they become an image [and] the li[v]ing air [is] also living.

[As] those five shall [come forth] from all the contests of the greatness [...] and a beautiful [form] to the limbs of their body [... w]hich exists [in] the land of light; their [l]ife.

Just as all the gods and the rich ones and the [angels w]ho were summoned came from the Father, so also all [the moun]tains [and] springs and trees [that] gush forth [from it] great is a [...] every thing that you [... / ...] neither water nor [fire].

These ar[e the things] which [... / ...].

The [fif]-th [is the] great light, the living air [... / ...] in which the aeons of greatness dwell, being established therein. [... / ... ang]el[s] that [...] and the [... / ...] the gi[fts] of the great Father [... / ...] in the [...].

The Eternity of Light, the Unfolding of Evil, and the Five Emanations

Primary Teaching

The Divine Being in its inmost essence transcends every finite understanding. The Celestial Human, the five divine faculties, and the Divine Truth of Life each dwelt immeasurably within their origins before proceeding outward — described as infinite preparation preceding every act of redemption. Evil Desire unfolded through parallel stages: from fundamental constituents to perceptions, works, and manifested evil affections. Five great spiritual states extend from the initial combat through ordering, duration, dissolution, and the formation of the ultimate Divine Human, with evil sealed in eternal restraint. Concludes with how the five emanations from the Father's five faculties proceeded in discrete degrees.

[... ..] Essence in [it] [ou] is the land of [... ..] and [is] their last.

What the essence of [light]—no person could recount or unveil [or say how it] exists [from ever for ever and ever]—all [...] and [...] unveil [...] [...] eternity [...] great [...] again and the [...] tend [to] the beginning of eternity and the end [...] set that one down.

The land of death [... ..] nature of the essence [... ..] which exists [from ever for e]ver and ever [dwelling] in [strife] with one another.

As for the eternity of [the darkness] which exists from ever, no person is able to [understand] how they exist. For no other power [is manifes]ted to them, in that it might speak or recount about their origin, how [they e]xist. However, from the time when it stirred itself and rose up against the light [... ..] it might come and rule over the land of the living.

[The Fi]rst Man came forth against it and prevented it, [he kept] it apart from the house of the living. He prevented it. From that time, when the light was mixed with [the] darkness, and life [wi]th death, the light [was] entwined with the darkness, [and] life in death.

[For after it] stirred itself in its essence, its th[ought arose] in its own land. It [... ..] the entire land of darkness in its [... ..] of light in the abyss. For [the] essence in [i]t [... ..] because a [...] they reckoned [... ..] on its side [is] this first nature [of] it, because its body is made strong [far more] than the Adamant [and] every [thing] as it exists [in the univer]se.

[...] Of death [... ..] envy, which [fills] the land of [darkness ... consi]deration in [its] wickedness [...] for as it [...] the wounds [...] against this land [...].

Then he will run [forth f]rom the land [of] darkness. It drew [down] his members [...] is deep [... ..] in them.

[...] Every [...] It spread itself out. It generated itself [of the five dark elements]; which [are] smoke, fire, wind, water and Darkness. [... ..] sprouted trees. It came up [... ..] it formed its own self in the [depths] it generated its own self with its birth [in] numerous [emana]tions, not resembling each other; [in] the storehouses of its abyss, many [dark] creatures [...] destroyers and dragons and evil beasts. It was established and [spread] and grew strong [...] in the ugly forms of those in the Darkness [...] dark, and by the [great] impetuosity, by their wickedness and hatred they slaughter [and devour] each other as they war with one another.

Then the counsel of their ruler humbled its world and its powers. It sensed the essence of the [light that is above it] It conspired to wage a war [...] with the exalted kingdom and the [light].

However, he, the Father of Great[ness] it also knew [of the] war, to disturb the [land of] light [but] in the wisdom of his [great]-ness [...] he transformed himself against it [... ..] against it.

Indeed, at that time [... ...] go against [...] God [...].

[And fr]om its [essence] poured it out [...] in the elements: in the smoke, the fire, the wind, the water and the Darkness. It came up from the [great] depth, it being set in the trees [... ...] against it.

Also, at the time when it generated itself [and] it formed the fruits, it still being set in them. They summoned the five garments, the sons of the Fir[st] Man.

And at the time when it generated its own self [f]rom the fruits through its offspring, they fell upon the earth and [drew] strength from the elements and were nourished by them. [... ...] wickedness, together with cruelty [dwell] in the ruler, the leader of all the demons. He hum[bled] his worlds and his powers; he gathered them all into him. He made himself ready for the battle; he set himself to the war with that light earth, and the great King who dwells in it.

At that very moment the First Man approached his garments, the gods [who sh]ine forth. He spoke with them, that he might entrust to them a [mystery] he [reve]aled to them and taught them about everything that [would come upon] them. He assumed them. He arranged them [... ...] He draped them over one another upon his limbs [... ...] danger, it [... ...] the heights of the earth [... ...] with all its powers [from the beg]inning, it being immeasurable [... ...].

[...] A great ju[dgement,] now also a ti[me came] that they sculpt[ed him, and] he was revealed in the Father, the first established thing.

W[he]n [he gave] the two summonses that he called [forth to] the Mother of Life [she spent] a long duration in the first Father [of Greatness].

For someone, if he might set a measure and rule [to] the earth particles and the pebbles of the mountains and [the sands] of the sea and the body of the firmaments. Should they be poured [into] the body of the four mountains and the three vessels that surround the universe; if they shall all be poured out [as] these fine granules.

The grains of the earth particles are measurable, [and those of] the [entire] universe. It is possible to count the particles of the earth each year [and] the sand grains of the entire universe; but the duration of the time that the Great Spirit spent in the Father, [the] first established thing, one will not be able to make a count of it!

He first sculpted her like this. He established her in his inner storehouses in quiet and silence. When [they had] need of her she was called and came forth of the Father [of Greatness]. She looked at all her aeons of light!

Once again, from the time when she was called to [come forth and] go to [...] she gave [her power] upon his [bod]y [and] all the aeons [of light]; she also [examined] all of them. This [is also the case] with the First Man.

This is how the Man spent a long time being anointed in the Mother, set fast in her inner storehouses [in quiet and silence]; from when the First Man went down to the contest, till the time when the [Statue (?) co]mes i[n]to being, this time [in which] he appeared [...].

Again, from when he was called and came forth, till the time when he [himse]lf called the five shining [gods] who are his sons; they themselves also spent a long time existing in their father! It is the time that occurred from the coming down of the First Man till the going up of the Last Statue. The five gods spent this much duration being anointed in the First Man. Yet, [at the] time when they were awaited, they were called and came forth.

At the time when the Mother of Life was called from the Father of Greatness, when she expelled herself and came down by her own wish, from the heights of the Father to the earth, [she would spend thousands of] years and many ten thousands until she reached the earth. [Fo]r there is no measure nor

rule to the heights of the Father. Rather, [just as] he had called her in his Great Spirit, so he set her upon [the] land of greatness through one of these three that are counted to the twelve hidden ones within the light veil, the ones [esta]blished after the [...] region of the south.

[The] matter of the Mother [of L]ife is like this. When [the Father called her he established her in the place he pleased,] to establish her there as the instruction of the people that [are] many [...]; and she examined everywhere that [...] a blink of an eye, or like a [swift] bird [...].

This also is lik[e that of the] Mother of Life in [...] whenever [...] cast her out [...] upon her to the place [...] him. He perfected her in his Great Spirit and set her in [the place he pl]eased, according to [his will].

[Th]is [also is how] they called the [five g]ods from the [Fi]rst Man. They were set before him, as he wished that [...] -ness [...] down, that they would rule in them [...] one another. He ordered and distributed them [...] the son. He stripped himself of them [...] and he [...] he girt and bound himself to [...] in a [place] of silence upon the border of the earth [...].

Again, he too, the First Man, spent a long period and [time] until he gave power to his sons; until he assu[m]ed them. After he came to wear them he stood fast in the heights between the borders. Again, he spent a duration and time like this, corresponding to such amount and measure as the raindrops and dew and falls of mist that come down in the universe. This is how he spent this duration also, standing between the borders, until the hour when he cast himself down to the contest!

Whenever the Father of Greatn[e]ss called the Great Spirit and the First Man and the gods of the glorious one, who are provided to enable them to reveal him; at that very time [he] sculpted the Great Builder in the [land of] light, [and] the Living Spirit with the mighty and active gods who came [from] him. Also, at that time, he sculpted the [Amb]assador, with Jesus the Splendour and the Virgin of Light and the Pillar of Glory, and the gods who came from them. [All these the Father of Greatness sculpted at] a single time. They came forth of one another, one after one; the time when [...] and the work.

[...] From the time when the Darkness raised itself up to [...] essence of the light [...] these three emanations [that came forth] from the will of the Father against the enemy [...] he has [...] Darkness [...] according to the will [...] the universe [...] in it [...] separate out [...] rest him in which way, and he rejoices [...] in his kingdom; until [the time when the face] of the Father will be unveiled over [all] the gods of glory, and all the rich ones of [...] the em[anations] who came forth against the enemy.

[From] that time when he sculpted these three [emanations,] till the time when the Father would unveil his face, [and they] go in to his hidden storehouses, and he calls them [and] establishes each one of them to his place. There is no measure nor rule to this period until that time.

What has happened and what will happen; but before [the time when] they are sculpted in heaven there is no possibility [for anyone] to proclaim about this beginning, because [it exists] for ever.

The time when all the fathers of light [go in to the hid]den (places) of the Father, and dwell [with] power in them to its [...] of God [...]; because it exists for ever. It is continuous till the aeons. It has no time to the end; but their establishment [is] eternal is their life [endures] generation by generation.

[If] a person shall ask [about this beginning] and about that eternal end [...] in the devastation [...].

This Matter, this thought of Death [that] came up to its storehouses. It has [been established] in its five elements.

Again, it also [is great,] the period and the time that it spent, until it revealed itself to its elements, before it came to the trees. It spent a great period and a long time established [in them] before it came up to the trees. It was [dwelling] in the trees. It spent a long time and duration [...] existing in them, before it sculpted the fru[its ...] and sculpted the fruits.

Again, it spent a long [time] in the fruits. Not little is the period and the time that it spent existing in the fruits, before it sculpted [them,] after a long time [it fashioned] the d[emon]s of its five worlds in various forms [can not] be measured [...] in p[erfec]tion of the fruits in the demons and fiends. They fell upon their earth and [they] were nourished. Not little is the period that they [spent in the wo]rlds, until they were nourished amongst [...] to make [war upon] that land which shines, and the great [King] who dwells there.

[Again,] at the time when he [stirred] its essence. It assumed [all of] Matter [and came] to the war [against] the Perfect Man. [From the time] when the war occurred [...].

[The first is the war, when] he came to be in some [mixture] when they ensnared a [...].

[The second is the building] that he built [and] the universe was established. The zone [came] down until the time when it will be dissolved.

The third is the [duration of] the things and the universe will [endure] from the time when they were established there, till the time when their end will be complete and their existence ceases [...].

[The fourth is the dissolution when they will dissolve the universe] there, and all things are destroyed. Obliteration reaches them in that great fire, [which will] burn them for fourteen hundred and sixty-eight years.

[The fift]h is the way that the Last Statue will be sculpted [from] the remnant of all things. The light separates out to its place, and goes up and rules in its kingdom. However, [the Da]rkness [goes down,] and they take it in to the tomb [...] and they are bound with it in an eternal chain.

Now, from [the tim]e when this first war occurred, till the time of this chain [...] these five things [of the] light.

[The six]th: From the time when it stirred and raised itself up in its land, till the time of its chaining [in the lump] However, before [...] from it out of the powers [...] and measure it; because it is eternal.

[From the time] when it will be taken in to the chaining and bound in the lump [...] to give to it. No person is able [to measure it].

Chaining is eternal [in the] lum[p of death] [forever].

The [Ambas]sador [came] from his mind; the Beloved of the Lights [from his thought]; the Mother of Life from his insight; [Jesus] the Beloved from his counsel; the Virgin of Lig[ht f]rom his consideration.

So in this way were summone[d these five] fathers. These five advents came from the five limbs [of the Father]. One came from another and was manifested in its season.

Part 6

The Anatomy of Evil and the Principles of Divine Judgment

Describes the complete constitution of the ruling falsity from self-love — its five genera, three capacities for concealment and imperviousness, and three further powers — then establishes the twelve principles of divine discernment and the eighteen governing thrones of spiritual authority (nine in the celestial order, nine in the intermediate sphere of conflict). This part maps the full organization of evil and the comprehensive judicial response of the Divine.

The Constitution of the Ruling Evil

Primary Teaching

The sovereign falsity from self-love is described through simile and detailed analysis: five genera of evil corresponding to five modes of spiritual opposition (dominion from self-love, evil affections, predatory rationality, sensual reasoning, perverted natural knowledge). Five modes of action. Three capacities: absolute command over subordinates, the arts of persuasion and concealment, and a will hardened beyond any truth's penetration. Three further powers: the ability to inflame with self-love, extinguish charity, and perceive subordinate evils — but only externally, never interiorly. It has no life from the Divine; its animation is rage simulating vitality.

The First [Man] is like a great distinguished man whose treasure has been taken away from him. He came to pursue his treasure. This is how the [First] Man too came after his sons from the heights, so that he might redeem them and retrieve his treasure, which had been scattered amongst his enemies.

[He is like a man] whose two sons were taken away from him by [the enemy. He] came out toward them to redeem them. This is how the First Man [yearns and] shines in the heights because of his two sons, who were separated from him. They are his living soul that exist in two powers, which makes four.

The ship [of the day] is like a great spear [that is cast against the darkness. The Great Spirit too, which is in it, is like a wise][crafts]man who might beautify and set aright [all] the armour for war.

The Living Spirit is like a combatant who might go towards a king's son who has been taken prisoner of war, and he redeems him from the hands of his enemies.

[The Amba]ssador too is like a great man [who goes forth] because of the treasure [in the] hand of his prisoners [so as to redeem] these light powers [and to bring them together with the] sons and their soul, so that they would [be set free, and that the soul might] be brought forth in the land wherein it was imprisoned.

Five forms exist in his body, corresponding to (the archetype) of the five creations that exist in the five worlds of darkness.

Indeed, his head is lion-faced, which came about from the world of fire. His wings and his shoulders are eagle-faced, after the likeness of the children of the wind. His hands and his feet are daemons, after the likeness of the children of the world of smoke. His belly is dragon-faced, after the likeness of the world of darkness. His tail is the form of the fish, which belongs to the world of the children of water. These five shapes are in him, and they came from the five creations of the five worlds of darkness.

Should he wish, he shall walk on his two feet [like the children of the] world of smoke. Also, when he wants, he shall [go upon all] four [limbs] on his hands and feet [together] like the children of fire. Should he wish, he shall rise up on his wings, like the children of the wind. Also, should he wish, he shall plunge down to the waters like the children of water. Again, should he wish, he shall crawl on his belly like the children of darkness. These five shapes are in him.

Also, there are three other (qualities) in him.

The first: [he commands] his powers [and they obey him].

The second: Shall a [power oppose him, he has] his magic arts. When he wishes, he shall make an invocation over himself, and hide from his powers. When he wants, he shall show himself to them and strike a death-blow by his magic arts. Any word he might utter at that moment, he shall [wreak magic] by it.

The third: His body is strong, a[nd] [the] nails and claws of his powers are not able to penetrate it. No iron nor copper body will equal him [in strength]; they will not be able to destroy him, because he was formed and fashioned from the hard-hearted counsel of Matter, the mother of demons and fiends.

Again, there are three others in him.

When he wants, his fire shall {blaze), and his entire body be made like the [furnace of] fire.

Also, when he wishes, he shall send out frost, and his entire body freezes like a [mountain of] snow.

The third: Whenever his powers are stood before him, he shall look at them and understand; for [whatever ex]ists in their heart he shall understand, what is in their heart and their face so long as they are stood before him. When they retreat before him and distance themselves from him, he shall not understand what is in their heart. There is no life in him whatsoever, but his 'life' is the bile of anger that is apparent on his face and in his fear. Shall a [power behold him, it is] destruction that is establ[ished be]fore him.

Twelve Principles of Divine Discernment

Primary Teaching

Twelve sovereign orderings of spiritual judgment proceed from the one supreme Discernment (the Divine Itself): the Primal Good overcoming falsity, Divine Truth proceeding raising up good, the Divine Proceeding ordering the celestial, the Great Ordering Wisdom constructing the new state, the Sovereignty of Divine Glory governing the rational, the Third Manifestation purifying wisdom, the Column of Glory confirming good and condemning evil, Divine Wisdom separating steadfast from convicted, Pure Affection gathering its own, the Judge in the intermediate state, Divine Truth entering the understanding, and Divine Providence making the final separation.

Twelve judges exist; the great mighty givers of judgement! They were sent and came from the exalted greatness to this place. They were assigned to different works according to the command that the Judge, who belongs to the greatness, entrusted to all these judges. Now he, the great Judge, he who transcends all the judges, who exists and is established in the aeons of greatness; he is the Father of Greatness.

The first judge is the First Man, he who humiliated the ruler of Darkness in the beginning. He judged him according to a judgement of righteousness; for he had exalted himself against a kingdom that was not his own.

The second judge is the Living Spirit, he who came and bore up the Man. He too made a judgement on all the powers of Darkness; which had wounded the garments of the First Man.

The third judge is the Mother of Life, the Great Spirit, she who beautified and set up the heavenly part of the universe, according to her pleasure; which [pleased] her. She judged the rulers above; she fettered and set them firmly in the place that is fitting for them.

The fourth judge is the Great Builder, he who built the new aeon of joy. He judged, according to a judgement of righteousness, the storehouses of the enemy; that death may not well up from this time on. He has constructed a prison for the enemy. Also, upon the crown of the building he has constructed a throne for the First Man and all the fathers of light; they who engaged the struggle with the evil one and were victorious over him.

The fifth judge is the great King of Honour, he who dwells and is established in the seventh firmament. He is the judge of all the firmaments who gives a true judgement, according to a judgement of righteousness, upon all the powers and all the kingdoms of the firmaments.

The sixth judge is [the Th]ird Ambassador, he who came and displayed his image. He purified the light [from the mixture] which his own [image released] also of the enemy, he has [judged them].

The seventh judge is [the Column of Glory, he who judges] the worlds [and all in them; as he gives the victory to] they who are steadfast; but he condemns the ones who are convicted [in their sin. But for the righteous] he shall become for them the steps of the way (?) [of life]; but the convicted he sweeps and casts out to the depths.

The eighth judge is Jesus the Splendour, the father of all the apostles; because after the Ambassador had displayed his image and the light was taken [from them] a mass of rulers rose up from above and below. Then they sent Jesus the Splendour. He came [... ...] he descended and made a judgement in the firmaments. He separated the steadfast from the convicted.

The ninth judge is the Virgin of Light, [she who took the heart] of the powers by her image, gathering her own ones into her. She makes a judgement on the ruler of the moist, and the ruler of the dry.

The tenth judge is the Judge who dwells in the atmosphere, judging all mankind. He makes a separation between they who are good and they who are evil, setting apart the righteous from the sinners.

The eleventh judge is the Light Mind, he who shall come and appear in the world. And he unveils [all that is hidden] and separates light from darkness, and sets the truth apart from lawlessness.

The twelfth judge is the great counsel, which is the summons and the obedience, which is appointed in the elements. It is the one that makes a separation between the good and the evil ones. At the end also it can gather itself together and sculpt its own self in the Last Statue. And it separates light from darkness.

These are the twelve great and mighty judges who were sent. They came from the great Judge, he who transcends all the judges. He is the Father that is hidden and immeasurable, the one who exists; who is established in the aeons of greatness upon the great throne of honour, which is the King of Honour [who is established] in his kingdom.

Eighteen Governing Thrones of Spiritual Authority

Primary Teaching

Eighteen governing principles established in eighteen distinct degrees: nine in the interior heavenly states (from the Divine Itself through the originating degrees of wisdom) and nine operative in the intermediate sphere of conflict (three in the doctrine of enlightenment, three in the doctrine operating through obscurity, one at the summit of the rational mind, one in the external natural mind rendering judgment on three paths, and one for the apostolic function of divine teaching entering natural life).

Eighteen [great thrones for all the fathers] exist and are appointed, which are established in eighteen places! While there are nine among them [appointed in] the outer aeons, they exist [i]n all the worlds of the damage.

The first throne is the throne of the Father, the God of [truth], the King of the aeons of greatness, the one who exists; who is established [in himself] he alone, in his own essen[c]e, [dwelling] apart. This is the first throne [of all] the one that surpasses all the thrones.

The second throne is that of the [gl]orious Mother of Life. She is the origin of all the emanations that have come to this world.

The third throne is constructed for the father, the First Man. He is the one who humiliated the entire first enmity, which existed in the worlds of Darkness.

The fourth throne is that of the Beloved of the Lights, the great honoured Beloved of the aeons of greatness.

The fifth throne is that of the glorious Great Builder; the great architect who built the new aeon for a newness, for [a resting place] for [the] fathers of light; also for a place of binding and a prison for the enemy and his powers.

[The sixth thro]n[e] is that of the Living Spirit, the [glorious] mighty one, he who bore up the First Man out from the [land of Darkness]; who also set in order and constructed the world [s ...] both for a cleansing of the light, [and] for a binding [of the] powers of the enmity.

The seventh th[rone is] that of the Third Ambassador, the king of the zone, also the master of all advices.

The eighth throne is that of Jesus the Splendour, who [is] the releaser and redeemer [of] all souls.

The ninth throne is the throne of the great M[ind, he to whom] all the churches shall gather; and all the [life] that will be purified from the world returns to him.

These are the nine thrones of ho[no]u[r] appointed in the outer aeo[ns], <which are established> for the fathers of the glorious realm; [in the kingdom of the King of] Honour.

In contrast, these are the other nine thrones that are appointed in this world of the zone.

Three thrones in the ship of [the d]ay: one is that of the Ambassador, the second i[s that of] the Great Spirit, the third is that of the Living Spirit.

Once again, there are another three in the ship that [belongs to the night]: the first is the throne of Jesus the Splendour, [the second is that of] the First Man, the third is tha[t of the Virgin of] Light. These six thrones are established in the two ships.

Also, the seventh throne is established in the seventh firmament. The great King of Honour sits upon it.

The eighth throne is established in the atmosphere. The Judge of truth sits upon it, he who judges all mankind. Three paths shall be distinguished before him: one to death, one to life, on[e] to the mingling.

The ninth throne appointed and established is for the [a]postle.

Th[ese] are the [nin]e great [th]ro[n]es of honour that are established in this world of [the zone] of the glorious realm, the one that the [... ...] honour them [... ...] and the [...].

Part 7

The Ordering of the Spiritual World

Details the specific operations by which the spiritual world is constructed and maintained: the three external truths that clothe interior goods, the divine awakening of the celestial human, the seven works and five constructions of operative divine truth, the ten operations and four revelations of the divine emissary, the wheel of providence and its twelve constraining truths, the zones of order suspended one upon another, the three great days and two spiritual deaths, the three necessary outcomes of regeneration, and the three blows that progressively destroy the self-derived will.

Three External Truths and the Divine Awakening

Primary Teaching

The Lord's operative wisdom descended bearing three coverings of external truth (rational understanding, love's activity, natural knowledge), through which Divine order was established across all degrees. Having accomplished this ordering, the Divine revealed the interior reality by removing the coverings. Then the teaching of how the divine awakening descended into the Celestial Human: the primordial Divine Human distributed His life into every faculty, yet did not perceive it — until the blessed Divine Human came by an interior way, through His own likeness, love, and holy truth, gathering His spiritual life into unity and building it as an organized habitation of wisdom.

When the Living Spirit came he brought the three garments; that of wind, that of fire, and that of water. He assumed them from [the heights] he has [clothed himself] in them in those three garments [and through them] he established [them] for all the things of [this univers]e, both above and below. He arranged them in the [form in which] he was displayed. Afterwards [he completed] his works [and] the [image was revealed, and]e stripped them off before [the ri]ghteous ones.

Now, when he was about to loose [and release them,] divested himself of them from their (clasp) and he [was no more]n them, and thus these three g[arme]nts are arranged [and extend] from below the edges of the zone as they clothe i[t al]l [reaching] up [to what is] above [and reaching] up [to what is] above them strips them of the zone from that place at its topmost point; and it is placed below them and ra[ised u]p to the heights above, from which it had been sent o[u]t at their beginning.

In which limb of [the liv]i[ng] sou[l] did [the] summons descend to the Man, who exists in the [a]eon?

Indeed, the First Man dispersed himself and he [was in every] limb of the living soul [and every part] of the living soul; he has [suffered and] he did not know [... ..] but the blessed, glorious Man came [in] secret; in his image; in his shape; in his love; in his holy virgin, she who is the virgin of light, the soul of the father.

After the fashion of this fleshly body: as the root of all the limbs hang upon the head, so that should one of the person's limbs be cut off, while the head exists he has hope for [healing] but if his head should be cut off, the entire body will die and he is lost.

This is also the case for the Firs[t] Ma[n]. He is the head, while his sons attach to it the limbs [of] his soul. Or, conversely, like the living air, on which all flesh entirely lives as it breathes and [lives] therein. His head is placed on the body of the Pillar of Glory in the heights of the universe.

[This i]s also the case [for] the father, the blessed Man; as he is like the head that is upon the body and the air that upon the Pillar is set i[n every place] being made strong by his light virgin, [she] who is his soul that he clothes [with light].

[For there are] t[h]ose [five]: the mind, thought, insight, counsel and c[on]sideration that he produced and sent forth from hi[m to] do his will. He sprang and travelled behind them. [These are the limbs] of his living soul, which is entwined among the rebels; as they are like the limbs of its body, and [are spread through the] universe.

And when they were sent, at [that ti]m[e] he was found with the Virgin of [Lig]ht and [he] stood up, asking and entreating for a p[o]wer. [And the Father] gave him peace and a ki[ss of love and] he [gave] him goo[d] tidings [concerning the] Man. The Man him[s]elf gave [his power to] his limbs and gathered his soul i[n]to one and] he built it in its place like this tower [of light].

[And he] shaped it and beautified it skillfully [and he] for[med it anew and] the voices that he sent
[forth that] he might sink in and quench [the fire and restore the] so[u]l that was crushed by the enemy.
They were gathered in. They came, set firm once more, in the image of their father.

Seven Works and Five Constructions of Divine Truth

Primary Teaching

Seven complete operations of spiritual regeneration: raising the celestial state from temptation, exposing and subduing self-love, penetrating the root-principles of spiritual death, forming vessels of celestial wisdom, calling forth five faculties with three essential truths and the divine invitation, sending forth agencies to guard the boundaries, and securing the spiritual form against relapse. Also five essential structural orderings: the foundational ground of truth, the spanning connective truths of doctrine, the determining pattern giving boundary to the hells, the supporting truths in the natural plane, and the fourfold protective enclosure around every vessel of reception.

The Living Spirit has done seven [wo]rks with his strength.

[The fi]rst: He brought the First Man up from the contest, the way a pearl is [brought] up from the sea.

[The second: He spread about the one who had rebelled, he crucified][h]im in every body.

The third: He [tr]ampled, piled up, and pierced the essences of death.

[The f]ourth: He constructed the ships of light.

The fi[f]th: He evoked his five sons, and distributed them about. They [took] possession of the zone, they bore up under all the universe's weight. Also, he evoked three living words. He set [them] upon the th[re]e vessels, another one upon the giant. [Again, he evoked the] summons, that it might be mixed with the five shining men.

The sixth: When he had constructed the zone he aro[se] and s[e]nt forth a multitude of powers and many [angel]s; so that they would bound the circuit of the z[o]ne on every si[de], un[t]il he finished [co]nstructing the works. And at the end [of] all the [wor]ks he to[ok s]ome of them into his storehouses, and he appointed others at the watch-posts.

The [sev]enth: A[t the] time when the Ambass[ador dis]pl[aye]d his glorious imag[e], the L[iving] Spirit [established] many [go]ds and angels. They [...] Th[ey to]ok hold of it, that the entire building [might] not [... / ...] one another against [the] light, which he had [spread].

Also another gr[ea]t and glorious work he will enact at the e[nd] is [the] Last [Statue], which he will bring up to the aeons of [light]; and he [goes] in, and [he ta]kes hold, and he smites [the darkness], and [he] builds, and he [...], and he [gathers]hem.

The Living Spirit constructed five great things from veins and skull[s in the] hard [bodies].

The first is the disc that is placed upon [the sh]oulder of the Porter.

The se[con]d are the arches of [the] pillar that is before him.

[The th]ird is the [mou]ld of the fo[r]m for the gehennas.

The fourth are the [seven] pillars that he has erected in the great sea, in [the] seven parts of the universe.

The fifth are the four walls that surround the vessels.

Ten Operations and Four Revelations of the Divine Emissary

Primary Teaching

Ten operations accomplished by divine truth in its emissary function: building a new interior state, moving vessels of good and truth through highest degrees, setting cycles of providence in motion, ordering transmissions, opening receiving capacities upward and downward, exteriorizing hidden evil, distinguishing truth from falsity, causing malformed spiritual productions to fall, and bringing the natural mind into continual alternation. Then four works disclosed when the Divine form was made perceptible: the manifest form of Divine Wisdom, all passages between degrees opened, wisdom and liberation purified, and the containing vessel of celestial wisdom perfected.

The Ambassador performed ten works by his advent.

The first: The Great Builder came forth to build the new aeon.

The second: The ships moved through the heights in the heavens.

The third: The wheels begin to send the life to earth and the upper worlds.

The fourth: [The zodiac was set in order].

The fifth is the doors of the ships, that they were opened up [to receive the light].

The sixth is the doors too [of the depths below, that they were opened to receive the waste].

The seventh is [the sin], which he had separated from the rulers by cause of the Third Ambassador; it fell upon the earth.

The eighth: Night and day were separated [from one another by the turning of the sphere].

The ninth: The abortions [fell] to the ground.

The tenth: Transmigrations came about in the zone.

At the time when the Ambassador displayed his image, four great works were revealed that are very excellent and outstanding.

The first is his image that he displayed in a glorious image.

The second is all the doors of the firmaments that were opened at that time. They open [before him] and shut behind him.

The third is the light and the releasing that was purified by his image. That light is more than the light that he shall [gather].

The fourth: He has [made apparent], by the perfection of people, his light ship. He has [perfected] the living soul that shone forth in perfection and fullness over the worlds of enmity.

The Wheel of Providence and the Zones of Order

Primary Teaching

The universal ordering of Divine Providence stands before the Divine Good governing: twelve constraining truths hold every dominant persuasion in restraint, with five illuminated faculties of perception interwoven throughout the boundary of external life. This ordering serves as a mirror of self-reflection through Divine Truth. The discrete degrees of spiritual order are arranged so that each depends upon the degree above it: the five genera of falsity are subject to five genera of radiant truth, while the five essential powers of the living Divine Proceeding sustain the entire structure from within.

The wheel that exists in front [of the King of Honour who dwells in] the seventh firmament [...], the root of the rulers above and below in a great and cruel fetter; as the entire will of the great King of Honour is placed in [it]. Also, their entire enmity, which is in the firmaments, is [bound] and ensnared in it.

It exists in a blaze of splendour [with] ornamentation and great beauty. Now, there are twelve seals in it. The seal between i[s] every firmament and the rulers who are there [... ..] are in it; for should one of them wish to escape, he will be bound [by the seal]. If he should wish to cause a trick in his bond [it will be] apparent and known in [that] wheel [before him]. The spheres and stars and [the] leader of all the powers exist there, and can be known by it, in front of the King of Honour.

The twelf[t]h seal that is in it is its five shining men that are conjoined and enmeshed through the entire zone; because every place where they are cramped, and every place where they have space, is displayed by that wheel. For the root of all the firmaments above and below, and that of their rulers, is ensnared and fixed in it.

The observation [of the wheel] is set right at all times opposite the great King o[f Honour ...] so that fear, wh[ich comes from it] will assume all the powers of mixture [... ..] their root affixed there, so that they cannot make an esc[a]pe from the fetter of their bond.

That wheel rese[m]bles, in this respect, a chain in front of the chief guard, for when [...] in th[ose fetters] in the [great cha]in.

This is also the case for all the rulers who are in the firmaments, and every power of the zone: If they should wish to escape, they shall be recognised and revealed by that wheel. [For] the wheel is like a great mirror, for [the di]scrimination of all things [that exist is] in it.

When he built and constructed the worlds, he suspended the zones on their zones, and within another zone also. The first zone is the five powers of darkness, males and females.

This is why he hung one zone on a zone! He hung the five powers of darkness on the five shining men, the sons of the Man; because all the enmity is entwined and bound in them.

Also, within the zone are the five sons of the [Living] Spirit; because the entire edifice is suspended from them, it being [that they also he]ard (?) him too, the oth[ers that were set] after them.

And this is the one who came to [rule over the fi]rmaments above [them all] which is in one zone, is the great [King of Honour] who e[xists in his honour] within the [very midst] of the universe.

Three Great Days and Two Spiritual Deaths

Primary Teaching

Three mighty spiritual states: the celestial principle's descent and the ordering of all things; the reign of the victorious in the regenerated life (equal in measure to the first state of affliction); and the great third state when the Divine unveils its likeness, receives all into its hidden treasury, and pours out blessedness without measure. Two spiritual deaths: the first temporal (from wisdom's fall into falsity until its purification) and the second eternal (those stripped of all truth, separated from living influx, severed from the completed Grand Man, bound upon their own self-love forever).

There exist three great mighty days in all; and also two great and bitter deaths.

What are these three great days? Or again, what are these two deaths that are bitter?

The first day is our father, the Man. From the time when the First Man went down to the abyss of darkness and drowned in it; and the Living Spirit was sent, who went and bore him up. After the Man had ascended, the Father of Life and the Great Spirit set things in order, and the worlds above and below.

Furthermore, the glorious Ambassador came and dwelt in the ship of the day. He displayed his glorious image, and he purified the light out of all things. He walked in the heights of the heavens. Till the time when the world will be dissolved, all things destroyed, the great fire released, and the Last Statue ascends. These three deeds were begun on this first day, when they sent the First Man with his five sons.

In contrast, [the first death] is the darkness that mixed with the five sons of the First Man.

The second day is the time when the fathers of light, who were victorious in the struggle, will sit on their thrones in the new aeon and dwell on the new earth. And they reign in the new aeon till the Father unveils his image above them.

The length of the sojourn in the new aeon equals the measure of the first day spent in affliction. They will reign like this and rejoice in the new aeon.

The great third day [is the time] when the Father will unveil over them his image [... ...] and he raises them up [to himself] and he receives them into his hidden treasury [of light] and he gives [to them] his soul. He can pour out upon them [without measure] his ambrosia and his sweet perfume, which takes away all affliction that they have seen with their eyes. [It is a] fullness and a joy eternal! When his grace would sate them, he gives to them his [garments of light] and they are made anew in them.

Also, he can summon them once more in peace and silence, and perfect their stature in same measure as his first aeons. And he sets each power in its aeon, in its dwelling-place. They will dwell in the new aeon in their aeons!

Now, when they dwell in their aeons, they will become rich beyond measure, for ever, beyond time. From then on they will not count that season amongst them; nor the number of the days, nor the hours, generation after generation, for ever and ever. The Father will not be hidden from them, from this time on. Rather, he has accomplished (his) unveiling to them [for ever] he being revealed to them for ever.

These are the three great days, [which the Father of Greatness has given number to in the reckoning].

In contrast, the two deaths are these.

The first death is from the time when the light fell to the darkness, and was mixed in with the rulers of Darkness; until the time when the light will become pure, and be separated from the darkness in that

great fire. The remainder left behind there can build and add to that Last Statue.

Now, the second death is the death in which the souls of sinful men shall die; when [they will] be stripped of the shining light that illuminates the world. And also they are separated from the living air, from which they receive [living] breath; and they are deprived of this living soul, which [sustains all things] in the world; and they are separated and swept away from this Last Statue [and they have no portion in it] and bound on [... ...] the female will become [the source of] their torture and their affliction; for their deeds [have cast them into] those three places; because they have blasphemed and despised the Holy Spirit since [ev]ery generation of the world.

These are the two deaths. The first death is temporal; [but] the second death is eternal. It is the sec[ond deat]h!

Three Necessary Outcomes and Three Blows Against the Enemy

Primary Teaching

Three outcomes that must be brought into being by divine wisdom from necessity: the regenerated external mind built upon the subjugated proprium, the containing form that encloses what is spiritually dead, and the permanent fixing of confirmed evil upon its own self-love. The final mass of evil is sealed with all phantasms, separated by a great void from its own falsity so they become sterile forever. Three progressive devastations then destroy evil: drawing it from concealment, dissolving its coherence in divine love, and the final 'rolling back' in which the intellectual element of evil is divided from the volitional, each sealed apart for eternity.

Three things would be fashioned by the Light through necessity. For there can be no other way nor other result, to allow them to stay without coming about. For the Darkness, the enemy, must be bound by them; he who stood up against the Light from the beginning. Due to this, these things have no (other) result, to allow them to stay without coming about.

Now, the first thing is the new luminous earth, which was set and built on top of this earth [that is beneath] it, namely that alien body [that was] built upon it.

The second thing is this: They will [fashion] and they [will build] the new earth, the coffin [and the grave] of the dark fire, the companion of the enemy.

The third thing is the souls of all the sinners who have been condemned by their deeds. They were [judged, and there came] over them woe; they have been condemned according to the wicked deeds they had committed, and due to this they will be crucified on the enemy, he who had raised himself up against the greatness.

They will seal up this final lump when all the likenesses and images of every shape will be nailed in it. Also, those will be bound by this last fetter for eternity, and be placed as a footstool and a mat and a rag for this coffin [of the Darkness] which is the prison of the enemy. It will be placed, being a boundary-marker and a great void between the two, between the Darkness and the enemy, so that they cannot reach one another, nor can they hear their voices; rather they will become sterile as they are separated from each other for ever and ever.

The Darkness itself, the enemy, has received three bad blows with three wars; and worse dangers from the light in those three wars.

The first: (The enemy) was brought out to the middle and separated from his dark earth, whence he had departed. He was vanquished in that first war, caught and [bound] by the living soul.

The second blow is the time when he will be dissolved and melted, and he perishes in this great fire. He is destroyed and overthrown, from the images that are all by which he exists. And he will be gathered in [to the] fetter corresponding to his archetype, and be made like he was from the first beginning.

The third blow that will befall the enemy is the 'rolling back' [at the] end when everything will be separated, and male will be divided [from] female. Now, the male will be bound in the lump, but the female [will be thrown] in to the tomb. For it will be divided [and sealed by a great] stone in their midst, for generation upon generation, for ever and ever.

This is the way that the binding of the enemy will come about, in a fetter that is burdensome and strong, one from which there is never escape; because [they have achieved] his binding and bound him for ever. And they have achieved his being set apart, and he has been set apart for ever.

Part 8

The Purification of the Mind

The central extended teaching on how evil is purged from the interiors of the mind. The three containing forms of evil (corrupted truth, falsity, infernal desire) cannot be cast directly into the hells but must first be brought into conscious awareness in the natural mind — like a physician who administers three medicines, each causing a different corruption to break forth and be expelled. Also describes the construction of spiritual order and the composite selfhood formed from the sediment of purification, and the principle that every confining state of restraint was prepared by providence before the evil it must contain had yet emerged.

The Three Vessels of Evil: Descent, Recognition, and Expulsion

Primary Teaching

The most extended single teaching in the text. Three containing forms of evil (corrupted truth, falsity, infernal desire) hidden within the ruling persuasions of the interior mind must be expelled — not directly into the hells but first through conscious awareness in the natural mind. The process is compared to a physician administering three medicines that cause different corruptions to break forth. The three doctrines (understanding, truth, love) accomplish this purification stage by stage. What is expelled draws like toward like: latent evils in the natural mind are attracted upward to meet the descending corruptions. The remnants of each form of evil persist in the natural mind as bitterness, obstruction of light, and pride.

These three vessels that [were hidden] and were discharged from above, and how they were discharged and separated from all the rulers who are arranged in the heavens. [This is] the manner in which the three vessels have been discharged, while the rulers were flourishing in their body.

When these vessels were discharged, they were discharged in [great] slaughter, but those [who separated] these vessels from them.

They are like the form of a man who has fallen into a purulent sickness. Other wounds and diseases are in his body, and even bile and other poisons are in his inner limbs. He achieves good health by a wise doctor, who gives him one remedy to drink that causes his purulent sickness to break out above, and gives him another medicine to drink that causes his sickness to discharge below, and he gives him yet another medicine to drink that cures his wounds for him [and purifies him] calmly and silently.

Through the skill of a wise doctor, with his effective medicines to consume that take away all sicknesses in this manner and dissolve all magic, the doctors shall [heal, and] they work cures through the aroma of the medicine, other wounds [that are in] what is hidden, they at last tear them out from [within, and are] manifested above and below [and purified through] the aroma of edible medicines that were placed upon them.

This is also what these vessels of water, of darkness and of fire are like, which are hidden in the body of all the rulers above; while the Living Spirit is like the wise doctor. These three healing drugs are the three garments that the Living Spirit assumes upon his body: of wind, of water, and of fire. Through them he has set in order the things below. For by those three garments he has been displayed to the rulers who are above, with hard-heartedness, with shaking and fear, with derangement; from them he discharged the three vessels, those of water, of darkness and of fire.

The case of these vessels is just like a child who is in his mother's womb and is swathed by seven garments. The first is the marrow, the second is the bones, the third is the tendons, the fourth is the flesh, the fifth the veins, the sixth the blood, the seventh the skin of the body that covers him. The other garment also [is the covering that wraps him, and the ninth is that which encloses him] this child. The marrow and the bones, the sinews and flesh, the veins and blood and skin, together with the garment that she wears and the linen that swathes her, total nine. Together with the nine of the child, these and the others, they shall complete and make eighteen garments. Now, you shall find the soul of this child is entwined within all these.

And look see: When the smell of the action of the demon, which brings about the stench of birth, will reveal the child; immediately [it] shall [open up] all [these things] and it emerges from a crack that has become visible, while no tear nor wound occurs in the body of the child. In the same way as this child opens up the womb of his mother, so is it also with these vessels of water, of darkness and of fire. The actions that open up his mother to the child, and she shakes him out and reveals him; these are the three

living garments that the Living Spirit assumed on his body.

For by the aspect of the garment of water [in which he was revealed to them, he shook them and discharged the vessel of water] from the rulers; he moved [the waters, for] they are the poison and death with which their veins and entrails are filled.

By the aspect of the garment of wind, in which he was revealed [to them] he has swept away and erased the entire destructive shadow and dirt, discharged it down to the earth. Afterwards he swept it out and confined it in the vessel of darkness that surrounds the universe.

Also, by the garment of living fire, through its splendour and vigour, he discharged the fire of the darkness from all the rulers and threw it down upon this earth. He swept it another time from the earth and confined it in the vessel that surrounds all the worlds, and they call it the wall of great fire.

Now, those three garments, through which he established these three things, he did not peel them off all at once; but he stripped them off one by one at the appropriate time [and cast them] down to the earth [below].

In this way the universe of the [...] his vessels [...] these vessels like [...].

The use of the matter, and the management of these vessels that were swept out and discharged from above to earth, have brought an advantage and benefit of twelve great deeds. Afterwards, they were swept from the earth and pushed outside to the edges of the worlds and to the extremity.

The first deed is this: So that evil-doing does not increase in the universe, neither in the creations nor in the trees [nor in all flesh, for] itself up in three things.

The [first is / ...].

The second is error [...] if [the vessel of water] had not been swept down from above, but rather the waters existing up till now in the rulers above [... / ... the] torrents that would flow [down] and the droplets that would [drip] down, so lust would have sprouted [and multiplied]n the trees and in the fruits as well as all flesh.

If the vessel of darkness had not been swept out and thrown down to the earth, nor swept from the earth and cast outside the region of the worlds into this pit; again the drops of darkness, which will drip down from it, and the torrents that will continue to flow down from above to the earth and assume the trees and all flesh, would have multiplied.

If the fire were in the rulers of the worlds of the heavens, and had not been swept out and cast down to the earth, and swept from the earth and shut up inside the vessel of fire that surrounds the worlds; [again] this fire [would have poured down from] above through the torrent [... the torrent ...] below;

And the dark fire would have multiplied in the tree and in fruit and in all flesh.

This single evil that was purified by three archetypes [... / ...].

The second deed: Al[I] the heavens [... / ...] of the sediment and the pollution [...] so that [... / ...] surpasses in them [...].

[The third]: The heavens and the firmaments [... / ... b]urden [and were] relieved from the weight-carriers [...] and it ceased being heavy. This rich one [...] above.

The fourth: That they might purify and cleanse their dwelling places [... / ...].

The fifth: Because the greatness and the richness that dwells in these ships, as it [fills them] you might find them living in these ships, purified and holy.

The sixth: That you might find the mixed, incomplete, and unconfined temples above at rest and purified; since rest will reach them and pass through them and purify them.

The seventh: [That the] nature alone of the vessels, which will advance and extend to their places and sites [... / ...] in [...].

The eighth: That great enclosures and walls would be made, and confine everything.

The ninth: When the apostles [reach] them, they shall return to the universe and give a sign of [the end and] the dissolution of the universe.

The tenth deed: That they would become releasers and purifiers of everything at the end of the universe like the fire [... / ...] burns [all things].

The eleventh deed: [That they] will make a crossing [to the light] and the entire ruling-power [shall be cast out].

To the outer land, for they were not envious of this [...] a man who is richer than them; because the aeons of light are outside [it, in] the place [of rest and] of peace, the place of honour and grace, the place where the joy of the householders who dwell in it shall never pass away nor recede.

The twelfth: That you might find all the deeds of loss hidden from the aeons of light, because of the wall of fire that surrounds the entire building; and these unclean things are displayed (only) in its [interior].

There was a need for these twelve great deeds because the vessels that were discharged and swept out from the firmaments to the earth, and were also swept from the earth to the {extr[emity] ... / ... } the three words of life watch over them that [... / ... ar]e set over them in great power [and authority] that they might watch over them at the last time; because of this, they are firmly set thus in these fetters.

When the Father of Life discharged these three vessels from above, they of water and of darkness and of fire, did he perhaps discharge them to their pits at the edge of the firmament? Or did he discharge them first to this earth, and then he swept them from the earth and threw them to their places?

When the Father of Life was about to discharge these three vessels he poured the three upon this earth, one by one at its (appointed) hour and season. He discharged them and cast them down to the earth.

Then he bailed and scooped them from this earth in these three garments, they of wind and of water and of fire, which swathed his body. He poured and made them flow into the three pits [at the edge of the firmament]hich he had [es]tablished during the construc[tio]n of the worlds [And when] they [were swept away, yet] something remained behind on the face of the earth from these three vessels, so that you can find their mark and type displayed in the universe.

The element that is left in water is the pungency and the salinity of this salty inner sea that surrounds the worlds.

And the remnant that is left from the darkness is this black mountain that exists in the surroundings of the sunrise. For when the sun would shine over the world no sunlight is visible there, because the darkness that gushes from it manifests above it.

And the remnant that remains behind from the fire, upon the earth, are all the mountains and islands from where fumes of fire gush up and are visible. For these things are the remnant of the great vessel, the vestige that was conjoined with this fire that comes up from the earth; together with the mountains and hills [and the] places where no fruit sprouts on the trees [for the fire is] greater than that place from the limb and [... / ...] the trees shall not bear fruit in that place.

About the vessels that surround the universe, and why they were not discharged from above into the ditches prepared for them (straightaway); but were firstly poured upon the earth, and afterwards were swept from the earth and cast down into their pits?

When the Father of Life discharged these vessels from above upon the earth, he poured them out for this reason: so that also the water and the darkness and the fire that exist in these three earths would be drawn and ascend towards they that had come down from above, and the earths would be purified and cleansed. Due to this he poured these vessels down to the earth, of water and of darkness and of fire, so that also the water and darkness and fire that exist in the earths would be drawn up towards they that had descended from above.

Now, first of all, he discharged the water, the waste, the poison of the rulers who are above. He cleansed the firmaments of the [water that weighed them down] he poured down the dark waters. [Just as the] waters fell from heaven to earth, so also the waters below in the earths were drawn and came up from below towards the waters that had come from above to the earths. The waters [were] purified of the dark poison that exists in them. Then he swept them outside and made them a great vessel and a wall of sea that surrounds the universe, and on which the ships sail.

After the water, he discharged the darkness. He purified the firmaments and dried from them the darkness with which they are weighed down. He discharged it down to the earth. Just as he had purified the firmaments, so also he purified the earths. The darkness that is in the earths was drawn up towards the darkness that had been discharged from above. He swept them both out and shut them in that [pit] of darkness [... / ...] the water.

And he discharged the fire from heaven to earth, [and at] that time again the fire that was shut [in] the earth below was drawn and came up towards its kind. Fire was added to fire. Afterwards, he swept it out and cast it into the outer underworld, which [he had constructed for] them outside the universe.

In the same way that he purified the firmaments above as a place for the light-givers to journey [... / ...] so also he purified the earths below and swept from them the fire and the darkness and the water [and cast them out] He has purified them for the ascent of these three powers, they of the wind and the water and the fire, which ascend before the Porter and traverse the earths.

The Construction of Spiritual Order and the Composite Selfhood

Primary Teaching

After establishing spiritual forms, Divine Truth set in motion the three progressions of influx, purified the natural mind, and deposited the impurities into the body of sensory knowledge (making it 'salty'). The revolving cycle of knowledges was purified of its residual falsity, which was precipitated into the mass of natural understanding where it consolidated into a composite selfhood bearing the stamp of every spiritual state and every general disposition. This selfhood serves three purposes: relieving the cycle of its burden, restraining knowledges from ascending or descending freely, and providing a receptacle for all influx and refuse.

After the Living Spirit constructed things and the worlds, he came up and set himself upon this earth. He gave a sign to the King of Glory, who turned the three wheels and caused the wheels that are found [to turn] up above all the mountains; he spread forth the wind to them, he breathed on them, he stirred them up, he washed the earth with the waters. And the waste and the accretion of the three vessels, they of water and of Darkness and of fire, which had been discharged upon the earth, he gathered them and deposited them in the sea that is within the walls and the vessels; because of this sea waters are salty. For they have received salt and bitterness from the washing out and cleansing of the three vessels.

When the Father of Life came, rising in his ascent to the heights, he discharged the wheel of the stars; he washed it out and loosened all the sediment that was in it. He cast it down to this great inner sea like [the stones] of the mountain. And that waste, the sediment of the washing out of the wheel, he cast it down and mixed it in with the sea waters. Its own thought collected it together; and the thought gathered the waste together in this way. It made it fast and fixed it [in the sea].

The sea giant had stamped upon him the seal of the seconds and the hours, the seal of the days and months and years, the impression of the stars and the signs of the zodiac [and the five stars] He came into existence from them and was discharged from their power and cast into the sea. The images and the seals and aspects and doctrines and counsels of [the wheel of the sphere] were sealed upon the body of that giant, because he is the residue of them all. Consequently, each star that will shine, and each sign of the zodiac that will turn: of one he shall be its inducement, and of another its confirmation.

He was discharged into the sea like this, the way a cloud might discharge rainwater into the midst of the sea. They compelled him totally through the action of the power and the helmsmanship of the angels. He was swept down to the mill, the place where he was constructed in the setting up of the universe; and the sea also conceived him [and bore him] for its part [and formed him] it being his chief sculptor and chief craftsman. It sculpted him in a likeness, he being changed more than the other residue of the sea bodies.

This matter is comparable with a craftsman who might take the stamped impressions of many coins and cast them on the fire, and mould them [into a single] image. These thousands of impressions and thousands of shapes [are perfected] and make a single body [from them all].

This is also the case with the sea giant, who too was moulded and sculpted by the power of the lust inside him from many doctrines and counsels that belong to the residue of the wheel of the sphere.

The archetype of the giant was constructed for three things.

The first: That the sphere would be relieved and purified of the burden present in it. In the same way that the ten firmaments were purified and relieved of the burden of the three vessels; so was it also done to the sphere, that it too might be relieved and purified of the burden and the waste inside it.

The second: That he might add a fetter and a prison to the wheel and the signs of the zodiac that are bound to it, so that when they wish to go up above, you can find the sea giant dragging them back as by an iron fetter, and they are unable to go up; and when the powers of the wheel would take a decision on a guileful thing, and it enters their mind to come down to the earth, they are not able to descend because of this stake that is nailed to the wheel upon the [midst] of the firmaments. This is one. However, this other one, because of its sleepless watchers that are set over it, it is turned all the time.

The third thing: That the wind and the water and the fire that gush from the circuit of the sea, and the rivers that flow upon the face of the earth discharging into the sea, and the rainwaters that come to ground, and the waste and rebirth that come down to it; that sea will be a hostel and gathering place for all of these.

As for all the power and the life that comes down to the sea, and in the breath that the sea giant will breathe and draw it into him that he might disturb the sea [there comes a] fullness and a [stirring] becomes between his movement [and his power to] purify; but the sea [is cleansed thereby].

What Was Prepared Before Each Evil Emerged

Primary Teaching

The universal spiritual law that Divine Providence foresees every possible descent into evil and prepares restraint prior to its emergence: confining states established before evil was expelled from higher minds, a place in the sea of knowledge before the monstrous persuasion was expelled, gehennas before refuse was purged, seven states of confinement before rebel evils arose, containing places before incomplete spiritual formations descended, prisons before elevated intelligences fell, doctrinal structures before derivative falsities propagated. The Divine Emissary was summoned before states of obscurity and illumination were distinguished; vessels of truth were prepared before wisdom was freed; the power of judgment was established before evil proliferated.

Understand also this other (matter): Before these vessels were discharged and swept down from heaven, first three ditches were fashioned and constructed for them, in which they would be bound and fettered.

Before the sea giant was discharged from the sphere, the Father of Life constructed a place for [him i]n this great sea that is within the walls, whereon the ships sail, and where the fullness shall [be gathered from it].

Also, before the [beast] was displayed to the worlds [and] the earth [... ... f]ell to the sea and its thought shaped it, the Father of Life constructed a place for it in [the depths of the earth] below the four mountains, above the mountains of the heavens above [it] that [as] a great plain it digs in Matter in the midst of the worlds. When the Adamant of Light was sent to it, he hastened after it to that place, smote it and threw it between mountains in the place made ready for it [and he] is set fast upon it till the end of the universe.

Before the waste and dirt of Darkness were swept out from creation, gehennas were constructed in which the waste might be covered till the dissolution of the universe.

Before the rebels rose up, they whose corps rebelled in the ruling-power above and below, they [were cast] outside, and also the tyrants in whose heart it lay [to ty]rannise amongst the murk and the clouds and winds and spirits and storms; for them were constructed in the great outer sea seven hostels, places whence they are thrown into the depths and the darkness [outside].

Also, before the abortions [fell down from heaven] to the earth, there was set apart [a place for them]: they are gathered in and dwell therein.

Again, before the watchers rebelled and came down from heaven, a prison was fashioned and constructed for them in the depths of the earth, below the mountains.

Before the children of the giants were born, they who had [no] knowledge of righteousness in them nor divinity, thirty-six cities were assigned and constructed for them wherein the children of [the giants would] live; they who would come to beget from each other, they who shall spend ten hundred years alive.

Before night and day were differentiated in the universe, the Third [Am]bassador was summoned. And afterwards, he was sent to this void and outer waste that he might purify the light, and separate night and day from each other.

Before the light was released and freed and ascended through this zone, the Father of Life made beautiful for it the ships of light. He constructed them so that it might be purified in them, and be sculpted and fashioned in good order.

[Bef]ore Sin had multiplied and had made a kingdom in the flesh, before the acquitted and the condemn[ed] were set apart from each other, the Judge [w]as sent forth and revealed. His throne was created and placed [i]n the living atmosphere, so that he would be a just Judge, so that there the righteous and the sinners would be set apart and tested and separated from each other.

Again, [befo]re mankind had been engendered, some were named ['rich' and] others 'poor' on earth [according to what is written] upon them. Before they die, they who will die are marked out by the stars and the signs of the zodiac in the sphere. They are appointed for them; in them are their births. And their root is bound up with their zodiacal signs; and they are compelled by them and brought to an equal judgement in accordance with their deeds and their sins.

Again, before the universe is dissolved, [and the] entire earth, the destroyers were appointed and instructed for its dissolution.

And before the ne[w] aeon was [built and] made be[auti]ful and marked out, [the] Great Builder [w]as summoned, the first architect and the angels who are with him, who would build and make beautiful the new aeon.

Part 9

The Architecture of Influx and the Foundations of Order

Describes the circulation of spiritual life through the created order: the four domains of the mind, the cycle of knowledges and its governance over perception and will, the three reciprocal conduits of influx connecting celestial states to natural forms, the three degrees of spiritual proceeding (divine good, abundance of truth, receptive form of wisdom), and the initiating events — the descent of the Divine Human into combat in the first garment of celestial love, and the Living Spirit's construction of the entire spiritual cosmos.

The Cycle of Knowledges and the Four Domains of the Mind

Primary Teaching

The whole dominion over spiritual states is distributed among four domains: the interior forces above the cycle of knowledges, the eight natural and infernal states below, the boundaries and containing forms that surround the worlds, and the cycle of knowledges itself — arranged with providential precision because immense evils are bound within it. The cycle is equal in strength to the hostile powers: they are kept in perpetual revolution so they cannot comprehend their condition, their captured good ascends while waste descends. The ordering of the cycle resembles a ruling love governing its domain with all its attendant states.

The wheel of the stars is a great mighty thing! Also, it is one among the four great things; since the whole ruling-power is assigned to four parts.

The first part is the powers who occur in the ten firmaments that exist above the wheel, and the ruling-power that is bound in them, as it is imprisoned within them in the heavens that are above.

The second part is the eight earths that are below; the four that are composite, and the four places of darkness. The second part extends from this earth, upon which mankind walks, towards the underside.

The third part is the walls and the vessels that surround the worlds. They are the four mountains and the three vessels; with what is in them, and the ruling-power that is trapped within them, and the powers who are masters over them.

The fourth part is the sphere of the stars that is appointed with great diligence, as it is ordered in a [great arrangement with] any [ordinances]; that of the Father of Life, [and that of the Mother of] the living.

Its [ordering was made with] very [great care] with diligence, because of the great and cruel powers, and the titanic figures, [who are bound] in it; they being suspended from it. So, all the first-born and the leaders of all the rulers, they who were existing in the three parts, these were garnered. They were collected together, seized, bound and assigned on this wheel. Each was apportioned by these three parts. They were distributed, entwined, and weighted against their companions of the same size.

Still, for its part, the wheel is equal to them in its strength; the powers of the enmity who are bound on it. Indeed, they were suspended on the circling wheel because of their cruelty; so that, due to the wind and the motion in which they go round, they comprehend not the place wherein they are set. For if they had been bound in the heavens, the heavens would not have had the strength to support them. Again, if they had been assigned on the earths, on the fixtures that are below, they also would not have had the strength to support them. Rather, they were suspended from the wheel of the circling stars; so that the power and the light that should come up from below can be received, and given to the heavenly ones above them. Conversely, whatever will fall from above, whether cold or hot, the wheel of the sphere will also take it and cast it out upon the entire earth, upon all the wood.

Behold, the ordinance of the wheel is in this form. For the powers who are entwined on the wheel are like this: a king mastering his kingdom by this mighty legionary force of all the leaders of the kingdom; and with all the armour of the soldiery that is collected together for him; and also with the mass of the property of the kingdom; and the beautiful lustful aspect of the women who are collected together for him; together with [all the] property [of the land] and those cattle [and beasts] that have been distributed about among his retinue. Yet, if you ask about that king, he is matched with all his retinue. His retinue, for its part, is matched against his entire kingdom. Judgement shall come forth from him, vindication and condemnation, to his entire kingdom; by his wisdom, skill and strength.

Now, just as for this king, who is matched against the measure of his entire kingdom by his wisdom, skill and strength; so also is it for the powers who are bound on the sphere as compared to the ruling-power, and the powers who exist in the entire zone. Like the king towards his retinue; so too is it that this totality is gathered to the sphere, to seven leaders, to twelve signs of the zodiac. As all the cities are gathered to the king, again they gather to the leaders of the universe. All that is done in the universe above and below: the battles and the disorders and the captivity and the hunger and the lust and the property; so shall they increase and diminish through these leaders. They are the motivators of the whole created order.

Three Conduits of Influx Between Degrees

Primary Teaching

Three reciprocal pathways of influx connect every degree of the mind: the first links celestial affections to their outermost corporeal forms (ascending good, descending refuse); the second links doctrinal structures to perceptions (truth organized into truth known); the third links governing rational loves to the proprial will. The cycle of knowledges gained dominion when evil, recoiling from the Divine Human's manifestation, fragmented into three degrees. The channels of influx cannot be severed by the revolving cycle because they are spiritual — like truths that reunite behind a passing doctrinal system, leaving no trace of disruption.

There are three conduits that exist through the entire zone, from the abyss to its heights.

The first conduit is the root of all the powers above, they that exist in all the heavens. They are cast off and fettered on the earths below; because the earth below is the 'stripping off', the garment and the body of the powers that are above the heavens.

For when the Father of Life constructed the heavenly worlds, he divested them of their bodies, [he] threw them to the earths below.

So, the upper worlds are of the soul and the spirit; but the worlds below are of the body and the carcass [of the powers above] Now as for this, he [bound a root from] the powers of heaven; he sealed it on their bodies and their carcasses that are on the earths, so that when life comes up from the fullness of these earths, it can be entirely drawn up to the heights in the roots of what is heavenly, that are fastened in their bodies. And also, all life can be purified in that place.

However, the waste that will be swept from the purified one who ascends to the heights will be let fall to the ground through the conduits of these conduits, and will be poured down [to the depths] and thrown to the underside.

This is the first conduit, which comes from the powers of the heavens to their bodies and their carcasses that are upon the earth; also, from their bodies and [their] carcasses that are on the earths to the powers of the heavens.

The second conduit is the one that comes from the temples and dwellings and cities that exist in the heavens down to the ground, to the five shapes of tree that grow upon the earth. The life comes up from the trees to the temples and cities. Life too, and the residue of the heavenly ones, comes down to the trees in a conduit.

And the third conduit is all the powers and householders who dwell in all the firmaments, whose roots come down from them to the five worlds of flesh that creep upon the earth, being fixed to one another. Now, the power and the life that shall be gathered in from the worlds of flesh are dispersed among them in various shapes. The powers above shall draw them to the upper side through conduits.

[The was]te too, and the lust and the evil-doing and the anger that will be greater in the powers of [heave]n, shall be poured to the ground through their various conduits. They shall be discharged upon mankind and the other remaining animals. When what is heavenly will wash the waste and the stench and the poison down on the creations of the flesh below, in their turn the creations shall be greater in lust and anger and evil-doing against each other through the action of their fathers who are on high.

Still, look at the wheel of the stars! It has no [root in this earth], but its roots are bound in the totality. The wheel of stars, then, receives life through the power and the life that ascend from the earths through conduits and the firmaments above. It (also) takes life from those conduits that receive up to the

firmaments and the heavenly worlds above it, it takes life out from that place.

In that the wheel has no root in this earth, from where did the stars and signs of the zodiac find this authority? They became masters over these five fleshs and five trees. Every thing, if it can be reduced from the earth, the heavenly powers above draw it through a conduit. Also, every thing that a person will attain, whether it be wealth that comes into his possession or poverty that will accrue to him, or his sickness and health; he attains it through the signs of the zodiac and the star under which he shall be born.

The wheel has no root therein. It is set aright in its position. For when the Living Spirit, the Father of Life, constructed the heavens and the firmaments above, he bound their roots into the earths below; in their carcasses that he had stripped from them. Yet, when he constructed the wheel, [he] did not bind its root into the earths, but he bound the root of the wheel by the sea giant.

And when [the] Ambassador came, he displayed his image and purified and brought the light out from all [the] heavens. Matter, however, which is present in all the rulers, spurted out against the image of the Ambassador. It went up in order to reach it, but reached it not. It dropped back and fell to the [under]side. Now, when it had fallen from above, it separated out into three parts.

The first part fell to the wheel; another part fell to the earth; an[other part fell to the se]a. [By means] of the part that fell to the sphere, [the r]oot was bound in the trees and flesh. Therefore, because of this, they received authority and became masters in the five worlds of the flesh and the five worlds of the tree.

Through the nature that came down [upo]n the wheel the root was bound in the trees. Also, by means of the abortions that came to the ground, another root was bound in the fleshs.

Therefore, because of this, the stars and signs of the zodiac received authority over the trees and the fleshs: through the root of Sin that fell down; and [the ro]ot of the abortions that were aborted there, they fell to the ground.

However, the[se] other conduits that [the] Living Spirit has bound in the e[a]rths, they that the soul of the elements comes up through to the heavens; those (conduits) are not bound to the wheel. Rather, they are plundered from them by the powers on the wheel, that hang from it.

The first is the one that comes from the firmaments to the earths, and the one that comes from the wheel to the sea giant. That is only one. So, the other root is the one that comes [fr]om [the temples] to the trees. The third is bound by means of the abortions in the f[lesh]s; also in the fleshs the fathers of the abortions who are in the heavens [by their roots] are bound and twined, and the [root] that [is bound in them].

About the conduits, the one that is greater than its [partn]er [is so] as more life and soul is drawn [through it] than its partner.

Great [is the root of] the earth from which much life ascends [to the heights] the Father of Life has drawn them. He has fastened them from the powers [above and] he has bound them in the earths. (These conduits) are the roots of the ent[ire] ruling-power that the life of the living soul is drawn up through, it coming up from the whole earth, from all the mountains, fields and islands.

After that first great root is the root of the trees, which is bound to the temples and the buildings above. For there also is much great life coming up from the tree and the entire Cross, being drawn up from them to the upper side like a great host.

What, however, is lesser [than these] of their conduit [through which] he takes up [life from] the roots [bound in] the earths, they [are present in] the whole earth in all the worlds. Again, these of the trees are present in the whole earth, whether small or great; but the root of mankind [and the fleshs] is not present in the whole earth, other than only this world of the south. Therefore, even now these fleshs

do not make [their dwelling] in the entire world of the south [but rather] there is a small part of them in [the region] of the upper side of the world of the south in [being lesser] in number than the [trees].

They are bound by their [roots and conduits] with one another. They stir one another, they draw life from one another through the action of the powers above, which stirs the nature that dwells in them all.

Now, when the Matter that is in them will be crushed and despoiled, then that Matter too shall [stir up] its members and overturn them and [devour] each other [and shall] stir [the nature in them].

How does the wheel circle over the conduits, which extend from the heavens to the earths, and it not cut them? Or why shall the conduits not get entangled in with the wheel as it circles and drives [onward through the u]niverse?

The reason that the conduits shall not be cut, for they are not cut, is because they are spiritual. Thus the conduits are like the waters through which ships sail. You shall find the prow that is in position in the front part of the ship divides the waters, casting them back and forth. So, when it parts the waters and that ship opens up the water with its cleaving prow, immediately and without delay the waters mingle with each other again behind the ship; and the path of the ship shall not be discernible in the midst of the waters.

Just as when a bird flies up in the air, for its path is not visible in the air, and in the way of mankind, in the sun within the conduits. They also shall not be tangled up in them, and neither shall you find their path through the air known.

This is also the case with the wheel. It turns through the conduits and the air. The wheel shall not cut the conduits, nor are the conduits themselves entangled in the wheel.

Three Degrees of Spiritual Proceeding

Primary Teaching

Three degrees of spiritual proceeding constitute the architecture of the Divine kingdom: divine good (brought forth by the Divine from Itself), abundances of truth (derivative states brought forth by good), and receptive forms of wisdom (further derivatives brought forth by truth). This single doctrine unfolds through three applications: as eternal reality within the Divine, as active proceeding into combat and redemption, and as living arrangement within the heavenly kingdom under three governing principles — mapping precisely to the celestial, spiritual, and natural degrees.

This one, a name is given to him in the world. For people pronounce it with their mouths: 'god', 'rich one', and 'angel'. Who are they? Who are the gods? Or who are the rich ones? Or who are the angels? Who are these [three] archetypes?

There are these three archetypes [in the land of light, and there is no measure to] them!

So, the ones who are called 'god', are the gods whom the Father has summoned from himself. He has established them after the likeness of his greatness.

Conversely, these who are named 'rich [ones]', are the evocations of the first rich gods of the Father; because, when the Father had summoned (the first), they themselves summoned evocations. They called them 'rich'.

They too, the rich ones, have summoned their evocations. They call them 'angel'. These are the three archetypes who occur in the land of light. There is no measure to apply to them!

Other persons who are named 'god' are the emanations who have come from the Father; the evocations of the Father whom he summoned forth. They came out to the contest and humiliated the enmity.

Conversely, the 'rich ones' are the evocations of these first living words. They too, the rich ones, have come and performed and fulfilled the pleasure of the greatness, in the worlds that are above and below.

On the other hand, the ones who are named the 'angels' are the evocations of the rich ones, who had come from the three living words. They have been sent in an embassy and an apostolate to this building. They have come to the entire divinity, which is established in silence and in hiddenness. And, also, they have come to all the souls who have been entangled in the enemy. They have brought them hope and confidence.

Again, they are called 'god', all the gods who belong to the household of the Great Spirit.

Conversely, the ones who are called 'angel', are all the angels who belong to the household of the Beloved of the Lights.

The ones who are called 'rich', are all the rich ones who belong to the household of the glorious Ambassador.

The Descent into Combat and the Building of the Spiritual World

Primary Teaching

The Divine Human descended clothed in the first truth of celestial love, sufficient to subdue evil; yet four further truths were added as supports. While celestial love received wounds, the rational sphere alone remained unpenetrated — and from its own truth-covering it gave life to the other four. Wisdom is never divided against itself; falsity, divided against itself, necessarily fails. Then the Living Spirit's construction: commissioning a subordinate faculty, establishing the ten planes, ordering the cycle of knowledges. The operative resembles a builder constructing the Lord's palace, and a carpenter shaping raw wood into vessels of use — the Divine forming all things within the mind as a dwelling for the Lord.

When the [First] Man came forth against the ene[my, clothed in a] garment [against] the Darkness with the garment of [the] living fire. With that garment he withered the tumescence (?) of the enemy; he brought down i[t]s foolery and its vanity.

Now, this one alone was sufficient for them. [Y]et, si[n]ce the living fire was weakened, because of this he added [to it another fou]r garments: that of the wind, that of the water, that of the light, and that of the a[i]r. And this, (why) has he given the four? He gave them s[o] th[a]t they would be helpe[r]s to t[h]at god, wh[ic]h i[s] the living fire; so that [the enemy would] not with [in] the living f[i]re], and penetrate it; and [the po]ison and the [enmi]ty cut it off.

While the fire received a bl[ow and] a wound in its body; yet still, [were weakened] all the powers of Da[rk]ness because of it [Yet also] It [was of] necessity [for its] brothers, to cause them to receive a blow and a woun[d to]o. The power of the en/emy mixed in with them. Rath[er, ex]cept [the air]. The Darkness did not mix in with it, nor was the burning of the enemy able to penet/rate it.

Never-theless, even the one that remained behind without the wound, which is the air, it stripped off garment and power. It gave it to its [fo]ur brothers in its place; so that by that [ga]rment of the living air they would become strong, and [receive] profit, and endure, namely its other four brothers. And it [be]came for them [a spirit of] life.

[Now as to what affects the] light, behold, at the beginning the Darkness was strong against it; [for] no disunity [or discord] exists in the light.

[See then] how far [extends the lig]ht that came forth from [the Greatness] in that place in a [unity] alone [abiding in] the greatness of the light with one another for ever, and nor did one of them transgress the command and order that his brother had entrusted to him forever.

However, the Darkness, the enemy, was doomed and overcome; because of the arising of disharmony it was divided within itself. Even the kingdom was divided within itself; [and] ev[en] the [powers, who had] left their abyss behind and come up fo[l]low-ing] it, were doomed because of the disunity that was present in all of them. The Darkness was destroyed, and its other powers were humiliated.

At the time when the First Man was sent to the war in the first garment of [living fire], which he gave to the first nature that exists [...] in that single garment. [By it] he hunted Matter, the thought of death, [its rulers] and all its other powers.

When the First Man came up from the abyss, [...] the Living Spirit brought the rulers whom he had hunted [from every] element, that [substance] of [the land of] darkness, that he might construct from them this universe and fashion everything appropriate for the greatness. From that time on, the place of the storehouses of the elements [was left behind, and] he destroyed and laid waste the [land and] all that

were in it.

Just like a marsh, of which the fish and birds are snared in a net, and only the waters are left behind and the reeds and the plants that grow in it, this is also the case with the storehouses of death. The [First] Man snared their counsels and [their k]in that were [in them], and the storehouses were left behind in their [dwelli]ng place.

So then, the case of the land of darkness is like this, as is that of the storehouses that were in it.

Just as the body of man has many limbs in it, [the land of darkness] has [storehouses from] its beginning [like] all [the limbs] that hang from the great head of the [body]. A single root is the root of them all, because they all hang from the great head that is on top of the body. Should a limb be cut from the tip of [the]se small [h]eads, the great head that is on top of them [al]l stays in its place the way that it is [and still] you find this person alive. Al[l] these sm[all h]eads are firmly set in it [...].

Wh[en] they will cut from them [the limbs of] all of them, these little [heads] shall [become] the corpses, because they might see [that they] be firmly set [...] in the body, which they joined wi[th] it ...].

In exactly this way, it is also the case that the storehouses of darkness are the same, the things from which the [darkness gushed] forth.

At the time when the F[ir]st [Man went down] he gave the leadership to his five [sons. Then the] Living Spirit and the Mother of Life [came down] as the entire ruling-power is entwined and crucified [in the Darkness, and] they were poured out and mixed with each other, the light with the Darkness and the Darkness with the light.

At that time the Living Spirit called one of his sons, one rich with power. He gave to him the leadership of the garments. Now, he himself [received the command] of [the garments, and] he hung them and set them up [by the command] of the Father of Life [who sent him. And] he set up all things [in the heights, and] he opened [out the] ten firmaments [and he set] the wheel of the stars [above] them and the [luminaries].

The Living Spirit is like this: Just as [a builder] and an architect who might build a dwelling for the king, and divide it up into separate houses and [separate rooms, and provides] everything that is required for beauty [in every room] and he cleans them. And also the stones [he shapes] them for beauty and loveliness, and he arranges them and makes them so that should the king come and inhabit that palace, he might glorify him.

Furthermore, the Father of Life resembles a wise and skilled carpenter [who finds a piece of wood] before it was worked [or shaped, and] before it was established and made beautiful and [useful. This] carpenter [knows what it shall become, and] works in it, but [it is] in him in his [thought and] in his understanding, and he brings the saw and the adze, and cuts it into separate pieces [and he trims] it and he pulls the [roughness from] it with the plane and he smooths it. He shall make many [kinds of] wooden implements, arranging them shape by shape; he cuts and produces wooden implements from it, wooden implements of different kinds, (such as) dishes, bowls. This wood, that [had no form] since previously it had not been worked before it was sealed by [the ski]ll and wisdom of this dextrous carpenter. He cut it up into different sorts of implements useful to his master.

So is it also with the Father of Life. In his wisdom he has [formed all things] in limbs [and built the] palace [and placed all things] in it or in a [vessel] useful [to him. He made] the ships of light [and] all the other works [that he established] in the [universe] so that when the great king comes, he who is the Third Ambassador, who [shall come to it] he might dwell in this universe [and purify it].

[And all things shall] live. The light, however, that is in it [he who is] wise, and he takes it up to the land; but the waste and the Darkness will be gathered and thrown down to the abyss.

Part 10

The Formation and Regeneration of the Human Being

The central anthropological teaching: how the self-derived faculties of the natural mind, perceiving the form of the Divine Human, fashioned an imitation — the human will and understanding. How the five sensory faculties were given interior memory-stores and governing affections. How the Light Mind (Divine Wisdom) enters, humbles the guards at the mind's orifices, takes authority from evil, and establishes the Divine as lord over all faculties. Also covers the progressive diminishing of spiritual capacity across generations, the four griefs of the external truths, and the body as a map of spiritual correspondence.

The Formation of Adam and Eve

Primary Teaching

When Divine Truth displayed the form of the Divine Human, the self-derived faculties perceived it, lusted after it, and fashioned an imitation — the voluntary and intellectual faculties of the merely natural self. This was not the Divine's intention: the Divine came to liberate the entrapped divine life. The concupiscence that recoiled from the Divine image descended, generated false perceptions, established itself within natural knowledge, and entered the ruling self-loves who then fashioned the human will and understanding. The copy resembles a reflection in distorted water — an appearance without interior life.

There are some among us telling us that we [know and perceive] that the (Ambassador) consents about [tha]t f[igure] of flesh; he who shall be fashi[oned in the flesh] at another time. And next, he says: [The Ambassa]dor displayed his image in the un[iverse]. The rulers and the powers of the universe saw h[is image], and they formed their shapes after his likeness, who are Adam and Eve. Behold, you see that god con[sen]ts to its happening; because of this, he has displayed his image to the rulers; and they constructed [mankind after his likeness.] If he was not consenting to humankind, he would not have uncovered his image, nor they fashioned mankind after his likeness!

Regarding the Ambassador, the occasion when he came displaying his image, he [d]id not come so th[a]t he might reveal his image to the ru[l]ers in the universe. Rather, he came and displayed to the universe be[cause of h]is soul and his son, who is [mixed in] every [place], that he might enable him to live [again] and make for him a release; and to free (the soul) from every bond and all the fetters, in which it is entangled and bound.

The rulers and the authorities, in that they had no form in [the likeness of] him, they lusted for his image. They reflected upon themselves, that [they] had no [form] like him in their creation. They sealed hi[s im]a[g]e in their heart, within their soul. Afterward[s, they] built it according to his likeness; they formed Adam and [Ev]e. They sealed the image of the exalted one in their [soul]. So, they [co]pied with an imitation; but they have not [copied i]n truth! Rather, just as [an image that is seen in water,] it is made as these, for [i]t came [from the likeness] but it is not l[i]k[e] him in truth. [Again, so too] is this figure of ma[n]kind. They copi[ed] it against the image of the exalted one [but not in truth].

Similarly the [t]ree, for while it is like the [image, it is] not [copi]ed in truth.

This matt[er is comparable to] this: As a great, fre[e] woman [who dwells] within her [palace, and she is] rich in wealth [and many] po[ss]essions; she is also beautiful in her beauty, and is virtuous in her modesty. She walks in a free and reputable position. The fame of her beauty has spread in every c[iti]ty. She sur[p]asses every woman] Behold h[er] chamber [is closed to every] one who is mad, because [of] the nobles and the great ones. Al[so], they lust for her beautiful face. They did not [reach] her, because she is hidden in her palace [and guarded] within in a [secret place. None could] meet that woman [except through] his so[n]; or rather the head [covering of] that garment. This free woman shall [not willingly] leave the cha[mber] behind her and come to the street [and uncover] her head [and her veil] and she reveals her [face and her beauty to all] because of her beloved broth[er]. This wom[an], on whom no man ever looked, nor did they ever see her fa[ce], as she neither desires nor rejoices [in outward display. She would not] leave her chamber behind her, and come in the midst of mankind [that all might see her] and everyone view her. The hones[t] men and the nobles, even the servants too, and the [lowly ones] look at her.

In accord with this simile: Again, [this] too [is] how [it is that] the Ambassador becomes [manifest in the universe] as this free woman [came forth, not] according to wantonness, in pride, nor [because she

co]nsented to the outer world, she [came forth from her chamber with grief], she revealed her face and her [beau]ty [to all] but only due to the constraint of grief [about] her [bel]ov[ed one].

Now, this too is the way of the Third Ambassador, when he came and display[ed his] image with a show towards all the powers. [He did] not [co]me so that all the rulers and the author[it]ies would sculpt a form [after h]is likeness. R[ather], he came because of his son being crucified in the totality; [fo]r he would release him, free him, and rescue him from oppres-sion. Yet, when the rulers looked o[n] him, [th]ey lusted for his image. They fashioned after his [like]ness Adam and Eve, without the consent of the gre[at]ness.

For, [a]s with Adam and Eve, whom the rulers fashioned and [se]aled after the image of the exalted one, so too this [i]s how a manifold divinity and many powers and angels [also received] the stamp of that image, which was displayed to them. For, in the majesty of the l[ig]ht and (the image's) love, they glowed with their desire and they were undone. Th[ey] were eager for their lust; like a m[an who looks] to the majesty of a lusted after face, and [is undone] and he is eager for the [fire] of the desire.

This is [als]o the case with those powers, when they looked on that majestic and beautiful [imag]e, they () [lusted for] a first image. They received the stamp of th[at image], which was displayed to them. They copied [its appearance, but that]ich th[ey co]pied out in a likeness, it being made [into outward forms, not in truth. And] the ones that they had put forth, which had received a [stamp of this im]age; but inward even to the rocks [and the stones of the earth,] which occur from place to place. The [stamp] of that image, which was displayed in the universe [spread to all, and] they received a stamp, it being revealed there, and an impress.

Now, this new birth that they begot in a new [form] in the world, is Adam and Eve. [There is not a] form in their world since the beginning like it; because that [im]age [occ]urs not in the worlds b[el]ow.

Not all the figures that have been fashioned were fashioned by birth from displayed intercourse. Rather, there are other figures fashioned [in another way].

One of them is the sea [gi]ant, the 'sweeping' from the sphere, which the [Father] of Life discharged into the sea. Its own fire and thought fashioned it [in] a figure.

The second figure is the one [that] fell to the earth. It made the sea its womb. Its own l[us]t became its sculptor. It alone fashioned it to a nature, which is the root of death. Yet, when it came up from the sea, it [rose up] that it might destroy the works [of the Father] of Life. They immediately sent against it the Adamant of Light, the great 'instruction of vigour'. He humbled it in the districts of the north. He has trampled underfoot and set h[im]self upon it, until the end of the world.

[The] third figure is the nature that fell on wh[at] is dr[y]. It] fashioned the tree and set itself there. [This is the] new figure that was fashioned [from within, and it]isplays.

So, in accord with the essence they [are of]ness; but yet th[ey] did not come with the King of Dark[ness to the wo]rld. Rather, their fashioning [came] about [by other means, and] they are composite and have been displayed in the world.

The Five Faculties and the Entry of the Light Mind

Primary Teaching

The formative power placed within the person faculties for reception and activity, organized with interior memory-stores. Each of the five capacities (intellectual sight, obedient reception, interior discernment, experiential taste, direct appropriation through action) has its own repositories, guarded by governing affections at every entrance. The will rules over all as sovereign. When Divine Wisdom descends, the ruling evils resist at every opening; yet by truth and holy awe it humbles them, takes their resistances, opens all orifices to good, and the Divine proceeds to reign — annulling the will of evil from first to last.

All [these a]bortions, amongst them are Saklas and his consort and the ones whom they have served [...], they are the ones that shaped Adam and Eve. How did they find this beautiful image laid over their shape, even though when it was displayed to their fathers they were not in existence? They never saw the image of the Ambassador! And how did they take the seal of the image of the Ambassador? They added it to [the] shape of Adam and Eve.

The Sin that spurted out from the rulers, which is Matter, shot up [tow]ards the image of the Ambassador. It was cut off from [tha]t place and came down to the earth, for they did not accept [it wi]thin the firmaments. When it came do[wn to] the earth, it formed the tree. It was established within the wood and formed the fruits. And when [the] abortions fell [to] the ground, to the earth, at the [second] time [... / ...].

[When it came up] fruits, it assumed the[m] and spoke in the ruler, their leader. He says to his companions: Come! Give me your light, and I will construct for you an image aft[er] the likeness of the exalted one. What he said, they did: they gave it to him, and he constructed [the image].

The Sin that s[putted out ... / ...] which is the Matter that saw the im[age of the Ambassa]dor and that formed the tre[e and was established i]n [i]t; afterwards it came up in the [and assumed them]. It went in to the rulers [and] they formed Adam and Eve after the [likeness of the] exalt[ed one]. Through the energy of the Sin that had s[een the image of the] Ambassador, it went into the (rulers) [through the fruits. It] assumed them and they [t]oo sculp[them. And they] begat each of them according to his destiny [...]; one he resembles, one he does not resemble.

The moulder placed in the form of Adam and Eve limbs, outside and within, for perception and activity. He was apportioned house by house. For everything that his perceptions and elements will receive externally there are internal storehouses and repositories and cavities; and what is received in to them is stored in them. Whenever they will be questioned about what is deposited in their internal storehouses, they bring out what they have received within and give it to the questioner who requested it of them.

In this way his faculty [...] outer [limbs] to look at [and receive] every type with [in ...].

Also [the fa]culty of the eyes [has] houses and cavities and repositories and stores within, so that every image it might see, whether good or evil, whether loveable or detestable or lustful, it can receive into its storehouses and repositories. Also, when the faculty of the eyes is pleased to send out the image that it saw and took in, it can go in to its storehouses [at the] time and think and seek [after it] and it brings it out [and] gives it to the questioner who requested it and the one who wan[t]ed it—whether it be something from lu[and desire, or a]n image of love [or ... / ... something] hateful. And thus shall that faculty (of the eyes) produce and do what it does in each category.

The faculty of the ears has its own storehouses also. Every sound it might receive, whether good or evil, shall be taken in and placed in its houses and inner repositories, and it is guarded in its [places] for a thousand days. After a thousand days, if someone comes and asks that faculty about the sound that it heard [at] this time and took into its storehouses, immediately it [sh]all g[o] into its repositories and seek and review and search after this word, and send it out from where it was first put, the place in which it was kept.

[In] like order, the faculty of scent [s]hall function just as that of the eyes and that of the auditory organs. Every [o]dour it shall smell it shall take in [to it] and [d]eposit in its inner storehouses. Every time it will be [a]sked by a questioner, it shall go in [to its repositories] and [search its] storehouse and remember [...] only these things.

However, even the mouth and the tongue within it, and the taste organ, have a faculty dwelling in them. Again, that faculty too, of taste, has thus cavities and repositories set apart for it. It too receives these tastes and gathers them in. A[nd] at any moment when someone will ask of a taste, if [it has received it] it shall send it out and remember tha[t] taste. It shall snare and give even the mar[k of] th[a]t taste; give its memory to the qu[est]ioner who asks for it.

Again, the fac[ul]ty of touch by the hands is also s[o]: When it might touch, touch shall [receive i]ts memory. And it [takes] it in to its inner repository [until] som[eo]ne will ask this faculty for the memory. [Immediately], it shall go in again and bring out the memory of this touch that it made, and give it to whoever asks for it.

And the faculty of the heart that rules over them all is much the most like this. Every thing that these five faculties will receive and put in store for the faculty of the heart it shall receive and guard. Any time that they will ask for their deposit it shall send out and give every thing that they gave to it.

For the counsel of the heart is like the king. All the ad[v]isers of his city and the leaders of his a[r]my are placed with him. Any time if his genera[ls] will entreat him for whatever they wish, he shall give them the ad[v]ice and opinion by which they move.

Furthermore, it is like a cellarman: [Eve]ry thing that will be entrusted to it by them, and given to it, it shall receive and put in separate vessels and places. Any time [... / ...].

[It shall find it] in the place that it put it.

This also is the way of the faculty of the body. The vision that the eyes will see and give to it, and it receives it in, it shall bring out again from the storehouses wherein it had placed it; and give it to whoever asks for it.

Again, [the] sound that the ears will hear and give to it, and it receives it from them. At any time when someone will ask it for that sound, it shall bring out and give the sound of the ears to whoever has asked it for that sound. It shall bring out and give the sound of the ears to whoever has asked.

Again, [the] faculty of smell in this same pattern; and that of taste is of the same [ty]pe. The touch by the han[ds ... / ...] they shall bring it out in to [... / ...] And whenever they will as[k it] for it, it shall bring it out and gi[ve it].

Indeed, watchmen are a[t] these doors guarding them, and bolts are fastened on the doors at the hands of the guards that guard them!

Just like watchmen guarding a camp with towers and watch-posts. As the holding rooms come out from there and the bolts are upon the gates, the guards control the bolts of the gates while they sit at the entrance [of] the watchposts. So, someone who belongs to their city as a fellow [cit]izen of them, belonging to their country, for him they shall open [the ga]te and receive him in by their will. However, the foreigner who comes they shall prevent, and leave him standing at the gate. They shall not yield to let

him enter. Again, another one whom they will receive in, with great trouble before [they] take him in, you shall find many holding rooms [... / ...] that [...] there are a mass [... / ...] them. The number of d[oor] bolts [upon the gates] are [many] Whenever someone will wish [...] the bolts at his hand, opens the gate and brings out whoever is hidden within.

This body too is like the mighty camp. And the gates of the camp with their guards are like the orifices and organs of the body. Now, the orifices of the body are of sight, hearing and smell; and they that send out words. There are many sentinels and a mass of guards placed over the limbs of the body, guarding their orifices. And the faculty in it is the directive of the body, the queen of the entire camp; so that whenever it wishes it can open, or when it wishes it can shut.

However, if and wh[en] the Light Mind comes, it shall tu[rn i]n to the orifices of the body. The rulers, who [a]re the door gua[rds], shall h[in]der and restrain it from en[ter]ing. They shall bind the circu[it] of the body so that the foreign[er] can not enter it.

Nevertheless, the Light Mind by its wisdom and awe and diligence shall hum[ble] the guards who are set at the body's orifices. When it finishes humbling them it shall take fr[o]m them bolts to all the orifices of the body. Now, the orifices that had been opened before to the parades of lust, to receive in the sights of pleasure, to transfer the [wor]ds of the practice of li[f]e's concerns, to receive in the t[astes] of the different foods and unclean meals together with the sin therein; whoever stops receiving th[is] in, his heart and mind shall follow after.

By the power of the Light Mind that has suffused him and lived in the body he has humbled Lust, the goddess of the body.

[S]imply, all orifices in similar fashion were opening at one time to wickedness, but now have opened to the good. Sin was ruling in the body this time, doing anything it liked, having none in command.

Yet, [n]ow, authority has been taken from the Sin in the org[ans] of the body. The Living Spirit has become lord over all its limbs. It has bound them with a chain of peace, and sealed them with the seal of truth. It has opened the orifices of the body to the good, and because of this the good enters them through the ears and the eyes. It dwells in the heart. The H[o]ly Spirit reigns. It does all that it pleases. It annuls [the] will of [S]in, the begin-ning and the end. [In contrast], the will of the [Ho]ly Spir[it] comes about, and the purpose of the Light Mind.

The Diminishing of Spiritual Generations

Primary Teaching

The Most Ancient Church was immense in spiritual capacity with abundant states of interior life. Five degrees of governing dominion (complete celestial state, spiritual change, natural illumination, particular influx, momentary perception) succeed one another through the ages. Under the first, spiritual offspring were vast and enduring; under each subsequent degree, they diminish in capacity and abundance — until the present, when spiritual life has contracted to almost nothing and minds are brought forth only one by one, diminished and impaired.

About Adam, the first man. When he was fashioned, how did they sculpt him? Or, how did they beget him? Rather, is his begetting like the begetting that is brought forth today, amongst humankind; or not? Does a distinction exist between his birth and the one that they bring forth today?

Now, no[te] that Adam is mighty in his stature, and great is his size. Even his years are many! He spent many years living in the world. And he is not the only one we have found to be mighty; but all the others who were begotten in his generation, many are their years too. Still, these people who are born today, their stature has been diminished in power; even their years are lessened. Also, why is the birth today, of [the]y who are born, altered compared with that of these first [generations, from] place to place? See, even the stars and signs of the zodiac continue in their positions. Why now have the age and the years of these last ones diminished, and he has also become smaller, compared to these ancient ones who belong to these first generations?

They increased, have turned, and diminished; because there are five types of authorities and leaders appointed in the sphere of zodiacal signs, and the heavens above it. They have names they are ca[lled] by: the first name is the year; the sec[on]d is the month; the third is the day; the fou[rth] is the hour; the fifth is the moment. Now, these five positions, and these five houses, exist in the sphere and the heavens. These places have five powers, and they are made masters over them. The master of the year exists; the master of the month exists; the master of the day exists; the master of the hour exists; the master of the moment exists. In turn one is above his companion; and in turn the one above is made the master over the one below him.

So, mankind is begotten, and [the ani]mals. They are born in these powers. And, thus, these powers have received authority since the beginning of creation till the end of the world. Now, in the beginning of the generations the powers who were masters over the years reigned. Therefore, because of this, the offspring born in their generations and their lifetime: their years were found to be greater. They attain a long life span in the generation of Adam, and [tha]t of Sethel his son, and that of the ones who came after him.

After they ceased to reign, namely the powers who are masters over the years; the powers who are masters over the months themselves reigned. Like the months, for they are less than the years; again this [is] also the case with the offspring w[ho were] born in them. Their life span is less [than the life span of the ones born] in the generation of the powers who master the years!

When the authority of the powers who master the months was completed; the powers of the days received authority after them. Therefore, like the days, for they are less than the months, this also is the case with the offspring who were born in them. Their life span is less than the life span of the ones born in the powers who are masters over the months. Again, even so the offspring who were born in the hours, and of the moments. Their conduit is less than that of the months and the days.

The life span of the people has drawn in to nothing. Their days have diminished. Their years have become less; because the life and the ligh[t that] was in the world in these first generations was more

than that of today. Indeed, because of this have they diminished in their stature. Their life span has become less for them.

By what sort of birth was the entire offspring of mankind made from one man and one woman, Adam and Eve?

For the manner of these first generations is that they are richer in their light and purer in stature. Even their years are greater. Thus, again, even their offspring is much more than the offspring of this tim[e]. They were spending a longer time [being fashioned] in [the w]omb of their mother. Afterwards, they [brought forth] a number in a single womb. There are times five were brought forth from a single womb, and times six were brought forth from [a] single womb! There are some lesser than this; again, some greater than this. Indeed, because of this the offspring of Eve multiplied, and of her children. The earth was filled by reason of them alone.

For, they whom they beget today, in these last generations, they stand diminished and maimed. And, indeed, one by one do they bri[ng t]hem [forth] from a single womb. Hardly two, or [l]ess or more. They are even made ugly in their aspect, being diminished in their size, and feeble in their limbs.

The Four Grievs of the External Truths

Primary Teaching

The inmost Divine Love and the Celestial Principle grieve perpetually over the captive divine life. The external truths that clothe the Divine Human passed through four states of deep anguish: perceiving the oncoming falsity and advancing into combat; being left behind when the Celestial ascended; being stripped and placed beneath all degrees by the Living Spirit; and the fourth, most terrible — grieving at the final consummation for those souls permanently severed from peace, who will never find rest. In this fourth grief, they grieve not for themselves but for others.

The first who grieves is the first Mother of Life. She is sad because of her children who are set in affliction, for they were conjoined with the Darkness and the [poi]son. They have been bound with the entire ruling-power. For what was she grieving, [wa]tching over them taking these afflictions? Whenever she might [s]ee them and how suffering is brought upon them, she shall grieve and be unhappy on account of them.

[The s]econd one who is troubled of heart is the First Man, whose [great]ness and kingdom is established in the li[ght] ship [of the moon]. And he too is troubled of heart because of his five sons who are set in the midst of danger. For any time he may see that they are given trouble, always he might hear the sound of their weeping as they cry out because of the blows and wounds of the enemy who assaults them daily; and as he sees them like this constantly, he shall g[ri]eve and mourn on account of his [s]o[n]s.

The garments, the sons of the First Man, wept bitterly three times. Then they were silent. There is a fourth time of weeping, for they will weep at the end. And then their crying can stop, and they will never again weep from this time on.

Now, the first time of their weeping is when they had seen the darkness, the enemy being about to burst out against them. They understood everything that would happen to them. They were aware of the one that would rise and come upon them, but by necessity they hastened to him and fought with him. They mastered him, they detained him. They bound him with their body and their limbs, they overcame his death and his fire and his darkness.

[The] second time that they wept is [when the]ir father, the First Man, [ascend]ed from the [abyss] of darkness and left them behind; that is the time when he stripped [them off] and left them below. Indeed, when th[ey] s[aw] how the First Man had risen out of the abyss and [l]eft them behind, and that they were abandoned in the enmit[y, th]ey wept and were sore of heart. Still, what could they do, wishing [to go up after him? Yet by necessity they gave] their heart to every affliction. They [remained b]ehind and grew [s]ick under the pressure of the weighty burden of all the works, until the end time.

[The] third time that they wept is when the Living Spirit stripped off the three garments of activity, placing them beneath all things. He gave them a sign to lift their heads and rise to the heights from that place; and to pass and journey through all the earths until they should reach the land of tranquilli[t]y and peace, the place of rest prepared for them. So, when they had seen him, that he had separated himself from them, while they themselves remained behind after him and had not ascended; at that moment when they stayed behind these three garments wept. After their crying, they turned their [hear]t to all the heights that were concealed from them, and were of one mind. For [they would] soar up and come to the heights; and pass over all things until the time that was ordained for them all [should come] at the end of the worlds.

[The f]ourth time when they will weep is when the [S]tatue will be taken up on the last day, and they will weep [for] the souls of the liars and blasphemers; for they may give [them no help] because their

limbs have been severed [and given to the powers] of the darkness. And also [th]ose souls, when the Statue will go up and they are left alo[n]e, they will weep in that they will rema[in] behind in affliction for ever. For they wi[ll be cut off] and separated from the Last Statue. An[d it is] a necessity to take these souls who are ready for loss as retribution for the deeds that they have done. They go i[n to] this [darkne]ss and are bound with the Darkness; just as they desired it and loved it, and placed their treasure with it. At that very moment, when the Last Statue rises up, the[y wi]ll weep. And then they will scream out loud because they will be severed from the company of this great Statue. And they remain behind for ever. This great weeping [and separation] is terrible, it occurs in front of the souls and [the spirits] who are ready for loss in accordance with their deeds. And they [will] weep with that crying, they will never be silent; because they will not attain rest from this time on.

So, they too are the garments of these elements. This fourth time of weeping is heart-rending for them. It is much worse for them than these other three times of weeping before. This fourth time the weeping is not for themselves. Rather they weep and are heartsore for these soul[s] who will be cut off from peace, because rest will not come about for them, to allow them to rest from torment for ever.

The Body as Spiritual Correspondence

Primary Teaching

The corporeal body has limbs hidden and visible, some receiving blows and some not — corresponding to the hidden Father, the two visible light ships (sun and moon = eyes), the living soul grasped and struck like the body, and the tongue that reveals all that happens within and without. Jesus the Splendour is like the tongue: revealing both the hidden outer aeons and the visible ships, proclaiming about the beating and wounding of the soul, and its peace, cleansing, and healing.

Just as the corporeal body has limbs that are hidden, so it also has others that are visible. They can be seen upon it, they can be grasped and receive blows and wounds, whilst others can neither be grasped nor receive blows.

So it is also with this entire greatness, as we resemble it. Some of it is hidden, whilst some of it is visible; some of it is far away from the blows and suffering, whilst some of it receives blows and wounds.

Now, thus the directive of the body that lives within, hidden in the storehouses inside the body and unseen. So it is also how the Father, the God of truth, exists; as he too is hidden in his kingdom, not displayed before this outer desolation.

Thus, too, the body has two eyes that are visible and seen, and are even the body's source of illumination; so there are also these two light ships that shine and are seen in the entire universe and the whole of creation. The light has never been hidden, just like the two eyes of the body.

The living soul too is like this; it is established in apparent silence. In its apparent silence it is grasped and receives blows from these five fleshs, which destroy (the soul) and strike it. It can be likened to the mystery of the corporeal body, as it can be grasped and mastered, can receive blows and wounds.

Also, thus this tongue that speaks, proclaims, reprimands and reveals about everything happening in this body, inside and outside, also the considerations and bodily knowledges. The tongue, which is outside, makes it manifest. It also proclaims about the honour and shame of the body. And it speaks, unveiling the pain of the body that is sick from its sores.

This is also what Jesus the Splendour is like, who shall be sent from the greatness. He manifests and reveals about everything, both the external and the internal, both what is above and what is below. Be it about the outer aeons that are hidden and not displayed, or about the ships of light that are seen: he is the one who unveils about them. He is also the one who reveals about their glory, and the greatness that dwells in them.

And regarding this beating and wounding of the living soul, Jesus is the one who reveals it. He also preaches about (the soul) and its peace. He also reveals about its cleansing and healing.

Part 11

The Correspondences of Heaven and Earth

Extended correspondential teachings on natural phenomena as signs of spiritual realities: the immensity of divine truth and three foundational truths, divine love and hatred as the two fundamental principles of all spiritual reality, the three essential qualities of the earliest humanity and the seven reasons evil formed the natural human, the sun as divine wisdom (seven works of day, seven evils of night, five archetypes, three mysteries), fire as love (five operations), the zodiac and five stars as evil ordered within providence, and the complete correspondence between the human body and the spiritual universe.

Foundational Truths, Divine Love, and the Three Qualities of the First Humanity

Primary Teaching

The immensity of the containing form of divine truth: the celestial principle confronted rulers exceeding all comprehension, giving fire, wind, and water — yet the rulers consumed the truths and could not be satiated. Three foundational truths established in the external degrees: the sustaining power of divine wisdom, the regenerated natural mind over the mind of falsity, and the divine perception from Divine Truth itself. Divine Love versus primordial hatred: love is the Divine giving itself for everything; hatred is the first death that ruined its own offspring and assaulted what was foreign to it. Three essential qualities in the earliest humanity: the divine likeness received inward, the interior arrangement through five faculties of perception, and the correspondence of the entire spiritual world inscribed upon it. Seven reasons the proprial powers formed the natural human.

How great is the power of the garment of the waters? How far shall [it extend]? The source from which all these waters burst forth, how great will it be?

[At] the time when the First Man assumed the elements, and stood [fi]rm against the first enmity that had come about in the Darkness, he defied these great and powerful rulers. They are immeasurable, greater than the extent or size of thousands and ten thousands of parasangs. At the start, when he spread the fight against them, he gave them fire and wind; and afterwards he gave the garment of the waters to the rulers of death. So they, the rulers, drank in and consumed those waters. Many [waters] poured forth from the garment of waters [from which] the rivers flow. The mouth of the rulers [devoured] those [waters], the warriors of destruction [and they] laboured and brought them forth.

There were seven (rivers) flowing in to the mouth of each one of them, as they shall not [suffice] to a single stomach, to their fill; because in turn the descent to its stomach shall burn them with its fire and heat. Those rulers were like the [depths] of [the sea]; they were not emptied; rain and [rivers throughout] their existent days.

The measure of that river was expanded seven times, as they flow [out] of the body of the [living] waters [until] now.

[This] is how great a struggle, since it has [overcome] these creatures of destruction, the mighty giants. Behold, they are entwined, bound, and [sealed] in every place. They are hidden, not revealed before the eyes of every flesh that exists on the land of death [and darkness]. These rulers [shall be] revealed. The entire universe of flesh will be destroyed and dissolved [with them]; all pass away [and perish]. They will be destroyed with their angry voice, which is mightier than the thunder.

This small stream is reckoned [as nothing] before the vastness of these waters. For only one river from thousands of rivers of water, from the secrets that are not revealed, is the river Tigris upon the earth.

Three great rocks, which exist, were appointed by the greatness. They were set in these outer worlds.

So, the first rock is the [Pillar] of Glory, the Perfect Man, which was summoned [by the] glorious Ambassador. He set it in this zone; [and he] brought forth its base (?) from the earth to heaven. It bore up under the [en]tire uni[verse], and became first of all the weight-carriers in [it]s powers. In its firmness it has been set upright, and has made fast every [t]hing above and below.

[The] second great and glorious rock is the new earth of light, which was set upon the earth of Darkness. It has squashed the fastenings of the five storehouses of death. It has established firmness, with great firmness, over and beyond the earth of Darkness. It has flattened, crushed and fixed the root of

death.

[The] third rock is the great thought, which was summoned from Jesus, the glorious one. It has stood firm, with a true fixity, for ever.

[These] are the three great rocks, they that have come forth in great confidence, in three great and honoured places. They were appointed and distributed in three great places of these [self]same worlds. They were made fast according to the will of the greatness.

What is love? [Love is the Father.][He has been revealed to] each [aeon], calling it 'love'.

Love is the Father of Greatness, who dwells in his glorious land. The entirety of the divine has been revealed [there]in! These two are a single living body, the Father and his love; because he has given himself for every thing, as he exists in his aeons. Indeed, due to this, they called the Father, the Lord of the totality, 'love'. For he gave the victory to his aeons and his limbs.

What, conversely, is hate? Hate is the first death that welled up. It revealed the land of Darkness. This one called 'hate', because it has ruined all its perdition's offspring; it sinned even against a power foreign to it, and ruined it. Due to this they shall call it 'hated'; for it has caused destruction, both wounding in flesh, and what is not its own.

Today again it causes wounding and destruction in all flesh. It kills them all with diverse deaths; these that are displayed today in every thing, in every type. Even the Cross of Light, the living soul, likewise too it ruins and kills them; as it did at the start. Indeed, due to this have they called it 'hated', this one from the hated; the envy from the envy; the devil from the devil; the bad that came about from the bad.

Three great things that are distinct were revealed in Adam the first human. Indeed, due to this, he was found to be better and more outstanding than the conjoined powers that are in heaven and on earth.

The first: The image of the exalted one was placed upon him. The creators and moulders of his body sealed him after the shining form of the image that had been displayed to them above. Indeed, due to this, the image of Adam was found to be surpassingly beautiful beyond any conjoined power above and below.

The second thing: Adam was shaped in his structure through the light of the first-born of heaven and [earth, and through] the five sons. Indeed, due to this, his structure was found to differ from the structure of even the other creations; [sin]ce the form of all creations is different. As for Adam, the formation of his soul fits over the correct distribution of the elements. Therefore, he has intelligence surpassing that of the other creations and beasts.

The third are the teachings and counsels and the seal of all the powers above and below. The creators, who set him in order, gathered them and sealed them in him. Adam and his consort Eve became a dwelling and home for the signs of the zodiac and the stars; and the months, the days and the years. For the seal of the entire universe is stamped upon Adam. Indeed, due to this, heaven and earth moved because of him; trouble and disorder arose on his account between they that are good and they that are evil. So, the good induce him to life because of their image and shape placed upon him; while the [wi]cked were drawing him to death, so that they would have power through him and they would conceive the kingdom, and through him humiliate the entire universe.

The rulers determined and formed Adam so that they would be masters through him and conceive the kingdom because of seven things.

The first: He became the enlightener in their creation; instead of the light of the image of the Ambassador who had displayed himself to them above. For they all desired the likeness of the image of the Ambassador. Their heart was drawn after it.

The second: So that they would scoop up the light through him and restrain and obstruct it from its ascent to the heights.

The third: So that because of the image of the Ambassador that is placed upon him the entirety of the divine that is above and below would be humiliated; on account of the likeness of the splendour, of the beauty of his superiority. For he is superior in his appearance to all creatures.

The fourth: He is a seal-ring and a new impression, so that all births who will be begotten might be brought forth after his seal.

The fifth: That might be displayed through him all the skill[s] of the powers, they above and below, secret and manifest; and that they might determine through him the totality, and every thing be revealed in him.

The sixth: That there would come to be a great protection for them through the image of the exalted one that was placed upon him; for as the heavenly would [not harm them, nor] even rulers; and no evil thing would be done to them on account of Adam.

The seventh: That he might become chief and king and master over all creatures; and they might conceive the kingdom through him.

The Sun and Moon: Seven Works of Day, Seven Evils of Night

Primary Teaching

Divine Wisdom as the sun accomplishes seven works in every state of illumination: opening intellectual sight, bringing peace, awakening the sleeping, nourishing all perceptions, driving evil into hiding, dissolving persuasions of falsity, and displaying the glory of heavenly states. The state of darkness accomplishes seven evils: filling the mind with falsity, inflicting dread, arousing rebellion, imposing spiritual torpor, hiding spiritual beauty, empowering evil affections, and displaying the sign of Evil itself. Five archetypes made apparent through divine wisdom, three mysteries of the first greatness, and two profound arcana of influx and withdrawal.

The greatness of the sun and its divinity: how was it fashioned after the likeness of the first greatness?

It is the gate of life and the vessel of peace, to this great aeon of light [from which it came forth]. it is the gate of the souls' departure.

Every day, would this great light-giver shine its light, it shall do seven good things for them.

The first good thing that it does for them is its light, which it shines upon them. It opens the eyes of all mankind. They see underfoot as they walk by it. It takes away the blindness of the night, which made them blind with its darkness.

The second: When (the sun) is come to the world, with its coming it shall bring calm and peace to the entire world. With its coming it shall also take away from them all the fear and trembling, which their heart is filled with the whole night; for it shall take away the darkness present by its light, and sweep it out. Also, this is how it extinguishes fear by its calm.

The third is its vigil; because when (the sun) comes to the world all sleeping mankind shall arise and awake. And the watchmen too shall cease from watching. The guards who sit at the gates of camps, they break vigil at the watchposts, because of its light that has shone upon them in the world.

The fourth: It shall nourish, and give strength, taste and scent, to the trees and fruits and vegetables, and all the herbs, and the flowers and grasses, which are upon the entire earth.

The fifth: When (the sun) shines in all the world, the evil reptile and the sharp-toothed beasts that are filled of wickedness, they shall flee to hiding in their dens.

The sixth: When it shines its light, the wound of any person is eased from pain. Its light shall melt away the evil arts of every doer of wickedness.

The seventh: (The sun) shall display and manifest to the world the sign of the splendour of the aeons of light, from which it has come out; it here in this world being their sign. It brings light to the whole of creation.

It has all wickednesses therein. Every occasion, would the night fall, it shall do seven evils in the world.

The first wickedness that the night shall do in the world is the darkness, with which it shall fill the entire world; because when the sun sinks from the world and draws to it its rays, at that instant the shadow of the night shall spread out over the whole world. The eyes of the people fill with blackness. They neither see nor wonder with their eyes, because of the darkness of the night which shall fill the whole world.

The second evil thing that the night shall do is its fear; because when its shadow looms forth, its fear and its trembling shall possess all of mankind. The entire world shall fill of the night.

The third: When the night falls, all creatures take up revolt. They rebel in their heart, to do wickedness and perdition.

The fourth: The heaviness of sleep shall lay upon them, and they fall asleep; they slumber and doze, and they are like these corpses in the night.

The fifth is its ugliness; again, when the night would fall, the form of the people shall be hidden in the darkness and the ugliness of the night. The beauty and the form of men and women shall not be displayed before one another, because of its darkness and its ugliness, which it shall spread out over all their forms.

The sixth occasion is when the night would fall on the world. At that instant evil people shall come out to do wickedness; the adulterers, and the robbers and poisoners. The evil beasts shall come out, and all the reptiles that are filled with wickedness, from their dens. And they stalk in the night. Also, the demons and fiends find power to do wickedness in the night. Again, the blows and buffets and wounds and discharges shall torment people in the night; because in it the whole of evil shall find strength.

The seventh: The night shall display the sign of the Darkness, its father. It has arisen out of its essence; because this night that came out of this first Darkness has been displayed in the world. Note this night, the shadow of this first Darkness, the one that is entwined and bound in all things above and below.

There are five archetypes occur in the sun, it making them [manifest to all] as it finds the world.

The first is its light; for it illumines by its light the world, and all the creatures who exist in it.

The second is its beauty; because when it shines, it shall flood beauty and loveliness upon all creatures and everything.

The third is its peace; for, again, when the sun would shine on the world, all people shall receive affection through it, and give peace to one another.

The fourth is the life of the living soul, which it shall release from all the bonds and fetters of heaven and earth.

The fifth: It gives a strength to the elements; and also it gives a scent and a taste to the entire Cross of the Light.

Its light illumines more than all lights that occur in the world. Also, its beauty is more beautiful than all the beauties of mankind. Again, its peace is more surpassing than all the powers and guards who exist in the world. Its releasing action, by which it releases the living soul, is a full day ahead of all releasing actions! The strength that it gives to its limbs is a great strength, being mightier than all strengths!

Once again, there are another three archetypes made apparent by the sun, in respect of the mystery of the first greatness.

The first is the filling up of the disk of its ship; because its ship has filled up every season, and shall not wane at all, the way that the ship of the moon wanes. This continuous filling, by which it is filled, displays the mystery of the Father, the great greatness; from whom all the powers and the gods have come forth. He shall never wane, nor shall lack ever exist in him!

The second: (The sun's) light surpasses the light of all the stars, and all the lights that occur in the universe; corresponding to the mystery of the light of the Father; for his light surpasses and is greater than the light of his aeons.

The third: This sun is very high above all else. It surpasses the height of all the mountains and hills that exist upon the entire earth, corresponding to the mystery of the Father of Greatness; for he is high above all the household of his light-earth. Also, because the Father himself is high above all the heights

and the mountains of his light-earth. He is 'filled up' in his image [all] the time and every hour from eternity to eternity!

The mystery of the first great light is the sun, which is this second light-giver, the one that comes daily to the world. It displays all the marks of its graces, displaying and signifying on its own behalf that it is good, out of the essence of the good. It came from the good Father and appeared in this world.

This night that is made of fear exists after the mystery of the Darkness. Behold too the mystery of its essence! It displays it in the world in all these wickednesses. It displays this mystery daily in the world.

Two great mysteries are apparent in this shining sun, at its rising and setting. Now, at the moment when it rises and is visible in the universe, all creatures of flesh shall lift up their heads fr[om their sleep] towards the splendour of the sun, and open their doors. While at evening time, when the sun sinks from the universe, all people from every place and even all beasts shall go in to their dark hiding places. The population of the entire universe shuts their doors and dark night overcomes them. They go inside and stay within the dark night in their hiding places.

Very great is this mystery revealed by the sun! For when the sun rises and [be]come[s] visible at the beginning of the day all people open their doors, and all of humanity and every creature emerges onto the ear[th] to destroy this Light Cross that is established i[n] silence.

This pertains to the mystery of the First Man, because when he came out from the grea[t]ness he shone forth over all the children of Darkness. At that mome[nt] all the children of Darkness came forth from their storehouses, its powers and its armies, abandoning their caves and their black abyss. They destroyed the [outer] body of his five sons, who were swathed over hi[s b]o[dy, in t]hat first struggle.

Again, when the sun sinks from the universe and sets, and all people go in to their hiding places and houses and conceal themselves; this also pertains to the mystery of the end, as it presages the consummation of the universe. For, when all the light will be purified and redeemed i[n] the universe at the last, the collector of all things, the Last Statue, will gather in and sculpt it/self. It is the last hour of the day, the time when the Last Statue will go up to the aeo[n of] light. The enemy too, death, will go in to bondage; to the prison of the souls of the de[ni]iers and blasphemers who loved the darkness. They will go in with it to bondage and the dark night overcomes th[em]; and thenceforth this name 'light' will not shine upon them.

Behold the two mysteries made visible daily in the sun, which is this splendrous light-giver.

Five Works of Fire and the Zodiac Ordered Within Providence

Primary Teaching

Love performs five spiritual operations: consuming what is merely natural, separating interior qualities from residues, bestowing perception and warmth, forming the containing vessels of the mind, and manifesting wisdom. The twelve zodiacal signs and five ruling stars: twelve governing principles of depravity seized from five genera of hell and constrained upon the revolving natural mind, with five principal evil affections. Yet Divine Good and Divine Truth — strangers to evil — are counted within the same system because they govern and subjugate all these evils at every moment.

This fire, which burns and is apparent today in the world, it does five works.

The first work that it does is this: It incinerates and burns wood, and everything that shall be placed upon it.

The second: It separates four aspects of the wood, which are these: fire and light, ash and smoke.

The third: It gives a taste and an aroma to whatever will be cooked on it. It also gives heat and cheer to whoever will be close to it.

The fourth work that [it] does: All craftsmen shall work the utensils that they will fabricate in it.

The fifth: It shall display light, and the people see by [it].

The twelve signs of the zodiac that are set in the sphere. How are they determined? Or to what place do they belong, according to their essence? Or else again, these five stars that circle in them, from whence are they? Or why has the demiurge appointed them as the authorities and leaders? He is the great constructor who has appointed the entire creation; and he has bound and fixed them on the sphere.

Whether these twelve signs of the zodiac that are fixed on the sphere, or these five stars that circle upon them; those and these are rulers, all of them, according to their essence. They are all enemies and rivals to each other □ one oppresses another, they threaten each other □. They plunder one another by the action of the great craftsman who has formed all the worlds. He has gathered [them] and bound them on the sphere above, which circles constantly. Now, while it circles and tumbles them, so they shall do everything that they desire, above and below, according to their pleasure. Nevertheless, a guardian is over them, a debt-collector above them; compelling, extorting, and taking what is theirs away from them!

Now, this is how it can rightly be understood. They were [s]eized from the five worlds of Darkness, and bound on the sphere. Two zodiacal signs were taken per world. Gemini and Sagittarius belong to the world of smoke, which is the mind. In contrast, Aries and Leo belong to the world of fire. Taurus, Aquarius and Libra belong to the world of wind. Cancer and Virgo and [P]isces belong to the world of water. Capricorn and Scorpio belong to the world of Darkness. These are the twelve rulers of depravity, the ones that wicked[ness] shall not [leave] For they cause all the evil and [corruption in the wo]rld, whether in tree or in flesh.

And understand also about these five stars, the leaders: from where were they formed? The star of Zeus (Jupiter) was generated from the world of smoke, which is the mind. In contrast, Aphrodite (Venus) came about from the world of fire. And then Ares (Mars) belongs to the world of wind. Hermes (Mercury) belongs to the world of water. Cronos (Saturn) belongs to the world [of] Darkness.

And also, the two ascendants are counted to fire and desire, the dry and the moist. They are the father and the mother of all these.

And also, the sun and the moon, which are counted in with them as a rule □[counte]d to their kind, but why did they count them in with them?□ so that they would reign over them. You will discover they subjugate them at every moment.

These seven we have named, the five stars and the two ascendants: They are the doers of wickedness that do every wicked and bad act in every land, the whole of it, above and below, in every creature, in the dry and the moist, in tree and flesh.

[They] are distributed, appointed on four sides, three per angle in these four places. And they are fixed to this revolving sphere. Aries, Leo and Sagittarius, they three belong to a single side. In contrast, Taurus, Capricorn and Virgo, these other three belong to another side. And then, Gemini, Libra and Aquarius belong to another side. Scorpio, Pisces and Cancer belong to another corner. Now, they are placed like this, appointed to these four parts, and distributed on the sphere.

So, when the side of Aries, Leo and Sagittarius will be plundered by the guardian who is over it, who extorts from it and the leaders who move upon it; at that instant shall affliction strike all the four-footed creatures below. However, when [the side] of Taurus, Virgo and Capricorn will be plundered; [affliction] shall at once befall the herbs, together with the vegetables and all the fruits of the trees. Yet again, when the side of Scorpio, Pisces and Cancer will be plundered; scarcity shall befall the waters upon the earth, and drought be from place to place. Conversely, should the side of Gemini, Libra and Aquarius be plundered; deformity and stuntedness shall befall the form of mankind from place to place.

These twelve signs of the zodiac: They were fashioned from the five worlds of Darkness, and bound on the sphere.

The other five, the stars: They too came about from the five worlds of the land of Darkness.

The [t]wo ascendants: They are set to the mystery of fire and desire. They are the dry and the moist, the father and the mother.

The sun and the moon: They are strangers to them. Still, because of the constraint of the arrangement, in that the thing receives light, and as they belong and plunder them; because of this they were counted in with them in relation to the calculation of the number. For, the sun and the moon are from out of the greatness, not belonging to the stars and the signs of the zodiac.

The Human Body as Image of the Spiritual World

Primary Teaching

The whole spiritual world reflects the form of the Grand Human: the head as the five external truths, the heart as the revolving cycle of spiritual life, the body as the successive degrees. Five principal provinces of spiritual governance correspond to the face, heart, genitals, stomach, and feet. Four discrete degrees exist within each person (celestial, spiritual, natural, sensual), each with seven governing faculties. The twelve zodiacal states are mapped upon the body from head to feet. Innumerable governing affections inhabit the body, and when they conflict, spiritual eruptions occur — requiring the purging of falsity until the wounds close and healing is found.

This whole universe, above and below, reflects the pattern of the human body; as the formation of this body of flesh accords to the pattern of the universe.

Its head is like the first-fruits of the five garments. And, from its neck down to the site of its heart, it resembles the pattern of the ten firmaments. And again, the heart accords to the wheel of the rotating sphere. And, from its heart down to its intestines (?), is like this atmosphere that extends from the sphere down to the earth. The [male] part of the body corresponds to this great earth. And also, from its intestines (?) down to its loins is like the three earths. And also, its shinbones to the pattern of the space in which the Porter stands. Its footsoles to the great earth upon which the Porter is stood; and the four fastenings that are under his feet. Its liver to the vessel of fire. Its flesh to the vessel of darkness. Its blood to the vessel of water.

The small body corresponds to the macro-cosmos in its firmaments, in its orderings, in its mountains, its walls and its vessels.

There exist five great camps in this great outer zone, of which the five sons of the Living Spirit are masters.

So, in the first watch-station above, of which the Keeper of Splendour is master, on the battlement of all the works, is found his authority over the three heavens. Then the ones below him [are under the authority of] the great King of Honour.

The second watch, of which the great King of Honour is master, his own authority (extends) over the seven firmaments beneath him.

The third watch, of which the Adamant [is master, his authority] reigns from the firmament down below to the [earth]. [And he] invigorates, according to his authority, the sphere and the worlds of the atmosphere; and the other four worlds that are appointed on this earth.

The fourth watch, over which the King of Glory has power, is the three wheels. And his authority lies over the three earths upon the head of the Porter.

The fifth watch is the watch over which the Porter is authoritative. Again, he is master, according to his authority, over this great earth he stands upon, and the four fastenings under his feet.

Affliction has come about in these five watches from time to time.

So, in the watch of the Keeper of Splendour, Sin desired to spurt up towards the image of the Ambassador. Yet, they barred it from that place, and it fell back down in shame.

Again, an earthquake and treachery occurred in the watch of the great King of Honour, which the watchers who had arisen at the time and had [sinned] they who were sent came down, until they were humbled.

Also, in the watch of the Adamant, the abortions came to the earth and fashioned [the] figure of flesh.

Again, in the watch of the King of Glory, a commotion happened in these three earths above the Porter. The pathway was obstructed for the ascent of these three wheels; that of wind, that of water, and that of fire.

Also, in the watch of the Porter, the fastenings beneath were laid bare and strained their chains. A great earthquake befell that place.

[Like] these five watch-stations, which exist in this great [outer zone as these five] camps: this is also the case with this body. There are another five camps there, and the Light Mind is watching over them, and the new man who is with him.

The configuration of his face, which is above his body: the mystery of the Keeper of Splendour, who rules over the watch above the zone.

His heart: the sign of the great King of Honour, who subdues the seven heavens.

His genitals: the mystery of the Adamant of Light, the one who subdues Matter.

The stomach and the fire that is in him: the likeness of the King of Glory, the one who turns the wheels, sending the life above.

The ruling-power that is beneath in his feet: the Porter, the one who subdues with his footsoles the abysses below.

Also, the teaching of wisdom, which circulates in that body: to the likeness of the Virgin of Light, who goes up and comes down in this zone, above and below.

Love and joy, faith and truth: they are to the likeness of these two light ships. For, the living soul should go up in them and become free through them; and it ascends from the abysses below and arrives at the heights above.

There exist four worlds in this body of the flesh, and there exist countless times seven rulers in the body of the four worlds!

So, the first world is from its neck up; and also the seven rulers who are in this upper world are these: the two organs of sight, and the two of hearing, and the two of smell. The other one is the mouth, which is the organ of taste.

The second world is from its neck down to its entire upper torso. And also, the seven rulers who are in this second world are: its two arms that accord to the pattern of its two ears, which occur in its first world above; and its two breasts that are to the pattern of its organs of smell; and the two eyes of its heart; and the gullet of the stomach between the two breasts, which in the chest is the pattern of the mouth.

Once more, there exist seven rulers in the third world of the body, which are these: the fat, the lung, the spleen, the liver, the gall, and its two kidneys.

Also, the fourth world below. There are another seven there of this same kind: its two buttocks (?), and its two testicles, and its two loins; and the member out of which the seed comes, that begets all the forms.

Aries and Taurus, Gemini, Cancer, Leo, Virgo, Libra, Scorpio, Sagittarius, Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces; these are the twelve signs of the zodiac that occur in the worlds above, on the sphere. They are interlocked and bound on this turning wheel, the one in which they are [set], fixed, and planted. And, regarding all these twelve signs of the zodiac, this is how they were appointed and made leaders [in their

order] on the sphere beneath the heaven that is the wheel of the stars. Now, they are appointed like this, they are thus, so that you can find the head of [each one] and you find the tail too [in the one set against it].

Again, they occur like this, these that we have recited, one after another in this body. They are counted by order and number from the head to the feet. Its head is Aries. Its neck and its shoulders are Taurus. Its two arms Gemini. Its upper torso is Cancer. Its stomach is Leo. Its belly is Virgo. The vertical spine and its intestines (?) are Libra. Its genitals Scorpio. Its loins are Sagittarius. Its knees are Capricorn. Its shinbones are Aquarius. The soles of its feet are Pisces.

Behold, these are also distributed one after another. They exist in this body, as if turned to the side and bent to the pattern of the twelve signs of the zodiac. They too are thus, arranged one against another, head to tail, as they occur on the wheel [from below] up.

Also, they are counted by order and number of the body and all its members. So, we have proclaimed that these are turned to the side, bent, and spread out; because from its head down to its hip shall count six to its left, and another six to its right.

The six that are down its right are these: the right temple is Aries; its right shoulder is Taurus; its right arm is Gemini; its right rib-cage is Cancer; its stomach is Leo; the right side of its reproductive organs are Virgo.

The other six which are to its left, in contrast they come from its hip to its head: its left [hip] is Libra; its left rib-cage is Scorpio; its left breast and left kidney is Sagittarius; its [left] elbow is Capricorn; its left shoulder is Aquarius; its left temple is Pisces. This is how the creator of the body himself has appointed them. He has [set] them in order and arranged them, one against its companion, head to tail.

There exist many powers in this body. They are the house-dwellers who are made the leaders in it. There are eight hundred and forty times ten thousand rulers made chiefs in the human body! They are distributed and set firm, quartered according to house. The count and number of their houses is two hundred and ten times ten thousand.

When all these rulers come creeping and moving within the body, they will meet one another; and they shall beset and destroy one another, and [make war] in them there. When [the affliction grows until] they shall erupt from the body of the person who [will] die; and make putrid boils and sores and burning wounds in the body. Either they might have made him sick within; or else they might come forth upon his outer side. Those wounds shall first be squeezed and discharge their liquid, and empty out their pus, until they are squeezed [clean of their impurity] and the suppuration forced out from the wound. Afterwards, their scars shall close over; and they are healed and obtain relief from the places that came out upon them.

Part 12

The Dynamics of Spiritual Life

Practical and applied teachings on how spiritual life is gathered, purified, nourished, and interiorized within the regenerating person: the ascending chain from wisdom through love to the Divine, the many names of scattered wisdom, the three appropriations by which evil seized what belonged to good, living divine love in eight states, the summons and obedience as spiritual letters, the fifteen paths of spiritual progression, the purification of the four fundamental faculties, the ascending clouds and the stripping of evil from each element, three earths under cultivation, pristine versus restored wisdom, the dragon of self-derived intelligence with fourteen heads, reflections and shadows as spiritual inversions, five productions from spiritual nourishment, the formation of truth through five degrees, and the three discrete degrees (spiritual, rational, sensual) within the elect person.

The Ascending Chain, the Names of Scattered Wisdom, and Living Love in Eight States

Primary Teaching

Wisdom is gathered into love, love into truth, truth into influx, influx into celestial life, celestial life into the Divine response, the response into the Divine calling, the calling into purified understanding, understanding into the pillar of Divine Truth, and so upward to the Divine Itself. The many names of scattered wisdom — great garments, rags, worn and torn garments, images, elements, Cross of Light, counsel of life, the slain soul — are all a single power, separated into these conditions in the first combat but destined to gather into a single unchangeable form. Three times evil appropriated what belonged to good. Living divine love exists in eight distinct states of spiritual order.

In what way shall the elements be gathered in, from one to another?

The light shall be gathered in to the fire, and the fire itself gathered in to the water, and the water gathered in to the wind, and the wind gathered to the air, and the air gathered to the answer, and the answer gathered to the summons. Also, the summons to the purified Mind, which is the intellectual. The intellectual to the Pillar of Glory, [the Pillar of Glory to the First Man, the Man to the Ambassador, the Ambassador to] the aeons of greatness.

What then are these 'great garments'? Or again, this you sometimes call the 'rags', what are those 'rags'? Or the 'worn and torn apart'? Or what are the 'images and the tattered clothes'? Or what is this name: 'light element'? Or conversely, what is the 'Cross of Light'? Or why named otherwise: the 'counsel of life'? Or what is the 'soul that is slain'; being killed, oppressed, and murdered in the enemy? What are all these names?

How have they changed with all these names and become set in altered forms.

The garments that are named 'great garment' are the five intellectuals that make perfect the body of the Pillar of Glory, the Perfect Man. They were purified by the coming of the Ambassador.

In contrast, the ones named 'rag': the rags are the devoured enlightening power. It is compounded and entangled in the body of the universe in the rulers who are above, who exist in all the firmaments. Also, its shine is that which lights up and is displayed in the stars of the chain and the powers of the course. And likewise, these rags that are entangled in these three earths below, above the head of the Porter [and also] on the earth that is under the Porter. These are named the 'rags', because [they are] set [apart in every place].

However, the 'great worn and torn apart garments', which we have proclaimed, is this entangled living power. It is reaped, cut, and devoured. It is overpowered by the five worlds of the flesh, which creep as they move from place to place.

On the other hand, [these] we have termed the 'images and the great tattered clothes' [they] are the three great garments of the wind, the fire, and the water. These the Living Spirit cloaked upon his body. With them he set in order things in the universe. With them also he emptied the vessels. He swept them out and laid them bare in front of the Porter at the foundation of all things.

Conversely, '[the ele]ments', we have called them this name, are this power that remains in all things below. It rises up in the wombs of all the earths, gathering together, and pouring forth upon all things.

And then, the '[Light] Cross' [we have termed] this bound 'light power'. It [is spread in] all [things] upon the earth, in the dry and the moist.

Also, the one named the 'counsel of life' is the summons and the obedience. It moves in all these powers that we have named. It awakens them, gives them ease, and drives them to their movement.

The one named 'the soul that is slain', which is killed, oppressed and murdered; it is this power of fruit, vegetables and seeds. They shall be threshed, plucked and cut down; and they give nourishment to the worlds of the flesh. Further: the wood should it be dry, and the garment should it become ragged, will perish. Again, it is [a pa]rt of this entire soul that is slain and killed; since also even this whole part of it they kill [and devour].

For all these names [that we have proclaimed] are a single [power] since the beginning, it [was one] as it enlightens; but they separated into all these parts in this first contest. They became set in all these altered forms, and these many names. Of course, if now all these varieties are laid bare, and stripped of all these appearances, and parted from all these names; they will gather together and make a single form, and a single name, unaltered and unchangeable for ever in the land of their first essence, from which they were sent forth against the enemy.

[The] entirety of envy is this first nature that occu[red] in the worlds of darkness.

In this envy that [existed] in it, the First Man [swallowed] its poiso[n and] its evil-doing. His garment[s] were [seized and] it cut them and drew them; [...].

It envied the first image of the Ambassador, which he displayed to it in the heights abov[e], i[n] his form that it saw. It established the seal and the image of flesh, and put the impression of t[h]at image on flesh, its very own birth.

[The th]ird time it envied Adam, the fir[st hum]an. It seized a power from him, and bore it forth from a [rib of] of Adam's [flesh].

The [holy] living f[i]re is present i[n] eight places.

The first place wherein it is, is this [light] land [where it is present and] exists. It is established beneath [it, and is ut]terly beyond the totality. It is the foundation and basis of that great earth, and the consideratio[n th]at is beneath them all.

The second place wherein it is, is the Father, the God of truth; because [the Fathe]r is established in his great, mighty consideration. So, [firs]t in the Father. The other powers that came from him were revealed through him, and (the fire) too came w[i]th them [and was revea]led by them.

The third [place wherein it is], is the First Man, h[is] wh[o was clothed in the five sons as his] armour. Again, it is this fire [...] on the body of the Perfect Man.

[The fourth is this fir]e that was purified from all the [light] powers, [which is i]n the outer wall, in the ship of the day.

[The fifth i]s this fire that is in the light-giver of the night [and dwells] within the water.

[The] sixth is this f[i]re that is purified from the totality. The Living [Spirit] swathed it upon his body, over the summons and the obedience. He has established many things by it. He went down and stripped himself of it before the Por[t]er.

The seventh is this living fire that is of the new earth, and is the consideration. For it is the first foundation in the new earth, it they built anew [...] the first course, that is a crown for the entire earth. T[hey] are below the totality, over the entire earth of da[rkne]ss [that is] in it, in the [...] whole [earth].

[The] eigh[th] is the fire that shall be revealed in this [last time upon every] person, and it signifies fear and war. Furthermore it [...] it displays and manifests its sign in [its ter]ror. It shall be r[ev]ealed in these two light ships.

This i[s the way] that the holy living fire exists in these [eight places].

The Summons and Obedience, Fifteen Paths, and the Purification of the Four Elements

Primary Teaching

The divine calling and the will's response are like letters exchanged between the Lord and the celestial mind — influx descending, acknowledgment ascending. The light-givers manifest in two aspects: love and fear. When the Light Mind comes, the soul is purified by wisdom and obedience; disturbance enters through hereditary tendencies, through corrupted appropriations, and through the conduits of influx. Fifteen paths of spiritual progression: four pure, eight mixed (ascending through purification), three of refuse (lust, destruction, profanation). The four fundamental faculties (love, wisdom, truth, perception) disgorge twelve corruptions — three from each — which are progressively purified through spiritual nourishment.

The summons and the obedience.

Consider the summons, which was sent from the Living Spirit in the beginning. He sent it to the First Man. It is a peace letter and greeting that he wrote and sent to his brother, in which all the tidings are written down, together with everything it will bring about and establish by that summons. That summons, the First Man [received, and all that is ordained to happen].

The answer that was sent from the First Man came to the heights, to the Living Spirit. That is also a letter, which was sent from the First Man to the Living Spirit, in which all the tidings are written down; and every war and the struggles that he had waged. It did [make known] in the answer that the First Man [had written down and made known] everything that had happened and everything [that would happen], all that had been done and whatever is made ready to be done by him. The Living Spirit knew all the wars and the dangers and the contests that the rulers had waged against the First Man.

For the light-givers that are in the heavens shall be revealed with these two aspects, in the aspect of love and the aspect of fear. They display these two aspects of the powers above that are in the heavens, because of their soul that passes through the totality. For in these two appearances, the aspect of love that is beauty and sublimity, together with the other aspect of confrontation that is in them, they shall purify in them the powers above.

The soul that assumes the body, when the Light Mind will come to it, shall be purified by the power of wisdom and obedience, and it is cleansed and made a new man. There is no trouble in (the soul), nor confusion nor disturbance.

However, when a disturbance will arise for him and he will be troubled, this disturbance shall go into him in [many ways], first through his birth-signs and his difficult stars that [are upon him, and] they turn over him and stir him and trouble him with lust and anger and depression and grief, as he wills. Also, as he wills, the powers of heaven shall trouble him through their roots, to which he is attached.

Again, there are times you shall find the powers of heaven are peaceful and tranquil for him, and it comes to [pass that] a difficult part comes into him by the nourishment that he has eaten, or else indeed in some [drink] or in the water that they have drunk. Again, trouble and confusion and anger will increase in him, and lust multiplies upon him together with depression and grief; because of the nourishment of the bread he has eaten and the water he has drunk, which are full of bothersome parts, a vengeful counsel. They shall enter his body, [mixed in] with these foods, and they even become joined in with the wicked parts of the body and the Sin that is in him; transferring the anger and the lust and the depression and the grief, these wicked thoughts of the body.

Should you be troubled [know that it comes to you from] them through the conduits and the roots of they above [so that you may recognise] the flood that comes into you.

There are times, however, if you shall find that the nourishment that comes into you is pure [and clear, and full of good parts], so it is greater in light and life while the waste is less in it, and the evil-doing is diminished from it. Even the atmosphere above is still, being purified through the [... ...] also the image is calmed from [its disturbance, and what] increases in you through those good parts of the food that come into you. And they find you at ease and tranquil, as you are well governed in your abodes because of the living part, which is greater on account of the light of these justified souls that are in it. The ones that have perfected their deeds. Their dues have ceased, while their soul is carefree [because] they have been allied with these living souls that [are p]resent in you. Due to this you shall find them in you, calm in tranquillity, and they come from you without trouble; and you are found flourishing of body. Even your deeds are determined, being well constructed after their manner, and your doctrines are in order, as your words [are true, and] your soul is carefree within you, ascending like a bird.

When [your bo]dy is troubled, you shall be troubled by the conduits of they below, the difficult parts that come into you by food and the act of eating. Again, when the conduits above are calmed from you, even your food that has come into you is clear and pure. Your heart shall be found ordered in its place, your counsels at peace from disturbance.

This [liv]ing sou[l] that is set in mixture; for it wishes to [as]cend and go to the house of its people, but it kn[ow][s a]nd understands that it has no open door in all the powers of heaven and earth. For they are its oppression that [presses upon] it everywhere. Indeed, it has no open door except the sun and the moon themselves, the light-givers of the heavens [... / ...] they become the place of rest for it. And they become a door that opens for it [in] the coming forth, and (the soul) comes out through them to the country of the household of i[ts] people.

The light-givers of the heavens have no place of rest amongst all the powers of heaven; except for the lan[d] of light, that has indeed been theirs for ever.

Fifteen paths are drawn out in the zone. Four paths are pure and belong [to the] light, leading up to life. Eight other paths are [mixed], leading above from that place. The light shall go [u]p and become free through them; be purified and go in [to the] ships. However, the waste is separated and thrown [dow]n to transmigr[a]tion and the other three paths of [waste are] discharged to the gehennas.

[The three] paths that belong to waste, the ones that are drawn to the gehennas, [a]re drawn from the flesh. O[n]e of them is the appetite for [lawl]essness, that of people and of all flesh. The second is the [destruction of] all bodies, which is slaughter, [with] which all flesh is consumed. The third is the damaging action, which [harms] the Cross of Light and every body; together with the rest of the error and the blasphemy that wounds the gods.

Th[ese th]ree paths lead to the gehennas. Every person shall follow after hi[s] de[e]ds, whether to life or indeed to death.

The four elements [are what is] purified. From the beginning they are holy ones, living ones, and enlighteners. However, when they undertood [the mingling] in that first struggle, the waste was [mixed] in with them, and the darkness of the enemy was mixed with them. And when they were come into the body, stripping off these polluted garments, they set them in the flesh. Their pollutions, which they have stripped off, shall be displayed in a [form] and become a danger to the body.

The discharge of this pollution, that [the fir]e shall disgorge and place in the body, is [blo]od. The discharge of the blood is anger. The discharge of anger is the humours.

Also, the emissions that the waters discharge from them are lust. The discharge of lust is bitterness. The emission of bitterness is f[e]ver.

The emission that light shall disgorge is flesh. The emission of flesh is gloom. [The] emission of gloom is obstinacy.

The emissions that the tree shall disgorge, they are the voices of the winds of shame. The emission of winds of shame [is sorrow. The emission of sorrow is the tear].

The emission of the [tear] is the [last] of these twelve emissions.

[Now] these four elements shall [disgorge, and] what are gathered in are [f]ound by the management of this soul food [that] enters the body. When they enter the body, they are cleansed and purified and established [i]n their living image, which is the new man. They shall live [again] and receive the Light Mind and be purified in their image; and they come forth, being cleansed and holy. They attain their first rest.

They shall be cleansed and go u[p to] the land of the living ones; but these that come to [the flesh] and pass through them and [... / ...] in sins. Their end will occur in transmigration and spirit.

The Ascending Clouds, Three Earths, and Pristine Versus Restored Wisdom

Primary Teaching

Captive wisdom is liberated from the five sensory faculties and ascends as clouds of obscured truth toward Divine Wisdom in her purity. Each element (fire, water, wind, light, air) rises differently: sudden illumination, deep reverberations, forceful temptation, peaceful stillness. Evil affections stripped from each cloud descend and inflict damage — consuming desire, frozen falsity, turbulence. Three degrees of the mind are undergoing regeneration, each resisting at first but bearing fruit. Pristine wisdom (never touched by evil) versus restored wisdom (intermingled with falsity, purified, and ascending to confirmation in the Divine order). In the natural person: the one who never conjoined with self-love versus the one who was conjoined but renounced it.

It shall be released from five places and ascend over this great earth and [rise up] and it is revealed and seen in the atmosphere between.

So, the cloud shall ascend from fire to the heavens towards the likeness of the Virgin of Light that she shall display to it. Its sign is the flashes that occur with lightning storms [and are seen. I]ts exchange [...]. And they shall be purified by her towards [receiving] the light that she shall reveal [to it]. The rulers shall be released by the lightning storms and they are freed and sent.

However, [these] angels shall immediately be summoned to them, so that they will seize them, because they know that they shall never do good. Every place they will touch they shall make dead and a loss. Whenever the angels will make towards them and come beside [them], they shall flee in their constraint before them. They go into whatever they will meet upon and assume it, like a robber being abandoned and fleeing before one stronger than him, as he runs after him to arrest him.

Now, those rulers that shall be freed from these clouds and assume whatever they will meet upon [and go] into the [... / ...] that they did not [seek] will seize this thing, whether indeed a tree to which they have found the way, or animals, or people. Simply, every place that they will assume they shall burn and destroy by the fire of their body. Namely, the rulers, [the] children of fire, they that shall be stripped of the fire.

In contrast, [the] cloud that shall be raised up from water, and comes above towards the Virgin of Light; its sign is the thunder storms and the booms that shall come in the atmosphere in various forms and are heard. [The lives in it shall be purified] Again, there are times if the rulers that belong to them, which exist in the cloud, shall on occasion be constrained [in a] water [clou]d. And they flee from it and abandon it.

Now, [they] too are so, in that every place that they will [reach], they shall make frost and hail and snow. [They rui]n the seed-corn and the fruits and the plants; and they [shall destroy] every place [that] they will reach.

Again, [ang]els shall be summoned to them who seize them. Still, while the angels [ru]sh after them in order to seize them, they shall make this destruction.

Also, [the cl]oud that will be raised up from wind ascends to the atmosphere between, towards the likeness of the Virgin that she shall display to it. Its sign is [the s]torm wind that shall blow with bitterness.

So, in those winds and tempests shall the lives be purified. Again, the rulers will be stripped of the cloud of wind and they descend from it, safe in their image. All the rivers and the seas that they will reach and arrive at, they shall make waves in them and raise [them up] and they [overturn] the ships. They wreak destruction [in them] and they seize and bring them [to the deep].

Also the cloud, the one of light, immediately they will be stripped of it [and it shall come above towards the likeness of] the Virgin. She shall display its sign too [to it]. And its sign is this, in that you shall find it sailing in stillness and calm. The lives in it shall be cleansed in stillness and calm. Again, the rulers that will be stripped of it [in their image] that will come forth [from it] they shall put [...] and they take [... / ...] there [until] the angels seize them.

Again, the cloud that shall be raised up from the mingled air comes above towards [the likeness] of the Virgin. Its sign is this, in that [the lives] are purified in it in stillness and [rest. Again, these rulers] that will be stripped of that cloud and come from it; every place that they will find [and reach] they shall make it [like] one of [the dead] until [the hour when] they are seized and taken to their midst.

Their strippings, that they shall leave behind them in various places they will have reached, whether the produce of the trees or the offspring of the flesh, they shall be taken midst [...] wither away. They shall inflict great dangers, but again those rulers also the angels shall send to their midst. They bring the light from them and cast the demons down to these seven outer ditches of the great sea; which is the vessel of the waters that are outside the world.

To what place do those seven ditches go down?

Those ditches and the [paths go down] until they reach the earths below [to the] feet of the Porter.

[...] For sometimes these angels shall be sent to them, to seize the rulers. Whenever the rulers [... / ...] for the angels rush after them. They beseech them [...] they that are given the command. However, [t]hose [rul]ers shall be freed from them alone and assume [the tree] and [the fle]sh. They are consumed by this offspring [... / ...] tree and that of flesh. The angels shall set a [watch] over them, that they might guard them until the hour when [those r]ulers will be stripped of tree and [flesh; a]nd they go up above. They shall be gathered [together] above, and they are poured out [again] in their first for[ms and im]ages in which they first were. They take the light from them, which had remained behind in them. And they too are cast down to these seven outer [path]s that are in the great sea; the place to where these former ones [were c/as]t. They shall reach their midst [...] and the light that is in them is taken.

And they are cast to the outer prison by the angels, when the command is given to them through the power of the Virgin of Light. She has authority over the entire zone, and cleanses the life that is in it.

Three earths exist in the universe, and are being toiled over. At first they [trouble] the farmer in them. Afterwards they bear [good] fruit to they who toil over them.

One of them is this great earth that people are living upon. They are ploughing in it [and digging], it with iron hoes, they cultivate, [making] the furrows, turning it over [from its place] Afterwards they harvest fruit from [it in its season].

The second field is the living soul, the holy one. It is mixed in the entire zone, above and below. The farmers who toil over it are these two great light-givers, which journey through the heavens. They are toiling and cultivating it, so that they will draw it towards their aspect. And it leaps up and comes to the heights. It goes upwards, out from every place wherein it is, and it adds to them.

All these animals that you see, and also the rest of the [crea]tures [upon the face] of the earth, confirm them in three likeness[es of birth]: some from [the] abortions. Others, however, form their own selves in their shape [and nature].

Also, their nourishment is thre[efold: the] light in them, if they shall wish [to eat it]. [Some of them] they eat see[ds and] fr[uit and grass]; they eat seeds and fruit. The [nourishment fills] it entirely, and they [bear within them] the three archetyp[es] from their nature and the [whole of] the time when they are on the ea[rth in this world]; they are seized [and bound] in their [bodies]. The Ambassador [purifies] all powers [of the darkness].

[Now] it [formed them], first [of all]. Plant them generally to this name: shoots and grass. It formed the bad, bitter trees, the reeds and the thorns and the [thistles] and these others that are like them.

For that thought belongs to the flesh-eating rulers. Still, these [that were] planted (belong to) grass and gourds, since they are in their essence. Nevertheless, [this t]ho[ugh]t that came down from the rulers, as they are in fruit and grass first and shall not be planted in flesh and blood, it formed the trees that shall give nourishing fru[it], as their gourds are sweet.

Again, this thou[ght] that came down from the powers that eat m[ea]t and also eat grass and gourds, it has formed the trees that shall not produce any nourishment. Their fruits belong neither to good nor evil.

What is the virgin that is named 'virginal'? Or the [one that] is called 'continent', what is it? Or by what category is the [vi]rgin called 'virginal'? Or [the co]ntinent, which is given this name, by what category is it named '[c]ontinent'?

What is called 'virginal' is assigned to the mystery of the aeons of greatness. And they called it 'virginal' by the category of all the light that did not [taste] of death, nor come to the enemy's war.

However, what is called 'continent' occurs to the mystery of the light that came and was mixed with the darkness. It was defiled in bodies [of the creatures] and went up to the light. [They] called [it 'co]ntinent'.

Furthermore, the holy vir[gin]als [are of such a nature that, even] should they come out against the en[emy and come to the war, they would not] taste death, nor [be defiled].

On the other hand, what is called 'continent' [is this li]ght that mixed with the darkness, was purif[ie]d, came [up f]rom all the creatures, and was confirmed in the great[ness]. They called it 'continent' since it tasted [of the l]ust; but afterwards was cleansed from it and [become an] holy one.

Furthermore, what is called '[vi]rginal' is this light that was purified by the ima[ge] of the [A]mbassador. It wen[t up and] attained [the] he[ights. It was] confirmed in the image of the gods.

Again, what is [called] 'continent' is the remainder of this light th[at] remained behind, from what was cleansed. It goes up and comes down in transmigration. Al[so], there is a part [of] it that shall come and attain the form of [hum]an [fl]esh. Again, that one too shall be chosen in the flesh, [accept] the hope, and become an holy one. And they name it 'continent'.

Furthermore, what is named 'virginal' is the Light Mind, should he come and assume the images [of] the ele[ct]. However, on the other hand, what is called 'contin[ent]' is the new man, should it be purified from this old man. And it is cleansed and strips off the Sin that is compounded with it, and it becomes a continent one.

And also, what is called 'virgi[n]al' in the flesh, is a man if he has [ne]ver joined himself to woman, has not been defiled by intercourse. However, [i]n contrast, what is called 'continent', is the man who has a wom[a]n in the world. Afterwards, he cleanses himself from her [and] renounces her. And because of this he [is purified] and he becomes an holy contin[en]t one.

The Dragon of Self-Intelligence, Reflections in Water, and the Formation of Truth

Primary Teaching

The ruling falsity of the selfhood possesses fourteen powers of dominion (seven interior, seven exterior) and five concealed interior states. The dragon is the self-derived thinking of the proprium. Reflections in water: what is highest in wisdom appears lowest in the natural, and vice versa — the divine call descended headfirst, the will's response ascended. Five productions from spiritual nourishment: inmost blessedness, expressed truth, active charity, the misdirected desire of self-love, and the merely external person. Truth is formed through five successive degrees like a coin shaped by five craftsmen. Interior truth and natural good are formed by five essential faculties, nourished by love and its absence.

There is a dragon with fourteen heads, and it is gathered in and [hidden in its] den with five refuges.

Again, this is how this earth [is likened] to it, as it is accounted a corporeal dragon [of desire] the dragon is this doctrine [and teaching] of the flesh [and its thought] also the fourteen heads that are distributed over the dragon are these.

The seven sense organs on the head of the body are the two of sight by which one sees; the two of sound by which one hears; the two of scent by which one smells; also the tongue [of taste] by which one selects, receiving there the different tastes that occur in every form.

These are the seven heads of the dragon, the seven sense organs that are on the upper part of the person; [and seven are] below. The seven of the torso are these: two [hands]; the two [feet] ruler [they correspond to] the seven heads that are above; so with the ones below they total and make fourteen heads of the dragon.

Conversely, the five dens about which they have spoken, where the dragon is congregated and protrudes, are these: the first is the tongue; the second is the lungs; the third is the heart; the fourth is the spleen; the fifth is the blood that dwells in them. Again, if it shall look out from them [and reveal its likeness and its observation above and below, it wages war by] its fourteen heads.

The dragon, which is the thought of the body.

The dragon that exists with its fourteen heads and five dens, wherein it is concealed and hidden. It does through them [all its evil deeds, fulfilling its will and its des]ire all the time.

When the person is above water and looking down [into the wat]ers, if he shall see his face reflected why shall you find his head turned upside down and also his feet upwards? Yet, when he stares down into the waters, his face shall not be visible, nor can he see it there?

[And] this: The face of people and the shape of trees shall appear turned upside down in the water as this is signified in [the] mystery of the summons, when it was sent down to the worlds of Darkness towards the First Man. Sin[ce the summons came down] in this way it cast itself down [to the depths] like a person [who] plunges headlong into water; so it is also with the summons. It cast itself headlong to the worlds below, with strength and diligence.

And this too: Shall the person lift his head up from the water, his face shall not be visible to him, being bent below. This characterises the mystery of the obedience that ascended from below, from with the First Man his father to the Living Spirit.

The face of people and of animals and of trees is visible in the water, hanging upside down. This occurs to the mystery of the stars and the zodiac, which hang upside down and are visible in the great

sea. For the face of people and beasts and all trees hang on the root of the stars and the zodiac, being begotten from them. Just as their fathers, who are spread out above, hang upside down; so it is also that the mystery of their fathers is being revealed to them whenever they stare down into the water. This is, that you shall find their shapes inverted.

Not only this, but [the] child who is born; as the ho[ur] approaches for him to be born, he hangs upside down and is born head first. Indeed, due to this, his mystery shall be revealed in these waters people stare down into.

Behold, you will find the shadow of the person who walks along is joined to the earth all the time. If the person is troubled [and seeks to lift] his shadow up upon the earth [it is bound from] above. It is impossible for him to do [this, to part from his shadow while he remains] on the earth. See, this mystery is [a] great sign, signifying that the entire body came from the earth and had ascended from the abyss. Again, due to this, its shadow is joined on the earth, turned downwards, and hanging from above.

This sustenance of various kinds that people gather in and eat, and enters the body; it shall be distributed to five productions.

The first product is this that shall issue from the person in rapture and rises up in the Mind, and it comes out from all his limbs, and is immeasurable.

The second is this that shall issue from the person in voice and word.

The third is this that shall spring from them in strength and activity.

The fourth is what is engendered by the pleasure of lu[s]t in men and women.

The fifth is this that shall be formed and sculpted in the flesh, and be engendered and come from them. It is this corporeal creature; only its parents can recognise this creature that they beget. They are attentive to its desire and its thought and its [lo]ve every day, all the time. However, these other four forms they neither notice nor are concerned about; because they are not displayed.

There is not [o]ne person [existing in] the world, standing firm [i]n mixture, for whom joy remains to the end.

Not only people, even the sun and the moon, the light-givers of the heavens, [do not suffer] nor are they oppressed, they know not [sorrow, being s]et firm in a summons and an [obe]dience. Nevertheless, they too, they do not rejoice completely.

So, one: Their eyes stare at their enemy, they [perceiv]e him and also look at his ugly shapes. They [s]ee him, that he is alive and established and is king above and below, in secret and manifest. He does every thing that he wants according to his wil[l].

[The s]econd: They perceive the living soul, they see [i]t and that it is ensnared and set in a great [fetter] above and below, in the tree and in the flesh, [burdened] with every oppression. It is being pressed, drawn near to [and] sliced and eaten as it comes up and down; from above below and from below above. It [is] despoiled and moved from body to body.

Now, because of their living soul that is loved by them and honoured of them, when they see it in oppression th[ey can] not [re]joice completely.

So, one about the soul; and one about their enemy whom they see ruling [over] what is not his own. He is proud and satisfied with a wealth that is not his own. Indeed, due to this, they do not rejoice in total; but bear up and swallow their heart until they cleanse the living soul and take it from the enemy's hands. Then they obliterate the death that is their enemy and they gather it in [and fetter it in the lump] for ever and ever.

When they will chain their enemy in the bond at the [las]t, then they will rejoice and no longer grieve from this t[ime]. Also, they become the very same as they were from the [beginning] for ever!

The production of the word t[hat comes] from the mouth and is heard by the [ears]. [The mouth shapes it] and the throat draws it up and the tongue spreads it out and the teeth cut it and the lips g[at]her it! The word shall come forth through the power of th[ese five] members and be heard outside.

Simila[rly] the coin: One shall pour it out and an [othe]r beat it and another trim it as it is turned, and a[nother] put the stamp on it and another wipe it in the sieve (?). [Behold], these five craftsmen shall shape and beautify [their] coin, and it comes amongst mankind. It becomes a posse[ssion] to be received and given.

This is also the case with the [wor]d, as it is formed and embellished by five [member]s. It comes forth and is heard by the ears [of] others.

This seed grain and this barley grain shall be formed and [nourished] and beautified by the five elements. Now, the warmth and the cold nourish the seed grain and the entire tree. So, just as these things nourish it [so also] it is destroyed [and consumed] through [great] hunger.

In this way also righteousness gathers the five to it.

In this way too, a lack and a shortfall shall occur from place to place through them; and they who have chosen it have gathered it in and beautified and attained it, while an affliction shall arise for it through those.

People also shall be caused to stumble on their account, through the energy of Matter that dwells in them. It has poured its shadow over them, just as it shall also pour its shadow over the elements and destroy the fruits of all the trees.

Twenty-Five Faculties, Four Aspects of Perception, and Three Images in the Elect

Primary Teaching

Within each of the five degrees of external truth reside five interior faculties, totaling twenty-five — the complete spiritual organism through which the divine call and its reception are elevated. An immense fullness of confirmed states is sealed within the natural mind, purified by interior perception, divine truth, and the stilling of self-derived thought. Four faculties within the mind receive spiritual perception; wisdom discerns what is hidden within all states. Three discrete degrees exist in the regenerating person: the spiritual (new will formed by Divine Wisdom), the rational (intermediate degree bound in the proprium), and the sensual (the outermost). The living element traverses all three daily, purified progressively — led by the pure affection of Divine Wisdom who is 'the moment of true life,' first and last.

[In each] one of these five garments that the [First] Man summoned there are five powers. They shall be counted to the [number of each] other, these five, and five times [five is] their number. However, at the time [when] the summons went down. The answer wished to ascend with it. And the summons with the obedience [constitute] twenty-five characteristics in their twenty-five limbs, [which] are the sons of the Man. The summons and [the obedience] were raised to the heights through them.

Just as their fa[ther] the living Man raised himself up through them, by these these other ones have set up all things a[bov]e and below. They fasted from their [foo]d, [w]hich is their own.

So, from that time until [the time] of [the adv]ent of Jesus the Splendour, the glorious one who came [from the land of light and gave to them] heir food which is the [life] of sou[l], which is the summons and the obedience [that is] that spiritual food. They rele[ased them throughout] all these fifty days, which [means] this living food suffices for all of them. It filled them all with power and richness and life. Light [is] this living food that [in them] became rich.

[The light] exists [and comes] daily to the body of the person [and] there are two hundred and fifty thousand seals in it [And with them] there are another two hundred and fifty thousand rulers [and] they are cleansed and purified and enter [into the rest] by the voice, by the word, and by the [thought that grows] quiet with the silence at the time when his heart [is opened to the love] of God the Father.

Also, the twelve [signs of the zodiac and their] rulers that belong to the Darkness shall be swept out outside in wandering and in transmigration [and in perdition, and] some of them [shall pass through] this transmigration, and others among them shall be brought back.

There are four aspects among mankind that perceive, as they perceive [all things] without these four that are hidden in them [no one can perceive, for] they belong [to the Living Soul]. So, [these four give perception to all mankind].

[The heat] that is in the [body] belongs to the fire. The darkness belongs to the abyss; but the light that perceives what is hidden in all these things, being clear, is the living air.

How shall the pupil of the eye perceive? While it perceives by day, yet come the night it shall not perceive. [For it is blind in the darkness] The pupil of the eye shall not [perceive] the mystery of the [eye] is the door [to what is] below [and to] the other four cardinal points. For in the [height] above. He has [established a] great [power and] they came down [to the] living [spirit]. The First Man came forth from it and knew all things.

This bit of life and light that comes from [these three] vessels that surround the universe [and the] life comes up [to the light].

[...] B[u]t should the [life] ascend [through the] light of the rays that [come down] which are received, which shine and go in through these great open gates, through these doors, firmament by firmament.

For four [gates o]pen in each world, distributed at the four points of the compass, opening downwards to the vessels. So, due to this, the [light of the] rays shall go in through these openings and it shines on [that] place, and pulls through them the light and the little pi[llar (?) that ex]ists there.

From that place [it] shall be poured [out to the] firmaments. It shall also be clarified in these firmaments [until] a part there is cleansed and it is [all] taken up with the living ones. However, its other part [of darkness] shall all [be cast] down.

Three images occur in the elect person.

The first is the spiritual image, which is the new man, which the Light Mind shall form in him; and it goes into him and dwells in him.

The second image is the remnant and remainder of the new man, which is the psychic image that is bound in the flesh, as the old man [has persisted since the] times of this psychic image.

The other one is the corporeal image [that is] added to them all.

These three images [exist in him] entirely. When it will [come into him] through the nourishment of food. If it shall sink [then it shall come] down to the corporeal image. [And] the corporeal, [that] is in it, shall divest itself of it and place it in the [psychic] image. [And] again it rises up and falls to the [spiritual] image; it shall divest itself of the psychical of the enemies, which [... ...] anger. The lust [... ...] with it.

Then shall a light virgin come and reveal the spiritual image that is [there], which [is] the new man. That virgin acts as a guide. [She g]oes on before and it is extended to the heights above, and received into this spiritual image. And she [forms] it and adorns it with the new man [wi]thin. It is sealed with all the limbs of this light virgin who is present and dwells in the new man.

So, this is [h]ow this living limb shall be [puri]fied and live, the one that comes into the body of [the ri]ghteous one from without through the administration of food of various ki[nds], like this. The living soul shall be clea[n]sed entirely every [d]ay and traverse these three [im]a[ges].

So, it shall divest itself of the body, which is not its own, in the corporeal. It shall also divest itself of the souls that are not its own, these that are mixed with it in the psychical [image, which are] anger and desire and [bitter]-ness and foolishness and envy and strife; and these other wicked teachings that are not its own.

However, in [the] spiritual image itself it shall live and be joined with [lo]ng-sufferingness, the perfection of faith and love that reigns over them all. It is the virgin of light who robes the new man and who shall be cal[le]d 'the hour of life'. S[he] is the f[ir]st, but s[h]e is also the last.

Part 13

The Final Vision

The culminating teachings: the three great entreaties — the complete narrative of how the Divine Proceeding petitioned the Infinite, how the Celestial Will was sent into combat and rescued, how the spiritual world was ordered and the mediating Divine Truth was sent to liberate the captive human spirit. Followed by final doctrinal teachings on essential versus replaceable spiritual faculties, the diminishing of states, the names and nature of the Celestial Human, the two fundamental essences (wisdom and falsity, divine love and self-love), and the meaning of affirmation and confirmation as the portals of divine mercy.

The Three Entreaties: Petition, Descent, and Restoration

Primary Teaching

The culminating narrative: the Divine Proceeding ascends in petition before the Infinite on behalf of the Celestial Will captive in the hells. The first entreaty: the Living Spirit is sent to liberate the celestial will. The second entreaty: the five divine powers petition for a guide — the Third Ambassador is sent to liberate the captive human spirit. The third entreaty: divine truth displays its image, purifying all things. The pattern of each petition is identical: need perceived, prayer ascending, power granted, descent, liberation, ordering, rest. Jesus the Splendour perfects the purpose of all, bestowing the hope of life. The entire drama is not cosmological but regenerative — the salvation of the human spirit across its successive planes.

The Great Spirit, the Mother of Life, she claimed and prayed and besought and glorified and praised the first established one, who is the Father. She besought him an entreaty. She claimed of him a request. She received a great gift; she and the many powers with her.

She besought an entreaty on behalf of the First Man, because of how he had come forth and thrown himself down. He became distant from the Mother of Life. He separated from her and gave himself; in great affliction. He joined war on earth with the destruction and the grief and the weakness; in the worlds of Darkness; in the abysses made of fear; in the midst of the demons' ditch; amongst the powers of the devil!

Indeed, he is like a king standing in the midst of his enemies. And when the Mother of Life petitioned and prayed and glorified and praised the Father, the first established one, she did petition him that he might send a power; a protector and redeemer and helper for the son of God who is set in affliction.

Now, just as she had besought and interceded, so likewise was her prayer fulfilled and received into the presence of the Father of Greatness. He turned and gave to her her entreaty: the great power, the Living Spirit, the giver of ease. The Mother of Life and the Living Spirit came with great power to the borders of the territory. They brought the First Man up from that war and struggle, wherein he is set.

He gave himself as a grace for the Mother of Life. He became estranged and far from her, the one whom his enemies (place) in great affliction, the one who is in the land of Darkness since he became weak.

The Living Spirit grasped and took him in. He freed him. He set him right and gave him ease in the land of rest [and joy] the Living Spirit, the first giver of ease [he fulfilled] the will of these three. The welcomer [shall] find with the welcomer that [ease is given].

[He received] a great power [and the charity] of the loved one [for] the First Man who had been far away. He had become distant. She had besought on his behalf. He was set fast in affliction. (The Living Spirit) went to the place of destruction and weakness, the one that freed and redeemed him and gave him ease from the affliction. He set him right with rest and joy. He has himself become rested, with him for ever.

[These great ones came] and they built the universe and completed it with its firmaments, with its wheels, with the ships of light that are in the heights, with its fastenings, with its earths and its walls, with its vessels. They completed the universe and set it right by the fathers of light.

Then, the Great Spirit stood with the Beloved of the Lights, the Great Builder with the Living Spirit and the First Man. These five stood to prayer; they glorified and praised the Father, the first established one. They besought of him an entreaty. They claimed of him a request, that he might give them the

power [and] the leader, a guide to all the things of activity that they had constructed. That he might come and purify the living soul that is set in affliction.

They prayed and besought their Father, and he received from them their prayer [and] he gave them their entreaty and their request [and] he summoned from him [a great power] which is the Third Ambassador. He, he came from the power of his greatness. He saw the entire soul, how it is entangled in a chain and set fast. It sees the things of activity that his brothers have constructed, that have come from the heights. Again, he saw the living soul, that it is entangled and set fast in a great torture. It is oppressed in the stink of the abyss that is joined with it.

And therefore, he, the Ambassador [was moved] in his charity. So, he revealed his way, before this underworld that is dug deep down, to free the living soul. He redeemed it from all the fleshs of death wherein it is pained. He gave it ease. He set it right in the place of rest and joy.

And again, he too, the Ambassador, he fulfilled the will of these three; the will of his brothers who had besought the Father for him. They claimed of him a request, together with the [will] of the Father, the one that [heard them and] he gave the entreaty that they had besought of him.

The third is the transferral of the living soul that he had freed. He released it and gave it ease from the affliction. He became king and first to the entire body.

The third entreaty when they besought him the third time [and he] displayed his image [to the light and] he hid his image from the [powers of darkness] he stood firm [in his power and] they revealed [the glory of] the light [to] the First Man [whom the archons] mock [and came] to him in [the height] which is exalted [in his] garment [and] they were freed [and came] to him [and raised] their voice [from] the body [in] prayer [and] it [did] beseech [for] the body [did] beseech [and] she besought [him] in [that they might] be free [through the] Ambassador [came] and also [gave them ease].

[He dwells] with the living ones and [rests] for ever [and] the first [Man was freed] from the [affliction and] he gave him the hope [of life].

Also, Jesus the Splendour perfected the will [of the Father and] the will [of the elements and] they found the light [and fulfilled] the will of the [elements] that he had [desired and] he gave them the power that is Jesus the Splendour. He granted the will of the elements. [And they rest in joy] for ever. This first [Man] he was humbled, he was made free [and] the [great]-ness is displayed to his enemies. He received the hope [of life to] reveal [through] Jesus the Splendour, the light power [of the Father] and the entreaty of the [fathers] of light [for ever].

Final Teachings on Spiritual Faculties and the Names of the Celestial Human

Summary

A series of concluding doctrinal teachings: the distinction between essential living faculties (whose loss causes spiritual pain) and outermost replaceable forms (hair, nails = mere natural coverings that regenerate). Three orders of spiritual perception: those that regenerate after being cut, those destroyed permanently, and the corrupted proprium that persists within regenerating will as spiritual sickness. The names of the Celestial Human: 'confirmed in good' (distinguished by the heavenly societies), 'perfected in Divine Good' (the first being wholly in good), 'sole-proceeding' (established alone against falsity). The Celestial Human stood firm amid all falsity, never loving it, laboring to separate and purify all things.

Why when limbs are cut from the body of the person he shall be pained? While if the hair on the head of the person's body should be shaved, and [the nai]ls of his hands and feet be cut, he does not notice it [nor feel pain] Some of these even now shall grow an[d come forth] again. Just as the na[ils are cut and grow] so the hair shall grow and [if you] cut a finger, he in [deed is pained] on the limbs of the [bod]y that you [cut from] him [shall not grow] since this time to the [dissolution of] the body ag[a]in.

Th[at the] body is like the earth, wh[ile these] limbs als[o growing out] of it are like the trees. There are varieties [and kinds] of tree you shall find growing on the earth. They ar[is]e and grow again and stand firm. They have not [been uprooted from the earth] Again, there are others that if they are cut shall not [grow again] and they grow, as they are li[ke the grass] which shall be cut and grow [again] and [again] they too that occur [on the earth] they shall be cut and not grow, resembling [the limbs that shall neither] grow nor shall they [grow again. And] it [sh]all please him on [that which is cut] and grows [again] in impurity [and shall not be cut away] from him. This flesh that is corrupt [is mingled] in the liv[ing] flesh and they [in whom it dwells] are somewhat sick.

About these people who shall [depart from the world] and their soul is released from [their body and the bonds of darkness] if he shall fall upon [judgment].

The [sec]ond [kind] if he shall fall [into the darkness for a time] one [portion of light remaining for] one hour [in that middle place and] others who shall [linger between the light and the darkness] and they remain. They shall delay until they [are purified and then] he is freed, and they delay to come toward [the land of light].

Which names shall be freed, as they [receive the light that shall] release them.

[The mind of the light came down] upon [the earth] from [the height] thus [it is].

[Once more he says concerning a]ll of them [are established by the light, so] that they shall [be purified and attain to the rank of] seven people [who shall be perfected in the light] Again, he too, this per[son, in] the time when [the mind] of the light [shall be made manifest and shall fill all of] the universe [and all the mystery that is within it] is revealed [to him, and he shall] take to the light [completely and utt]erly, the way that he exists [and receives his life and his portion] from [among] these other three [aeons].

[The deed] and the [righte]o[usness of the Father] is more than [the name and] the voice through them.

This one, whom they called "approved" [he received this name because] they approved him in the midst of the ae[ons of] light. These numerous multitudes set him a[part], and he came forth against the enemy. They gave this name [to him on account of] this matter [... ...] who are numerous, that are in the aeons of light and who [are without] measure or number.

This one, [whom they called] "righteous", because he is the first righteous one who had no sin amongst all of the aeons that belong to the light and the thought [by which] they knew him, so that [it was known becau]se he is the first [wh]o obe[y]ed his Father, who had sent him with five sons [into] perdition.

This one also [whom they called] "only begotten", because he was established [alone to] pour [forth against the] enemy.

[The o]nly begot-ten also from gold and silver and all the [treasures] of the universe.

[The F]irst Man, himself stood firm in the [midst] of all the worlds of Darkness. He did not love [the] worlds of Darkness, nor did he lust for them! Rather, h[is] thought and love for the household of his people is in h[i]m. Anything else that the enemy [did to them] with his violent de[e]ds. Behold, (the First Man) toils and struggles; so that (the enemy) would be separat[e from] them and be cast out from them. And he purifies them and ma[ke]s them f[r]ee, and makes them as they were from the beginning.

The Two Essences and the Portals of Divine Conjunction

Summary

The two fundamental principles of all spiritual reality: wisdom and falsity, divine love and self-love, conjunction with the Divine and separation from it — eternally distinct, never arising from one another. The complete spiritual architecture in fragmentary summary: the celestial, spiritual, and natural degrees with their powers. Then the concluding teaching: affirmation belongs to the divine calling, confirmation to the will's response. These opened the portals of mercy for the Celestial Will, became pathways for the Divine Truth and Divine Love to find their captive proceeding, served as purifiers and restorers of interior memory — whether in states of perception, in knowledge, or in the corporeal state.

The two essences that are present at the beginning [and are opposed to one another:] the light and the darkness, that which is good and that which is evil, life and death.

The [Light] and the great [Power] and the great Mind that is [in] this Youth that is with the [Maiden of Light, and the] thirty-six angels [and the] twenty-two angels [that are with him] but [the number] of the twenty-two [is] the seven pillars that stand in the sea that surrounds the universe [and the] four angels that are distributed to the [whole] universe, supporting the mightiness [from] below, which is the earth of all the heavens [and also] these other five gods, the sons of the Man, they that [through them] the universe is stood firm [together with] the summons and the obedience [and] the splendour of the [Light] the Adamant of Light [against those that] they are become enemies [yet] they guide it.

The third also, [that is] below, there are twelve powers standing firm there. However, the number of the twelve images [and also] the three great pillars of mightiness that [are the] pillars supporting the disk [and] the other three [powers] they are the garments that the Living Spirit [wore] he put them at that time [upon those] that threw them, together with [the light] which is displayed therein [and] this [that is made] perfect before [the] great Porter [who is] in his power [and] these are the three great [powers] against [those that] are in the midst of people [and whoever] knows [them and] entrusts his soul to them [shall be saved].

What is the 'assent' and the 'amen'?

The assent and the amen have come about from these great ones of the powers. They were given the name as the assent belongs to the summons and the amen belongs to the answer.

Just as the summons and the obedience are the ones that opened the portals of mercy and entreaty for the First Man, so they also became portals for the Mother of Life and the Father of the living. The First Man sought and found his redeemer. And also the Mother of Life and the Father of the living sought [and found] this runner, who came forth from them, who is the First Man; but the summons and the obedience became the portals for them.

They have become portals for the aeons of greatness towards the First Man, and the soul that was conjoined with death. They became helpers [and saviours] of the First Man during his ascent. They gave him [back to] the Father of Life and the Mother of Life [who received him]. They are purifiers of the living soul, being helpers and bestowers of remembrance for it, be it either in [the water or] in the tree or in the creation of flesh [wherein it is bound].